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Introduction. The Path of Court Love

1.1 Lucinde

Update 12 October 2021. Thus began the path of the Knight 15 years ago, today.

From Lucinde by **Friedrich Schlegel**.

Julius writes to Lucinde:

In the holy solitude around me everything was light and color, and a fresh warm breath of life and love touched me, and stirred and murmured in all the branches of the luxuriant grove. I looked, and I delighted in everything at the same time: the vigorous green, the white blossom, and the golden fruit. And so too with the eye of my spirit I saw the one and only and forever beloved in many forms: sometimes as a childlike girl, sometimes as a woman in the full bloom and strength of love and femininity, and sometimes as a worthy mother with her earnest little boy in her arms. I breathed the spring, saw clearly the eternal youthfulness around me, and I said with a smile: "Even if this world is not the best or the most useful, still I know that it is the most beautiful."

Nothing could have shaken me in this feeling or conviction, neither general doubt nor my own fear. For I believed I was looking deeply into the secrets of nature; I felt that everything lived eternally and that even death was only an amiable deception. But, actually, I didn't think about it very much — at least I wasn't particularly disposed to classify and analyze abstract concepts.

Instead I lost myself gladly and deeply in all the comminglings and intertwinings of joy and pain from which come the savor of life and the bloom of feeling, spiritual voluptuousness as well as sensual beatitude. A subtle fire flowed in my veins; what I dreamed of wasn't just a kiss or the embrace of your arms; it wasn't just a wish to break the tormenting thorn of yearning and cool the sweet flames in surrender; I didn't yearn only for your lips or your eyes or your body.

It was, rather, a romantic confusion of all these things, a wonderful mixture of the most various memories and yearnings. All the mysteries of male and female frivolity seemed to hover about me as suddenly your real presence and the gleam of blooming happiness on your face inflamed my lonely self. Wit and rapture alternated between us and became the common pulse of our united life and we embraced each other with as much wantonness as religion.

I begged you that for once you might give yourself completely over to frenzy, and I implored you to be insatiable. Still, I listened with cool composure for every faint sign of bliss, so that not a single trace might escape me and leave a gap in our harmony. I didn't simply enjoy, but felt and enjoyed the enjoyment itself.

It may seem presumptuous to include love advice in a discussion on *jñāna*, since we associate them with asceticism and celibacy. However, while it started somewhat “tongue-in-cheek”, there is a valid purpose. If non-duality is true, then every area and aspect of life is non-dual. We cannot see the ascetic as the norm — it's odd that only now are we concerned

about the termination of human life on earth, whether through war or environmental destruction, when in actuality, it has always been the human prerogative to end the world simply by refusing to reproduce!

It is a sign of the times to believe we have evolved to the point of accepting practices which have traditionally been considered deviant, on the grounds that they are “natural”. However, this assumes a profound misunderstanding of man, who is anything but natural, both in a positive and a negative sense. Positively, man is more than his nature; with his source in Atman, he creates himself and cannot be reduced to biology, instinct, and impulse. To the modern mind, freedom means release from every constraint to say “yes” to every whim. However, the task of self-creation will often require a “no” instead. It will serve no point to be more specific; as in everything, prudence and wisdom will be suitable guides. Keep in mind, though, the Hermetic principle: “As above, so below”. The manifest world arises from the polarity of the male and female principles (*Purusha* and *Prakriti*). The most creative relationships will exhibit that polarity in the phenomenal realm.

Negatively, man does not understand his true nature. As we pointed out, his perceptions, actions, and thoughts are delusory, so man, in this unregenerate state, cannot even know his true nature, so what he considers “natural” is, from a metaphysical perspective, more likely to be the manifestation of unnatural *tamasic* forces. Keep in mind that the studied “naturalness” of a Zen practitioner, or the “naturalness” of a dancer or artist, are actually the result of deep and dedicated practice.

In the past, we have quoted from **Friedrich Schlegel**’s novel *Lucinde* without giving the background. Schlegel was a founder of the Romantic movement in XIXth century German art and was an innovator in bringing the Vedic teachings to Europe. The common “wisdom” among the intelligentsia at that time, was that a man needed three types of women to be fulfilled: a wife, a mistress, and an âme-soeur (soul sister). The first two are self-explanatory. But the âme-soeur is a Platonic relationship; she

is able to discuss the deep things of life (e.g., art, philosophy, spirituality, etc.).

Schlegel and his wife, Dorothy, turned that common wisdom on its head by incorporating all three aspects into a single relationship. The progress and results of that experiment were documented in his novel.

While the “mate” (or wife) can be seen as the public face of the relationship, the Mistress is the private face. (This is why any hint of promiscuity, adultery, exhibitionism betrays the relationship.) The public/private distinction corresponds to the exoteric/esoteric distinction in religions. So, exoterically, since sexual relations between mates is open to biological life, by correspondence, esoterically, the Mistress relationship is also open to the creation of a new life, though, in this case, it is the spiritual birth of a new being, wherein they each find their own wholeness in the other. So for Schlegel, the *âme-soeur* relation is not opposed to a “conventional” relationship, but is instead its fulfillment.

This extended passage from *Lucinde* is illustrative:

Yes: I would have thought it a fairy tale that there could be such happiness and such love as I feel now — and such a woman, at once the most delicate lover, the most wonderful companion, and the most perfect friend. For in friendship particularly I sought for all that I lacked and didn’t expect to find in any woman. In you I’ve found everything and even more than I could have hoped for; but, then, you’re not like the others. You’re untouched by the faults that custom and caprice call female. Aside from your little idiosyncrasies, the femininity of your soul consists simply

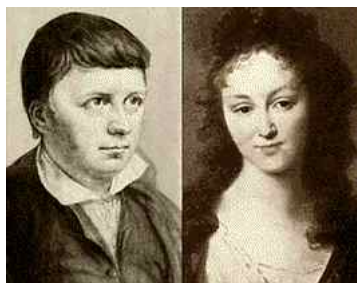


Figure 1.1: Friedrich and Dorothy Schlegel

in your making life and love synonymous. You feel completely and infinitely; you know of no separations; your being is one and indivisible. That is why you are so serious and so joyful. That is why you take everything so solemnly and so negligently, and also why you love me completely and don't relinquish any part of me to the state, to posterity, or to my friends.

Everything belongs to you, and we are in every respect closest to each other and understand each other best. You're at my side at every stage of human experience, from the most passionate sensuality to the most spiritual spirituality; and only in you have I seen true pride and true womanly modesty. The most extreme sorrows, if they merely enveloped us and didn't separate us, would seem to me nothing more than a refreshing contrast to the sublime frivolity of our marriage. Why shouldn't we interpret the bitterest whim of chance as a lovely witticism and an exuberant caprice, since we, like love, are immortal? I can no longer say my love or your love: both are identical and perfectly united, as much love on one side as on the other. This is marriage, the timeless union and conjunction of our spirits, not simply for what we call this world or the world beyond death, but for the one, true, indivisible, nameless, unending world, for our whole eternal life and being.

Posted on 2006-10-12 by Cologero

* * *

Tannheuser on 2021-02-15 at 13:50 said:

It may be worth meditating on whether there is a parallel between the Mother/Mistress/Ame-soeur triad and the Three Marys (John 19:25) from the New Testament. The fact that all of these important women in the New Testament are named "Mary" would seem to indicate that they are in a some sense different aspects of the same personage.

Magdalene is described as being cleansed of seven devils (Luke 8:2), and the first to behold the resurrected Christ (John 20:11-18). She is also prominent in the apocryphal and "gnostic" gospels – in the Gospel of Mary she describes exclusive and private revelations given to her by Christ, regarding the nature of the soul and spirit, and the trials the soul undergoes after death.

In all of this it's hard not to think of Arcanum II of the Tarot, the High Priestess. Tomberg says that she embodies Gnosis, and if we think of Magdalene this way it makes sense that Aquinas calls her "Apostle to the Apostles":

"Note the three privileges given to Mary Magdalene. First, she had the privilege of being a prophet because she was worthy enough to see the angels, for a prophet is an intermediary between angels and the people. Second, she had the dignity or rank of an angel insofar as she looked upon Christ, on whom the angels desire to look. Third, she had the office of an apostle; indeed, she was an apostle to the apostles insofar as it was her task to announce our Lord's resurrection to the disciples. Thus, just as it was a woman who was the first to announce the words of death, so it was a woman who would be the first to announce the words of life." (2519)

Sibylle on 2023-06-05 at 03:16 said:

Lucinde writes to Julius:

"...childlike cheerfulness and bitter pain, untamed rage and pouring dreams, death and love, desire and contemplation, sweeping exuberance and melancholy, (sweet little sighs of which none escaped my ears), dark sorrow and bright willfulness; this is what I see before me in such clear and powerful manner, gazing at me, living and striving in ... letters and dreams, conversations and speeches; this is the spirit and intent of your opus, and that is why it is so dear to me, why I have taken it into my heart, out of intimate love and deep awe; it is here where I have found the clearest image of my own highest longing."

– Fragment from the appendix of "Lucinde, Studienausgabe", Reclam Verlag

1.2 The Path of Courtly Love

neither is the man without the woman, nor the woman without the man, in the Lord.

1 CORINTHIANS II:II

There are few people who know the full strength of the different movements of the heart. The vast majority of men are sensitive to only five or six passions in the circle in which their lives are spent and which define the boundaries of their imaginations. Take away love and hate, pleasure and pain, hope and fear, and they will feel

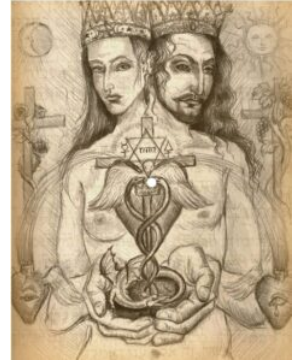
nothing. But persons of a nobler character can be moved in thousands of different ways. It seems that they can receive ideas and sensations which surpass the ordinary norms of the common people.

ABBE PREVOST, *Manon Lescaut*

There are many paths to God — the ways of the Monk, Ascetic, Mystic, Devotee, Sage. But the most effective, and little known, may be the Way of Courtly Love. This is the path of the Fedeli d'Amore, the Troubadour, the Alchemist, and the Knight Errant. The Muslim mystic, **Ibn Arabi**, was aware of this path:

Contemplation of God without formal support is not possible...
Since therefore some form of support is necessary, the best and most perfect kind is the contemplation of God in women.

Formal manifestation, then, is the stepping stone to formless manifestation, and ultimately to the Supreme Identity. Hence, Dante had Beatrice and Ibn Arabi had Nizam to lead them upward. I have been aware of this path since I was a young man. Although following it often brings heartache, unfortunately even to the innocent, it is nonetheless effective. Herewith, we describe some preconditions and indicate some signposts to follow along the way.



Emotional Education In the decadent parts of the modern world, great attention is paid to physical and intellectual training, while emotional development is left entirely to chance.

Figure
Androgyne

1.2:

Sure, there is talk about “emotional intelligence”, which in practice achieves nothing. There are about a half dozen primary emotions, that can even be observed in babies: delight, fear, anger, surprise, discomfort, sadness. Over time, any developments in emotional responses are usually negative: anxiety, depression, worry, despair, self-doubt, inflation. That is why esoteric training begins with some preliminary objectives:

The chief practical objectives are mastery of the sexual center, and the training of the emotional center.

BORIS MOURAVIEFF, *Gnosis*

Emotional problems are obstacles to the Supreme Identity as they will disappear:

The only things which have disappeared [in the unconditioned state] are the limiting conditions, which are negative, since they represent no more than a “privation”.

RENE GUENON, *Oriental Metaphysics [OM]*

Otherwise, the Supreme Identity is the fulfillment all of one’s potentials in his other states:

In this unconditioned state all other states of being find their place, but they are transformed and released from the special conditions which determined them as particular states. What remains is that which has a positive reality, since herein it is that all things have their own principle; the “delivered” being is truly in possession of the fullness of his own potentialities.

OM

What are these states? Tradition teaches that the Celestial Ray draws us upward. This vertical ray is perpendicular to the degrees of existence represented by successive planes. Death in one plane is birth in the next. Life then moves in a spiral around the Celestial Ray

Alchemical Marriage Since its goal is to achieve higher states beyond the merely biological, Alchemical Marriage requires mastery over the sexual center. In *carnal love*, the couple becomes One Flesh. In *Courtly Love*, the creative power of the sexual instinct leads to the couple being One Soul. In Tradition, this state is called the Androgyne. Guenon describes the necessary conditions:

The union of complements must be regarded as constituting the primordial **Androgyne** of which all traditions speak. In the totalization of the being, the complements must in fact be in perfect equilibrium, with no predominance of one over the other.

RENE GUENON, *Symbolism of the Cross*

There is no question of domination, as each soul reaches its full potential with no diminishment.

There is one precise woman and one precise man. However, when that is not possible there will be others that are “close enough”. Often, the couple may be geographically and temporarily separated, or one may even be deceased. Nevertheless, St. Paul assures us that no one is deprived (1 Corinthians 11:11).

Courtly Love

Courtly Love is the *raison d'être* for the couple of polar [i.e., complementary] beings: for the Knight and the Lady of his Dreams; without it, their polarity remains spiritually sterile and they fall

back into the common condition. Its practice, however, demands sacrifices and ‘exploits’. These are tests. For those who surmount them, the salutary effect of Gnosis is doubled: *when it is enriched by experience, theoretical knowledge becomes living knowledge.*

BORIS MOURAVIEFF

Despite his artistic and scientific genius, Goethe failed to realize this courtly love in his ill-fated relationship with Ulrike. He treated her as common and ordinary. Nevertheless, unrequited love is not a failure, as Goethe then entered another creative period of his life. To the age-old question, “How do I know when I am in Love?” there is this answer:

On all planes, the objective sign of Love’s participation is the creative spirit which animates the subjects for whom it has become an aim. Conversely, if we think we are in Love but objectively do not notice an increase in creativity on any plane, either in ourselves or in our partner, we can be sure that the relationship is based on anything but Love.

BORIS MOURAVIEFF

The Union of Complements The descriptions of this contemplative union are usually one-sided. There are the well-known examples of Dante and Beatrice, Ibn Arabi and Nizam, Hafiz and the beautiful daughter, just to name a few. Some may claim that the women never physically existed, but Ibn Arabi denies it. What became, then, of the “real” Beatrice, the real Nizam, the daughter who become interested in Hafiz, just as he began his vigil. Don’t they deserve a voice in the matter?

In other words, your polar being is not merely a prop for your spiritual development. In our state of being, she is as much flesh and blood as you are. She needs to be treated that way, since her own development is intertwined with yours.

I can share some personal experiences that may help you turn “theoretical knowledge” into “living knowledge”. Obviously, you wouldn’t want to share the Supreme Identity with a stranger for all eternity, so you need to know your complementary or polar being.

A woman, at least the one that you should want, desires to be known, just as a man desires to know. It is important so pay attention to her, not just what she says, but more importantly what she means. Often, she does not even know herself, until it is articulated to her.

A Short Digression In the Turkish telenovela *Sahsiyet*, the female character Nevra resists remembering the one thing that could free her from her life of promiscuity and inner turmoil. Agah, a government functionary his whole life, needs to come to terms with his impending death of his human person. He has been in position of the diary of a girl named Reyhan who was abused by the men of her village. He decides to become a Knight at that point, fights for justice for Reyhan and rescues the damsel Nevra. Agah knows her better than she knows herself, so he executes an elaborate plan that eventually allows Nevra to bring that hidden part of herself into conscious awareness; that liberates her.

Soul knowledge Sibylle surprisingly wrote: “To a woman the love of a man is incomprehensible.”¹ Why would that be? If she is often pursued, she may be confused by the different motivations. If she feels herself to be unlovable, she may reject them all. The one mistake she can make is to assume that mere willfulness is a strength in itself. Then she may try to play the role of the Animus herself and become an ersatz man. Or else, she denies the Animus altogether and lives unconscious of her full potential. There is no way to reconcile those, so the double-mindedness can lead to doubt, division, confusion.

¹See Section 3.2 in this book.

The Will must be guided by intelligence to be effective. Beatrice and Nizam are Wisdom, so they can pull Dante and Ibn Arabi upward along the Celestial Ray. In the world of flesh and blood, the woman supplies the man with the will to fight his battles. This is always a necessary component in the horizontal planes of existence that still include trial, conflict, and purgation. In exchange, she becomes who she truly is and is herself drawn up the Celestial Ray.

To write about the polar being only at the human, all-too-human, level will totally miss the point. Rather, it must be described from the states beyond the human state. Moreover, these must not be understood as merely psychological states.

What follows is a living, not theoretical, description, but don't assume it refers to a particular living person. It shows what to look for at the higher states of being. Bear in mind that the Person exists in all states simultaneously, even when unaware of them.

The Active Intellect Buddhi, or Active Intellect, is the first degree of the manifestation of the Androgyne. As such it is formless, not bound by individual conditions. Nevertheless, it is the father of the human intellect. Look, therefore, for someone of the same level of intelligence. While most people can only understand ideas that can be expressed in a slogan, she will have intellectual depth. Hence, she will be interested in high culture including art, poetry, music, mythology, psychology. Besides depth, she has a broad outlook that comes from knowledge of history and of different culture.

The lower intellect is the passive receptacle of ideas. Those in touch with the Active Intellect, on the other hand, are creators of ideas. She writes text. You share the same worldview to a large extent. You recognize the same landscape she creates, but her different perspective can be disorienting. But that is the motor force that drives the spiral up the Celestial Ray.

Manas After the Buddhi, Manas is the next degree; it begins to take individual form and is the principle of the individual senses and the organs of action. Manas is the inner sense. Our sensual awareness is not the creation of any physical or corporeal process. Otherwise, there could be no common experience, or experiences in other states of being.

Each of the five primary senses is related to one of the fundamental elements.

Vision There are many pretty girls, so what makes one more special than another? The vulgar will gaze at a woman's physical qualities, so you have the "ass man" or the "tit man". But that is what women share in common, not what makes her unique. To find your Lady, you need to look for the features that set her apart and are meaningful only for you. They reveal more of her inner life than you might suppose.

As an example, look for qualities like these: The enigmatic color of her eyes, the way she cocks her head, her preference for angles rather than rectangles, her refusal to smile in photographs.

When you understand that the sense of Vision is associated with the Fire element, you will understand how the mere sight of her sets your heart ablaze. Sometimes it is can become physically painful so you have to look away. But you can't look away.



Voice Everything in the universe consists of vibrations, which are beyond matter and energy. Hence, the element Ether is associated with vibrations. It follows, then, that the auditory sense, which converts vibrations, arises with the Ether. Unlike the other gross elements, the Ether is subtle.

Her voice seems to arise from a transcendent source. The ancients

understood this; they weren't bombarded with a cacophony of noise, so they understood silence. The voice of a Sybil rang true as a prophecy. Sometimes the allure was dangerous, like the tempting sons of the Sirens. But the voice of your Lady is only sweetness.

If you are fortunate, she will sing for you, and it will sound like the Music of the Spheres. Thanks to the gift of Memory, you can recall the song anytime you want.

Life is Bittersweet

In the Middle Ages, the Knight and his Lady, who considered themselves spiritually ONE did not venture into marriage. On the contrary, they parted, accepting the risk of never meeting again and knowing that if they did not triumph over a hard test, their love would degenerate, losing its meaning and its marvelous power. They knew that, by separating from each other for an *exploit* they had a chance, while a premature marriage would be reduced to nothing.

MOURAVIEFF

The legends of mythology and knightly valor know of these tests. Atalanta would only marry the one who could pass a test; but they allowed their passion to take old and were punished.

Often the exploit will take the Knight away. If he fails to return, they will need to wait for the next turn of the spiral to meet again. Just as they had promised each other in the previous turn. It sounds bittersweet, so I asked a sweet and insightful friend who explained:

A little bittersweet. It is an art to take pleasure in sorrow.

Appendix For more on Nizam, see The Lady Nizam — an Image of Love and Knowledge².

²<https://ibnarabisociety.org/the-lady-nizam-ralph-austin/>

William Anderson in *Dante, The Maker* explains the influence of Beatrice on Dante:

Through his love of her on Earth he formed an indissoluble union of love with her that transcended the incident of her death. She mirrored to him the Incarnation of Christ, and, in purifying his individual nature as a Christian, he found that the only way to the sight of God was through her as the revelation of his soul... so she, as his illuminated soul represents the search for unity and contains in herself the still causes of history and of creation. Through the love of her his love expands to become the love of God... she is in him the gateway to ecstatic joy. the source both of his inspiration and his salvation, the maker of him as a torch of living flame and his guide towards the peace which his difficult temperament and the sorrows of his bitter political life so long denied him. Through her guidance he achieved a total transformation in his emotional and intellectual being.

Ibn Arabi describes his first meeting with Nizam, the daughter of a Persian scholar:

Now this shaykh had a daughter, a lissome young girl who captivated the gaze of all those who saw her, whose mere presence was the ornament of our gatherings and startled all those who contemplated it to the point of stupefaction. Her name was Nizam (Harmonia) and her surname "Eye of the Sun and of Beauty". Learned and pious, with an experience of spiritual and mystic life, she personified the venerable antiquity of the entire Holy Land and the candid youth of the great city faithful to the Prophet. Her glance, the grace of her conversation were such an enchantment... If not for the paltry souls who are over ready for scandal and predisposed to malice, I should comment here on the beauties of her body as well as her soul, which was a garden of generosity... And I took her as a model for the inspiration of the poems... although

I was unable to express so much as a part of the emotion which my soul experienced and which the company of this young girl awakened in my heart, or of the generous love I felt... since she is the object of my quest and my hope, the Virgin most pure ...

Yet, his encounter with her, spiritually revealed a sharper aspect:

One night I was performing the ritual circumambulations of the Ka'abah... suddenly a few lines of verse came to my mind. I recited them loudly enough to be heard... No sooner had I recited these verses than I felt on my shoulder the touch of a hand softer than silk. I turned around and found myself in the presence of a young girl, a princess from among the daughters of the Greeks. Never had I seen a woman more beautiful of face, softer of speech, more tender of heart.

Posted on 2021-02-07 by Cologero

* * *

Tanneuser on 2021-02-07 at 18:15 said:

Thank you for this. I tried living without Love for a long time, finding it again was transformative. One of the reasons it is such an "effective" path is the way Love easily burns away many bad habits and impurities of the senses that can be difficult to master otherwise.

On the other hand, Love is bittersweet as you say, and involves very painful tests of all kinds. Every kind of meeting with the Beloved, no matter how sweet, involves a departure, and has the double character of requiring excruciating restraint and control of oneself – the ability to stand firm and not be swept away by the whirlwind described in *Inferno* Canto V, that beats from all sides.

Of the Will that a woman provides a man to fight his battles, take the example of Palomides in *Malory*, who is powerfully inspired by Isoud, despite his love being unrequited:

—

"Sir Palomides looked up toward her where she [Isoud] lay in the window, and he espied how she laughed; and therewith he took such a rejoicing that he smote down, what with his spear and with his sword, all that ever he met; for through the sight of her he was so enamoured in her love that he seemed at that time, that an both Sir Tristram and Sir Launcelot had been

both against him they should have won no worship of him; and in his heart, as the book saith, Sir Palomides wished that with his worship he might have ado with Sir Tristram before all men, because of La Beale Isoud. Then Sir Palomides began to double his strength, and he did so marvellously that all men had wonder of him, and ever he cast up his eye unto La Beale Isoud. And when he saw her make such cheer he fared like a lion, that there might no man withstand him; and then Sir Tristram beheld him, how that Sir Palomides bestirred him; and then he said unto Sir Dinadan: So God me help, Sir Palomides is a passing good knight and a well enduring, but such deeds saw I him never do, nor never heard I tell that ever he did so much in one day.

...

Well, said Dinadan to himself, all this worship that Sir Palomides hath here this day he may thank the Queen Isoud, for had she been away this day Sir Palomides had not gotten the prize this day.

...

Well, said Sir Launcelot, I see, for to say thee sooth, ye have done marvellously well this day; and I understand a part for whose love ye do it, and well I wot that love is a great mistress. And if my lady were here as she nis not, wit you well, said Sir Launcelot, ye should not bear away the worship."

(Mort d'Arthur Book X, Ch. LXX)

Paulo Adolpho on 2021-02-07 at 22:38 said:

"There are many pretty girls, so what makes one more special than another? The vulgar will gaze at a woman's physical qualities, so you have the "ass man" or the "tit man". But that is what women share in common, not what makes her unique. To find your Lady, you need to look for the features that set her apart and are meaningful only for you. They reveal more of her inner life than you might suppose. As an example, look for qualities like these: The enigmatic color of her eyes, the way she cocks her head, her preference for angles rather than rectangles, her refusal to smile in photographs."

"In the Middle Ages, the Knight and his Lady, who considered themselves spiritually ONE did not venture into marriage. On the contrary, they parted, accepting the risk of never meeting again and knowing that if they did not triumph over a hard test, their love would degenerate, losing its meaning and its marvelous power. They knew that, by separating from each other for an exploit they had a chance, while a premature marriage would be reduced to nothing.

Mouravieff"

These parts above, summarize the true understanding, the essential knowledge, on this issue. And what about you Cologero, do you have experienced what is described above?

Tannheuser on 2021-02-09 at 21:53 said:

"In other words, your polar being is not merely a prop for your spiritual development. In our state of being, she is as much flesh and blood as you are. She needs to be treated that way, since her own development is intertwined with yours.

...

A woman, at least the one that you should want, desires to be known, just as a man desires to know. It is important so pay attention to her, not just what she says, but more importantly what she means. Often, she does not even know herself, until it is articulated to her."

—

In the modern world, this is painful. Allowing oneself to love a woman today feels a little like what it must be like for Christ to love the world. Her spiritual well-being becomes my concern, and suddenly all of the awful decisions she makes are harmful to me also. The Garden of Gethsemane is the first thing that comes to my mind here. Like the Elves who leave Middle-earth for the Undying Lands, there's a part of me that also wants to leave it all.

In the human state, I think it is possible only to really love one other person in this way. I think it requires angelic and higher states of consciousness in order to really love beyond that, and the first love is the gateway to everything else. Universal love that is not based on these higher states of being, on the other hand, is a counterfeit.

Tyler on 2021-02-09 at 22:09 said:

On the subject of artistry, romanticism, and the Path of Courtly Love, can you speak in some way to this strange importance I perceive of *not* breaking the fourth wall? I don't quite grasp it in full as I am still young.

A magician never reveals his secrets – but in some way I feel I would go insane if I never broke the fourth wall with my lady. Which is it? Does this make sense?

Cologero on 2021-02-09 at 22:46 said:

Yes, you and your lady are starring in the same film together, but as characters. To break the fourth wall is to become the actor in the film, not just the character; the audience as well as the players. It is complex. A similar idea is developed in Gnosis Book One on the topic of the "film" of life. But to start there, in media res, will be difficult probably.

Isma'il on 2021-08-26 at 01:36 said:

Peace friends,

"In the modern world, this is painful. Allowing oneself to love a woman today feels a little like what it must be like for Christ to love the world. Her spiritual well-being becomes my concern, and suddenly all of the awful decisions she makes are harmful to me also. The

Garden of Gethsemane is the first thing that comes to my mind here. Like the Elves who leave Middle-earth for the Undying Lands, there's a part of me that also wants to leave it all."

My sympathies. Qur'anic exotericisms on marriage conditions are very useful. A woman entering into marriage aware that:

- he can marry others, but she cannot, though divorce is normal
- while married, he has the right to physically spank her should vanity overcome obedience
- many others

...are all a deep Mercy I think, especially for this time.

Don't worry about classical Fiqh, it is full of things that don't make sense in our age. At the danger of being Protestant, taking the Quranite approach of seeing it as the complete independent revelation that it claims to be clears a lot of that mess.

Salaam.

Mail on 2021-08-29 at 08:16 said:

A little interesting, Isma'il, that you invoke the Qur'anic teaching on disciplining women but then tell us not to worry about fiqh. Most of us readers here at Gornahoor are living in countries where we are temporally judged by a modern legal system not based on fiqh, and that includes our decisions on how to handle women.

Because of this, most of us have had an intuition of the Western path of courtly love. It underlies the expectations of this modern system, so being raised in the system, and desiring to know the truth mixed with its lies, we are slowly directed towards that path. You may find that when you meet your Muslim beauty, your Western intuition provides you with an orientation that her other suitors have lacked, and you will feel safe to walk the path of life with her out of a shared hunger for the soul as Cologero writes about here, without desiring a moral basis for physical domination. But it seems to me you must also take care in the way you think about fiqh, as religious syncretism engenders modernism.

Marcellus on 2022-07-23 at 21:10 said:

I thought to myself last night that I had seen god. I had focused strongly on one who is indifferent to me and how I could be with her, and the potentialities were shown to me, and I witnessed the higher plane of love in estastic vision. I had seen Dante's vision, I said. At one time, I was filled with the greatest warmth from the fire within, and I shed tears in awe. Alas, she was but "good enough", I can only assume, for I know her not well. I was only truly brought back down to reality a few hours later from a manosphere video.

1.3 Faithful to Love

The various ladies celebrated by the poets attached to the mysterious organization of the Fedeli d'Amore, from Dante, Guido Cavalcanti, and their contemporaries, to Boccaccio and Petrarch, are not women who actually lived on this earth but are all under different names, one and the same symbolic Lady who represents transcendent Intelligence or Divine Wisdom.

RENE GUENON, *The Secret Language of Dante*

*O voi che avete gl'intelletti sani, Mirate la dottrina che s'asconde
Sotto il velame delli versi strani !*

O you who have healthy intellects, look at the doctrine that lies hidden under the veil of mysterious verses.

Inferno IX

Women's strength lies in her beauty, whereas Man's beauty lies in his strength.

BORIS MOURAVIEFF

He who knows himself knows God.

CLEMENT OF ALEXANDRIA

Esoteric Schools Guenon's written works are often dry and intellectual, which have opened him up to the charge of "rationalism", so it may be easy to miss his point regarding the Fedeli d'Amore. Yet that is where we need to look in order to understand initiation in the West. He goes further, and adds the stories of Chivalry, the search for the Grail. Even *The Romance of the Rose*, translated into Italian by Dante, is a work that

hides its hidden doctrine. Historians dismiss it as a work of popular entertainment. Who has bothered to read it; and of those who have read it, who has understood it?

The Persian poets, like Rumi and Hafiz, need to be penetrated to reveal the secret doctrine. Such poets influenced the Sicilian poets from whom Dante was initiated. Hafiz was the equivalent of today's pizza delivery guy. Yet, like the Buddha who sat under the fig tree until he was enlightened, Hafiz did a vigil for 40 nights at the tomb of a Saint with the same effect.

Guenon asserts that from Pythagoras to Virgil to Dante, the chain of Tradition was never lost on Italian Soil. This Tradition was continued by the alchemists with their quest for the Mystical Marriage. More recently Vladimir Solovyov brought us revelations of Divine Wisdom. Carl Jung, in a scientific way, has recovered the hidden doctrine of the alchemists, even recreating the pathway to the *Mysterium Coniunctionis*.

As a student of science, I learned to keep a lab book of experimental results. The science of alchemy is no different. It may be helpful to share the results of alchemical experiments in a concrete way rather than in abstract, intellectual terms. Our age is more open and I have learned that some things remain hidden out in the open. There are those who just don't see it. This will involve "women who actually lived on this earth" and some who have not, at least not as I have experienced them.

Basic Instinct

The more civilized, the more unconscious and complicated a man is, the less he is able to follow his instincts. His complicated living conditions and the influence of his environment are so strong that they drown the quiet voice of nature. Opinions, beliefs, theories, and collective tendencies appear in its stead and back up all the aberrations of the conscious mind.

CARL JUNG, *Aion*

Sometimes you need to live your life in reverse. What was it like before opinions, beliefs, and theories filled your mind? What were your first instincts as a boy? I grew up with my Nana, Mother, and Sister; they mostly stayed at home, while I, along with the other boys, would be gone for hours. We would play games, wander, fight, explore. But I could always count on a home to return to. I envisioned myself as a caveman. I would go out, confident that I could return to a warm cave. Nana would make me what my father called “peasant food”; tasty and comforting but not available in restaurants. That includes gnocchi which she made by hand. Now gnocchi are the rage, overpriced and mispronounced as “noki”.

Nana, Mother, and Sister had special roles in my life. All the other girls were fair game, mostly indistinguishable from each other. Their thoughts were mysterious, even alien, but of little interest. In Kindergarten, we had dance time in which the girls rushed to pick a partner. Two of them ran to me. A shoving match ensued and one was pushed to the ground. I didn’t understand the fuss since I didn’t even like to dance.

That world for me, was impervious to intellectual abstractions. It was populated by angels, demons, saints, Jesus, Mary, God, suffering and triumphant souls, prayers, holy days, fasts, abstinence, and so on. Mary has watched over me my whole life or else I’d be dead by now.

Remote Control I can wave my hand, shake a leg, and nod my head. Yet there is one appendage over which I have no conscious control. There was a point when I came to realize that another being, through her touch, or even seeing or imagining her, could make it rise and fall, like the way the Moon controls the tides. Except that the Moon is always there, but a woman needs to be pursued.

That led to years of wandering outside the cave. I had to learn many new skills in order to survive. I learned how to dress, learned to dance, worked out, took acting lessons. Through spiritual practices, I developed more control over thoughts and emotions. In particular, I had more op-

tions to express a Persona before reverting to my rather Saturnine default personality.

There were too many risks, things I did that I would not have done even to save my own life. If you've ever had to crawl out a bedroom window or scamper down a fire escape in the middle of the night, you will understand. Like encountering a rusalka, pleasure and risk interpenetrate each other.

Penetration At a certain point, it just becomes tedium, without a purpose. Then mere penetration is not enough with someone you love – or think you love. Your desire then is to penetrate her soul; that is what is needed, even if the reasons are unclear. Skin, which a moment ago was an organ of intense pleasure, suddenly becomes an obstacle. The frustrating conclusion is that the soul is impervious to physical contact.

At the level of the psyche, the roles are reversed: the woman becomes the active principle and the man passive. This is known in Tantra; **Francesco da Barberino**, also in initiate into the Fedeli d'Amore, reveals it in *Documenti d'Amore*:

the man with his passive intellect is reunited with the active intelligence, represented by woman

Tomberg expresses it like this:

the intellect is the feminine side of the soul, whilst the fertilising imagination is the masculine principle

Expressed another way, the Anima is the passive receptor of images revealed to him by the woman. Once again, another being is in control, in this case, of the most intimate parts of a man's soul.

Imagination and Inspiration

The intellect that is not fertilised by imagination guided by the heart is sterile. It depends on impulses which it receives from the participation of the heart by means of the imagination.

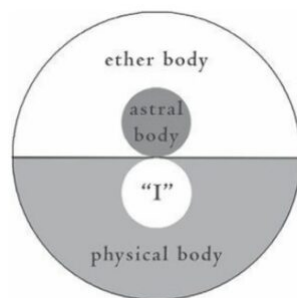
Meditations on the Tarot

The scholastic principle is that knowledge begins in the senses; from that base one may be led to the knowledge of the ideas. Some few will go beyond even that to an intuition, a direct knowing, of what is beyond even the ideas.

Analogously, spiritual ideas are first expressed in images, symbols, legends, and the like. These excite the Imagination, which is sufficient to most people. Some few will persist in understanding those figures in the imagination.

That leads to the stage of Inspiration. To return to the original idea, Dante started with the image of Beatrice who was not a real woman, or at least not real to him. Nevertheless, that inspired a huge creative output of philosophy and poetry, culminating in his masterpiece.

The final stage is Intuition, when he reaches into the highest heavens. In Intuition, the whole is grasped all-at-one, in its entirety. That is a long way from the physical effects that Beatrice's beauty elicited from him in his youth.



Individuation The process of Individuation involves the four primary archetypes: Ego, Shadow, Anima (or Animus), and Self. The intent is not to psychologize the attainments of the initiates. Nevertheless, the journey of the Spirit will have its reflection in the Soul. Therefore, it is helpful

to focus on phenomenological experiences, even if, ultimately, they are left behind. That occurs when Inspiration becomes Intuition, that is, the help of sensory images or thoughts are no longer necessary.

The path can be summarized, referring to the diagram on the right (from Valentin Tomberg):

- **Ego:** The I of the body, attentive to its needs. What is above the line is unconscious to it.
- **Shadow:** The knowledge of good and evil requires an adversary to push back. Catherine of Emmerich reveals this as an evil being, but not irredeemably evil.
- **Anima:** The unity is broken. A person of the opposite sex reunites.
- **Self:** The return to the Primordial State requires these elements to be integrated in the Self, represented by the circle.

Ego As Jung defines it, the Ego

forms the centre of the field of consciousness; and, in so far as this comprises the empirical personality, the ego is the subject of all personal acts of consciousness.

The Ego can arise only through thinking. Descartes' insight — *I think, therefore I am* — is correct. The intellectual soul is tied to the Ego. That is the spirit breathed into man that lights up consciousness; actually, the source of the light is the Holy Spirit. As the diagram shows, the undeveloped Ego is the I of the body. The etheric and astral bodies (vegetative and animal souls) are unconscious to it.

The esoteric student will be encouraged to recall the first time he had the awareness of being an I, i.e., a separate being. The long-term task is to bring the unconscious into awareness. This will develop a stable Self and beyond that, even higher states of being.

Shadow

The shadow is a moral problem that challenges the whole ego-personality, for no one can become conscious of the shadow without considerable moral effort. To become conscious of it involves recognizing the dark aspects of the personality as present and real.

Aion

Young children act spontaneously; there is no separation between emotion and response. Traditionally, there is no moral responsibility until around the age of seven. Thus, in the exoteric tradition, children begin confession at that age; that trains them in the task of becoming conscious of the Shadow.

Yet even that is insufficient. All negative emotions and thoughts, idle fantasies, and the like need to be brought into awareness.

Anima This is actually the Syzygy Anima-Animus, but I can only write from the male perspective. The Anima is the most difficult archetype to recognize. Like the physical member that requires a partner to be aroused, so also does the Anima. Mother, Nana, and Sister are the first to contribute to it.

The mother carefully inculcated into him the virtues of faithfulness, devotion, loyalty, so as to protect him from the moral disruption which is the risk of every life adventure.

Aion

Nevertheless, to remain at that level is to be infantile, so there must be more. The Anima contains the imagoes of Baubo, all his lovers, Divine Wisdom. Baubo returns in the infamous interrogation scene from *Basic Instinct*. She is hardly safe and consistent.

This perilous image of Woman belongs to him; she stands for the loyalty which in the interests of life he must sometimes forgo; she is the much needed compensation for the risks, struggles, sacrifices that all end in disappointment; she is the solace for all the bitterness of life.

And, at the same time, she is the great illusionist, the seductress, who draws him into life with her Maya — and not only into life's reasonable and useful aspects, but into its frightful paradoxes and ambivalences where good and evil, success and ruin, hope and despair, counterbalance one another. Because she is his greatest danger, she demands from a man his greatest, and if he has it in him, she will receive it.

Aion

Recall my childhood vision of the cave; the boy could wander about in the world and take risks, certain that he could find comfort and solace on his return. Now that the primal cave no longer exists, that boy needs to build his own cave and find a new source of solace.

Ancient myths, legends, and tales of chivalry portray tales of men having to prove themselves to his potential lover through various tasks, such as feats of bravery, strength, speed. Or perhaps he will praise her beauty and immortalize her in poems and stories. But she needs to be worth the trouble and few are.

The psychological process becomes complicated since it involves a quaternity: the real man and woman, the Anima, and the archetype of the Wise Old Man (or the Animus and archetype of the Chthonic Mother, often represented by Hecate).

That is why, esoterically, the actually existing woman can be a hindrance. The merely psychological level must be transcended. Then higher forces come into play: the Holy Spirit and Divine Sophia or Wisdom. Nay, they are not archetypes, but rather spiritual realities. Psychologically,

the Anima is perturbed with “frightful paradoxes and ambivalences”, and other psychic oscillations. The Holy Spirit is the light of consciousness, Wisdom is His reflection in the Anima. When the waters of the Anima are unperturbed, it perfectly reflects the Holy Spirit and something higher can be born.

Self Before the Shadow and Anima are integrated into consciousness, the true Self is also unconscious. The Ego believes he is “in charge”, even while he is buffeted by forces that are unknown or unclear to him. As the diagram above shows, the I needs to become master of the unconscious elements of the etheric and astral bodies. Unfortunately, this final stage of integration has its own dangers, so help is often required along the way.

It is of the greatest importance that the ego should be anchored in the world of consciousness and that consciousness should be reinforced by a very precise adaptation. For this, certain virtues like attention, conscientiousness, patience, etc., are of great value on the moral side, just as accurate observation of the symptomatology of the unconscious and objective self-criticism are valuable on the intellectual side.

Aion

This psychological Self is still short of the final goal. By transcending the psychological level, higher levels of the Self, with more integration, can be achieved. Ultimately, it leads to life before the Fall, the return to the Primordial State:

ET INCARNATUS EST DE SPIRITU SANCTO EX MARIA VIRGINE.

[The above formula] contains the trinity of the generator above, of the generant below, and the generated—or: the Holy Spirit, the Holy Virgin and the God-Man. It is at the same time the formula

of sacred magic in general, because it expresses the mystery of the union of divine will and human will in the element of blood.

VALENTIN TOMBERG, *Meditations on the Tarot*

Esoterically, blood is the physical organ of the human I.

Man is made in the image of God; the Self is the image of Christ in the soul.

Appendix: Polar Beings Often the guys will ask how they can get their girlfriends involved in their path. From experience, I don't see how that can be done. If you get along with your gf and she does not oppose your spiritual quest, that is probably a big success.

The esoteric teaching is that many women may be compatible physically but a much smaller number will be a good match for the soul. But there is only one Eve for Adam; she is your polar being. You will meet her once in your life. I suspect most of you have met her already, and are even with her now without fully realizing it. You need to be fully conscious to see it clearly. She may not be a woman "just like you", or how you think you are; rather, she will be just like your Anima. The more conscious you are of the Anima, the better will you recognize her.

Two souls who fully know each other become, in effect, a single I. This is the highest path.

Posted on 2020-12-11 by Cologero

* * *

Sibylle on 2020-12-23 at 07:46 said:

Thank you very much for this article. I do hope it will resonate with many readers. It certainly touched me since from the practical female perspective relationships remain very much stuck due to the lack of response a woman gets from the soul of a man. (And as a result of that even

the “remote control” loses its power, which in turn is interpreted as homo-bi-trans-whatever-sexuality whereas it is just a sign of the enormous distance a man put between himself and his body, let alone his soul.)

What if the cave is a cave full of men instead of women because men went into hiding? It seems impossible to find a woman resembling a man’s “Anima” if men refuse to leave the cave and allow that space to women. Of course you are talking about a man’s perspective and I absolutely understand that men are afraid of women. Especially nowadays with all this obnoxious behaviour by many females.

It really doesn’t contribute to a greater depth of a relationship though if men refuse to take care of themselves. The so called risk taking mentioned in this post does not happen anymore. As a result women need to compensate for the lack of respect men show towards themselves which makes any real intimacy impossible, because the active role becomes the woman’s role all along, not only when it comes to the level of the psyche. This change of behaviour makes attraction impossible even before the level of the soul is reached. Sexual attraction cannot arise when a woman needs to make up for a man’s missing self respect.

We all know the causes for this mess. However – “feminism” could never have happened with the enormous help of many so called intelligent men who could and should have known better. (But as we know: Every vote counts!) It cannot be left to women alone to clean up the mess. We need a hand. There can be no deeper revelation if there is no quest. Rusalka is a necessary first step. It is impossible to submit oneself if there is nothing to submit to. And believe me, the need for submission has never been greater (as mentioned here³).

It is something women give with great joy and very freely if there happens to be a receiver. However it is an act that arises from the occasion where it is needed, it can neither be forced nor demanded.

The “right” woman can only be “right” if she is needed. She can only be needed by someone who has left his cave. If you decide to stay in there, she cannot find you.

In this sense remaining faithful to love means remaining faithful to oneself in allowing this self to be known to itself before it can be revealed to others (a woman). When men don’t bother about themselves and remain in their caves women become superfluous. It’s planet Adam without the need for any sort of Eve. So imagine what it feels like to be a woman on such a planet. Everything a woman does can be accomplished better by a man. Even remaining in the cave. So why do we exist?

Cologero on 2020-12-23 at 17:27 said:

The knight Don Manuel de Leon retrieved a glove from a lion’s cage at the request of a Lady. He then slapped her for frivolously endangering the live of a knight.

³<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=8417>

Sibylle on 2020-12-24 at 08:11 said:

This slap probably taught the Lady more than a thousand words about the moral implications of her carelessness. Women never understand the effect they have upon men unless they receive their initiating slap. It is rather an act of information than of dominance.

The Lady will surely have remembered that Knight's slap as one of the most caressing moments of her life.

Santiago on 2022-06-07 at 00:21 said:

"...she is the solace for all the bitterness of life.

And, at the same time, she is the great illusionist, the seductress, who draws him into life with her Maya..."

Why must the Anima be both 'Madonna' and 'Whore'. How is it even possible for her to take up such a contradictory existence? In both dreams and real life, women are capable of the most radical transformations. I don't know how it's even possible to be both so enraptured by someone and yet to be made to experience such fear.

"The Anima contains the imagoes of Baubo, all his lovers, Divine Wisdom. Baubo returns in the infamous interrogation scene from Basic Instinct."

Some lovers more so than others; some I will never get over. Mainly from the perspective of dreams, the Anima's relationship with time is also worthy of note. Little forgotten details from years ago will be brought up, or I'm given little premonitions related to the upcoming days or weeks. Sometimes the similarities are even undeniable, beyond coincidence. It's like a game to her, and she responds to the interest I take.

And you hit the nail on the head. Every now and then, something analogous to the Basic Instinct scene does occur, but if I take the bait, holy hell does she make me pay for it. FWIW, I'm never allowed beyond that point. It's like a cruel test.

"The psychological process becomes complicated since it involves a quaternity: the real man and woman, the Anima, and the archetype of the Wise Old Man."

Kind of a technical question, but who is the 'Wise Old Man'. and how is he related to all this?

1.4 She who must be obeyed

From my earliest youth to the present time I have been aflame with the most exalted and noble love. My love was extremely difficult to bear: certainly not because of the cruelty of the lady I

loved but rather because of the overwhelming passion kindled in my mind by my unrestrained desire which often caused me to suffer more pain than was necessary.

GIOVANNI BOCCACCIO, *The Decameron*

Only loving like a pure madman can you continue along the road.
But how many times do you believe you love someone and in reality you love no one, not even yourself?

Nos: Book of the Resurrection

The Anima At the end of the *Letter I: The Magician*, **Valentin Tomberg** reveals that the Magician represents the man who has attained harmony and equilibrium between the spontaneity of the unconscious and the deliberate action of the Ego (conscious sense of I). This state of consciousness is the Self or Real I.

This process of individuation proceeds in stages described by Jung. The ultimate synthesis – speaking from the male point of view – is the integration of the Anima archetype, as described in *Two Essays on Analytical Psychology*. The archetypes are inborn in the psychic makeup, so the Anima is the image of the woman in the man. This is represented in three ways to be described later. But prior to conscious awareness, the Anima is a dark force, erupting into awareness as unexplained moods and other ways.

In meditation, one seeks to bring the I consciousness into the lower parts of being. In particular, there needs to be more awareness of the workings of the psyche or subconscious. There, one will find other beings, i.e., different “I’s” or different personalities, each claiming to be the true I.

Jung’s psychological approach is useful for this process, provided the limitations of psychology are understood. This post is concerned with just one part of the process, achieving harmony with the Anima. The first

things to note are any unexplained mood changes. Beyond that, there needs to be a deliberate encounter with the Anima. For example, initiating a conversation with Her and writing it down. In our workgroups, this has been effective; sometimes the effort results in a poem. Of course, careful attention to dreams is necessary; big dreams – i.e., those that have more than a personal content – should be logged.

Note that we have not recommended more books to read. We learn most effectively by trial and error. Ultimately, the Hermetic path is quite personal and one law for all would be oppression. One's book comes at the end of the exploration, not before. Tomberg describes the process:

The pure act in itself cannot be grasped; it is only its reflection which renders it perceptible, comparable and understandable or, in other words, it is by virtue of the reflection that we become conscious of it. The reflection of the pure act produces an inner representation, which becomes retained by the memory; memory becomes the source of communication by means of the spoken word; and the communicated word becomes fixed by means of writing, by producing the book.

Keep that in mind. The Anima is a mystery, and our verbal descriptions are of its inner representation. She cannot be exhausted by our verbosity.

She Jung refers to the character in **Rider Haggard's** novel *She* — the one who is called “She-who-must-be-obeyed” — as descriptive of the Anima. She is a mana personality, that is, “a being full of some occult and bewitching quality, endowed with magical knowledge and power.” This, Jung claims, is a projection of an unconscious self-knowledge, described this way:

I recognize that there is some psychic factor active in me which eludes my conscious will in the most incredible manner. It can put extraordinary ideas into my head, induce in me unwanted and

unwelcome moods and emotions, lead me to astonishing actions for which I can accept no responsibility, upset my relations with other people in a very irritating way, etc. I feel powerless against this fact and, what is worse, I am in love with it, so that all I can do is marvel.

Obviously, a man who has ever fallen so totally in love will recognize parts of himself in that description. But if he then manages to integrate the Anima, he will gain her mana. This will raise him archetypally to the “mighty man”, e.g., a hero, chief, magician, saint, ruler of men and spirits, a friend of God. It is one of those types that particularly interests us, viz:

Actually, it is the figure of the *magician* who attracts the mana to himself, i.e., the autonomous valency of the Anima.

Dante and other Initiatory Texts This teaching is certainly not novel. Rene Guenon mentions some European initiatory texts. Foremost among them are **Dante’s** *Divine Comedy* and the medieval poem, *The Romance of the Rose*. Both of them are focused, in differing ways, on the integration of the Anima.

For Dante, Beatrice was a projection of his Anima, an unreal woman who led him to higher states. Now Dante lived a man’s life: he raised a family, he was a warrior in the battles of the time, he was a poet, philosopher, mystic, and initiate in the *Fedeli d’Amore*. Boccaccio claimed Dante’s countenance displayed a Saturnine melancholy, not surprising in such a deep thinker.

Hence, his writings were not at all dry abstractions, but were taken from his own life. In his oeuvre as a whole, he describes people, personal events, dreams, impressions, etc. The trend of some Traditional writers to leave out the personal element as something inferior is not necessarily superior.

The Romance of the Rose is an allegorical poem about uniting with the Rose, despite a series of obstacles. Various personages representing,

for example, Reason, Genius, Friendship, the Old Woman, offer different opinions on the task. To regard it simply as an entertaining tale of romance would be a mistake.

Guenon also surprisingly mentions **Boccaccio**'s Decameron and **Rabelais**'s Gargantua and Pantagruel as other initiatory texts. They may be too ribald for some, but that may be a technique to hide the real meaning from the merely curious.

The main point, then, of all these works is to show how the integration with the Anima is essential on the Hermetic path.

The Blue Rose Folk tales often contain hidden wisdom unlike much of modern story telling that is cynical with ideologically inspired lessons. For example, *the Legend of the Blue Rose*⁴ is one such tale from China. Note how the lesson of the story is opposed to the commonly accepted serpentine wisdom of our time. For example, the gardener's son, in some MGTOW circles, would be mocked as being in the "friend zone", while the princess is really attracted to some "bad boy" who mistreats her. However, in the folk tale, the princess is psychologically healthier than Western woman today. She recognizes her real Animus and they live a happy life together.

Germanic Women **Tacitus** in *Germania*, sections 18 and 19⁵, describes the Germanic women of his time. Jung uses them as exemplars of this quality:

Woman, with her very dissimilar psychology, is and always has been a source of information about things for which a man has no eyes. She can be his inspiration; her intuitive capacity, often

⁴http://www.marilynkinsella.org/Fabulous%20Folktales/The%20Blue_rose.htm

⁵<https://www.gutenberg.org/files/7524/7524-h/7524-h.htm>

superior to man's, can give him timely warning, and her feeling, always directed towards the personal, can show him ways which his own less personally accented feeling would never have discovered.

Tacitus notes that the matrimonial bond is quite strict among the Germans, with monogamy being the norm. The woman is not the weak link in that relationship; rather she shares fully in their common life:

That the woman may not think herself excused from exertions of fortitude, or exempt from the casualties of war, she is admonished by the very ceremonial of her marriage, that she comes to her husband as a partner in toils and dangers; to suffer and to dare equally with him, in peace and in war: Thus she is to live; thus to die.

The society is based on chastity, with no "seductive spectacles", adultery is extremely rare and immediately punished. Young couples are expected to be virgins, so marriage is lifelong. They don't try to limit children through birth control, nor through infanticide as in other cultures.

That opposition to divorce, promiscuity, adultery, and birth control was very influential on the Roman church. Even the Greeks allow divorce and have been inconsistent on contraception. Of course, the neo-pagans believe in none of it.

A Modern Life The modern world tries to foist on us certain falsehoods presumably based on "science". One of them is that a man is genetically programmed for promiscuity. The traditional life of the Germanics reveals the lie. A real man protects his wife and children, desiring to keep them safe and secure, psychologically and spiritually, not just physically. The effeminate man seeks pleasure over protection; he is not our model.

Three Appearances of the Anima Friedrich Schlegel in his roman a clef *Lucinde*⁶ describes three appearances of the Anima: as Wife, as Mistress, and as âme-soeur. He recognized those three qualities in his wife Dorothy. That is, their relationship clicked on all three levels: hylic, psychical, and spiritual.

The imago of woman (the soul image) becomes a receptacle for these appearances which is why a man, in his love choice, is strongly tempted to win the woman who best corresponds to his own unconscious femininity—a woman, in short who can unhesitatingly receive the projects of his soul. ...it may turn out that the man has married his own worst weakness.

Wife and Mother A man's first female relationship is normally with his Mother. This imprints itself in his psyche:

His nearest relations, who exercise immediate influences over him, create in him an image which is only partly a replica of themselves, while its other part is compounded of elements derived from himself. The imago is built up of parental influences plus the specific reactions of the child; it is therefore an image that reflects the object with very considerable qualifications.

As he matures, that shifts, as Jung describes:

In place of the parents, woman now takes up her position as the most immediate environmental influence in the life of the adult man. She becomes his companion.

⁶See Section I.1 in this book.

Sexual Attraction The strongest impulse of the Anima is sexual attraction, which erupts into consciousness in various forms. This is exacerbated by the distortions of the psyche resulting from the fall.

The first is our imaginative faculty in the astral body (animal soul) which is given over to sexual fantasies of all types. These occlude the image of the Feminine as Sophia, while debasing her. She just has an instrumental value. Although a healthy relationship will involve visual, auditory, and tactile elements, these are used not for their attractive qualities to another human being, but rather as stimuli for personal pleasuring. So in Dante's case, his fantasy of Beatrice leads him to higher realms, whereas the fantasy of a so-called poet today (as in pop music) would be more suitable to for the Penthouse Letters.

Another distortion occurs even lower, in the etheric body (vegetative soul). A healthy eros will be oriented towards the Beloved. Most often, however, the eros is indiscriminate, and is attracted to women other than the Beloved. Moreover, the eros may even be directed to other objects, as in fetishes, for example. Since the eros is ideally intended for one specific person, artificial stimulation of the eros can be an obstacle to spiritual progress.

Polar Beings and Courtly Love Since the psychological is the reflection of something higher, the Anima needs to be understood in her spiritual reality. The story of Adam and Eve reveals this, since Eve is split off from Adam. She is then his spiritual double, the outer representation of his Anima. Although Jung's archetype is to be understood in a universal sense, it is also intensely personal.

With the Fall, this connection has been lost. This is meant in Tomberg's sense of the archetype that manifests itself endlessly both in history and in each individual. The task of the integration of the Anima becomes intertwined with finding one's twin soul or âme-soeur. **Boris Mouravieff** refers to that couple as Polar Beings. Drawing on Eastern Christian

traditions from Mount Athos, he asserts that at the general Resurrection, the human elite will be formed of polar couples. The meeting of the Polar Couple is a new initiation.

There is much esoteric effort required for that to happen. The first stage is the purification of one's own being. If you find that you are consistently entering into toxic relationships, that is likely due to defects in your own psyche, particularly with the Anima. We are not speaking here of so-called good relationships which are mostly a mutual agreement to "settle", which eliminates the element of risk, yet also prevents the full attainment of something higher.

This was understood much better in the Middle Ages with the ideal of Courtly Love involving the Knight (or Warrior) and the Lady of his Dreams. We have the Troubadours and the *Fedeli d'Amore* as examples. This was Love at the spiritual and objective level, beyond both the carnal and the psychological level.

The Knight and the Lady considered themselves to be spiritually united. Yet they renounced any idea of marriage as such. Typically, the social roles of wife, husband, mother, father were with someone else, not the Polar Being. Moreover, a physical relationship must be avoided as a sacrifice. This is emphatically not some "high-minded" Platonic love devoid of passion. Rather, the physical attraction is quite intense, so its renunciation can be quite painful.

The Knight and the Lady will meet each other once in their lives, but will seldom recognize each other, because they are not ready or have not advanced enough. Sometimes they are given a second chance and that must be obeyed.

Posted on 2018-06-29 by Cologero

* * *

Therion Exú Rei on 2018-07-23 at 15:40 said:

the anima is an archetype, archetypes are modes of perception and modes of function. Jung talks about 4 phases of the anima as an mode of perception, how men ig going to perceive the female sex.

they are represented by eva, helena of troy , maria and sophia.

In the first phase men is under the mother figure, the men in this phase is either a homosexual or a weak heterossexual. That kind of men that is submissive to the female figure. In the second phase the men can see woman as a truly sexual object, but he is under a more of an animal sexuality. In the 3 phase, very rare for modern men, it begins a higher perception, woman is see as a spiritual being, capable of rising men to a spiritual ground. In the fourth phase, is the *mysterium conjunctuns*!

Mikkel on 2018-07-28 at 10:52 said:

If we're talking about the Anima as Jung described I think the article puts out well that "Jung's psychological approach is useful for this process, provided the limitations of psychology are understood."

In his talking of phases as you've (Jung?) described, it seems limited and counter to the concept of unity of a principle vs. multiplicity which quickly spirals into talks of "progression". Perhaps these are not stages that follow from one to another or build on each other, but frames or perceptions of types of men who made them. As psychology is really based on some type of cure or understanding to help change an individual, perhaps we can see that stages or perceptions are different ways of being rather than focused on an individuals perspective? As representational, what do all the figures mentioned represent or say about the spirit that illustrated the feminine with their description as true, perhaps these descriptions of the phases here shows more about the type of spirit and how closely related they are to principle rather than a quality of the feminine being illustrated as truth, albeit the stages described have truth to them, but essentially why do certain people see them that way?

Michael on 2020-11-04 at 11:12 said:

Circling back to this..."Typically, the social roles of wife, husband, mother, father were with someone else, not the Polar Being. Moreover, a physical relationship must be avoided as a sacrifice."

How does this work with "Schlegel and his wife, Dorothy, turned that common wisdom on its head by incorporating all three aspects into a single relationship."

Seems like an example of turning common wisdom on its head, but perhaps closer to a synthesis we hear the words of M. (paraphrased) : "All must be sacrificed, but we have not said all must be broken."

1.5 Astray in the Human Jungle

Turn every negativity to your profit.

ST JOHN CLIMACUS

Courtly love can be effective only if it is based on a Gnosis which is lived, for only a lived Gnosis, on that has been acquired through experience and has gone down into the heart—one joined with Hope that is founded on Faith—will ensure that the knight will have the discernment which will prevent him from going astray in the jungle of purely human reasoning and feelings.

BORIS MOURAVIEFF

As we pointed out last time, a consistent theme has been the development of the sense of Self or the Real I. Along with that, we have used the idea of the possibility of using feminine energy as the means for that development. This started, actually, in our first real post on Lucinde by **Friedrich Schlegel**⁷. The difference between masculine and feminine spirituality should be clear by now. The former, as described by **Julius Evola** in particular, involves an act of possession of what appears to be a lack, but is really a privation.

The feminine, on the other hand, is more concerned with filling that lack, always in a passive way. Thus, the movement based around a “Law of Attraction” has gained ground in recent years. Its teachers claim that the “universe” will satisfy the lack, presumably in some automatic and predictable way. A recent encounter may serve to illustrate these things more clearly, while providing concrete examples for Evola’s and Michelstaedter’s abstractions⁸.

⁷See Section 1.1 in this book.

⁸<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7338>

Rhetoric and the Feminine Consciousness Not so long ago, I heard from a woman — let's call her Erica — who had discovered the Meditations on the Tarot web site. Since she was very interested in that topic, she contacted me to discuss it. She gobbled up all the articles and was full of praise. I gave her the source and she bought the book immediately. After a week of exchanging emails, we agreed to meet for dinner at a posh Palm Beach restaurant.

It would be easy to believe that she had won some sort of genetic lottery. A former internationally known cover girl, she still retained her beauty, and was cultured, elegant, with a sharp intelligence. A true cosmopolitan, she had lived in several different countries. Yet, there was still something deeply sad about her. There was a malaise, bordering on spiritual acedia. She managed to keep it so deeply hidden, I was unable to intuit exactly what it was, given the short time we spoke in person. Nevertheless, she was quite spiritual and claimed to be fully committed to her Catholic faith.

She was a bit intimidated by the Tarot commentary, so she asked me where she could find the “kindergarten” to begin her studies. I assured her that the education she received at her convent school was more than enough kindergarten. Tomberg gives us a deeper understanding of just what she would have learned in her religion classes.

She seemed quite pleased to hear that.

The Feminine Path When she began describing her own comparable spiritual undertakings, we could see our differences arise. It should surprise no readers that she had taken an active interest in areas such as the development of psychic powers, angels, crystals, and so on, that is, the whole gamut of the new age. Apparently, there is a college in London that claims to teach such things. Just as in our interview with Aphrodite⁹,

⁹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7197>

she, too, was interested in exotic stones from around the world and their alleged effects on the various chakras.

I mentioned that she was following a very feminine path, whereas Medtarot and Gornahoor are quite masculine. That she agreed with, even pointing out that the men at her psychic studies college were less masculine. The fundamental difference is this: feminine forms are interested in seeking experiences, visions, good feelings, and so on. The masculine paths, on the other hand, are interested in transcending the human condition altogether.

Chakras and the Hero Let's look at the chakra studies, for example. Different stones are supposed to correspond to different chakras, which in their turn, correspond to the various endocrine glands. Of course, it is "all good", and there is no concern about artificially stimulating the lower forces or inadvertently triggering a higher chakra before the person is ready and prepared to deal with those energies.

For example, if the lower chakras represent subconscious or animalistic forces, as **Carl Jung** says, we are not "honoring the earth" by placing our own selves under their power. Obviously, if everything is "good", if everything is to be "honored", then there is no place in this world for the Hero. The Hero knows what is good and evil, what is honorable and dishonorable. Without such distinctions, there is no reason for the quest. That is why the modern mind, in particular, has gone astray in the jungle of purely human reasoning and feelings. And since Christ is the archetype of the Hero, this message is profoundly anti-Christian. Here is Jung, speaking to Miguel Serrano:

Do you know what the Self is for Western man? It is Christ, for Christ is the archetype of the hero, representing man's highest aspiration. All this is very mysterious and at times frightening.

So to the extent that the West loses its faith in Christ, it also denies the Hero. It then denies that man has any high aspirations, since the basest

things are now celebrated and honored. All this to avoid the mysterious and the scary. The remaining Knights in the world accept the mysterious and move forward despite the terror.

Chakra Energies I'm not denying that such energies exists, just that the stone is not its source. In that system, the I, or Self, is passive. Hence, the stone, or endocrine gland, must be vibrated from the outside in order to produce some effect on the Self. However, the stone represents a privation, a lack of understanding our own psychic centers, so we project our own energies onto the stone. If there is energy blockage in the psychic centers, the better course is to deal with them internally, with the Self as the active force, not to rely on external factors to do that work of self-awareness and self-development for us. This whole line of thought is an example of the lack of self-possession.

In his meeting with Miguel Serrano, Carl Jung offers a deeper commentary on the chakras, which he considers as purely psychic centers of consciousness, not physical entities associated with endocrine glands. He pointed out the interesting point that different cultures may be centered on different chakras, in this sense. As an example, he referred to a discussion with a Pueblo Indian chief, who criticized white people for thinking with their heads. For him, only crazy people think with their heads, and normal people think from their hearts.

A very interesting point that Jung made is that the ancient Greeks also thought with their hearts. This means that it is literally impossible for a contemporary scholar to understand ancient Western culture, to the extent that he is dominated by his head. One must learn, first, to think with one's heart.

Yet, there is something even more appropriate, certainly due to synchronicity. Jung goes on so say this about contemporary Westerners:

They think only with their tongues. They think only with words, with words which today have replaced the Logos.

That may take some time to fully sink in, and is worth an entire article. But basically, he is describing those under the influence of “rhetoric” in Michelstaedter’s sense. Rhetoric has now replaced the Logos, through whom all things are created, with an artificial ideology. You see, we are back to the illusions of the causal body¹⁰, although from a different angle.

Rhetoric and Psychoanalysis It is curious that Erica knew nothing of this, although she has been undergoing Jungian analysis for over five years. That can’t be cheap, especially since her therapist made house calls. Moreover, she has had another analyst for decades, but can’t use him all the time due to his exorbitant rates. She made sure I understood that her analysis was expensive.

However, that is mere rhetoric to me. I was more interested in the process. I asked her the obvious question, “Did she understand the goal of Jungian therapy?” Her immediate confusion showed me that she had never even thought about that at all. Of course, the goal of Jungian analysis is the creation of the Self, beyond the Ego, through the process of individuation.

Magic Weddings So I offered to help her through the process of individuation, since great gains can be made in our era through Courtly Love, i.e., a common spiritual journey shared by the Knight and his Lady. For misplaced Knights, born in a place and time where they no longer have a role, this would be their best path. I’m afraid I don’t have the requisite degrees or certificates, and I certainly do not overcharge. As I said, there is no acknowledgment of Knights in our day. Now, in therapy, the male role is taken by the psychologist; I don’t see how a female therapist, as in her case, can be the catalyst for that process.

Serrano builds on Jung’s idea with his own description of the magic

¹⁰<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7224>

wedding. In some ways, he comes close to Tomberg's idea¹¹ that the fruit of the union of the male and female principles in consciousness gives birth to the Logos, the Christ within, which Jung claims is the archetype of hero in the West. That is the true self.

While both Jung and Serrano describe this wedding in terms of an alchemist and the mystical sister, a physical female is not absolutely essential from the male perspective.

Man is self-sufficient, since in him the anima is the passive element. To give birth to the True Self, the anima must be pacified so that it can receive the imprint of a higher source. That is why Jung says that a physical woman is not absolutely necessary for the individuation process. Rather, she is a privation, so the energy of the anima exists in the man and can be claimed in an act of self-possession.

The situation is different in a woman. For her the anima is the active element. So to make it the passive element would force her to no longer be a woman, psychically. That is why she needs a man to complete the individuation process, and that role was usually taken up by the analyst.

Posted on 2014-06-09 by Cologero

1.6 The Beautiful Soul

In order to satisfy a social obligation, I saw the movie *RIPD*¹² last week (no, I don't recommend it). Although it has no deeper meaning, we can possibly insert one for it. Although I doubt and such meaning was consciously assumed by the creators, it is possible that higher powers subtly influenced them. The premise of the film is that there are walking dead among us, men without souls, or actually souls so ugly they would be

¹¹<https://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/the-word-is-made-flesh>

¹²https://www.imdb.com/title/tt0790736/?ref_=nv_sr_srsq_0

better off without them. Hence, it is no great gift to be able to see men's souls.

In the film, the dead souls create an artifact whose purpose is to call the ugly souls back to the earth. It is powered by the blood of, if not exactly a virgin, at least an innocent woman. Eerily, these are two themes that we have mentioned. The first is the idea that there are hungry ghosts¹³ about, since they are no longer revered by their ancestors. The second is the idea of the problem of births¹⁴, and how spirits are attracted to specific material and psychic conditions following the law of affinity.

The Medieval period attracted souls destined to salvation and so attracted nobles, saints, knights, contemplatives, hermetists, etc. However, it also attracted the rebels, those opposed to all order and authority. That is the spiritual battle that was eventually lost. The rebels, beginning with Luther, through the French and Soviet revolutions made possible the births of new types of souls. This will sound incredible to the modern mind because it seems unscientific on the surface and goes against all notions of egalitarianism. He prefers to see this trend as the "evolution" of man. In a sense he is correct, but in a sense opposite to what he intended. It has to do with the "survival of the fittest", and only certain types of souls are fit for the current ugly environment. This is what Guenon means by "compossible".

Nevertheless, the modern world also attracts a band of counterrevolutionary warriors ready to do spiritual battle. Unfortunately, they come ill prepared. They lack the resources for spiritual development and often grasp at any ideas that sound plausible. They are disorganized and hence fall prey to the various counter Traditional movements that claim to be on the right. These are the ones who must be awakened to their destiny. Whatever the modern world hates, they should probably love; whatever the modern world despises and condemns, is probably where the truth

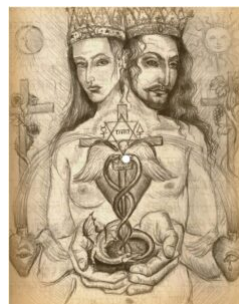
¹³<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2507>

¹⁴<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1664>

lies hidden.

So that they don't flounder like the mass of men today, the secret counterrevolutionaries need to develop their sense of "I" and their will. This is the alchemical task of the creation of the homunculus which is generated through the alchemical marriage. Now there is a lot of ineffective erudition surrounding alchemy, because it can never be understood without doing the "lab work". Of course, lab work is not the same as that done by the "puffers", but really through the efforts of the alchemical transformation of one's own consciousness.

This is the marriage of the spirit, which is masculine, and the soul ("anima"), which is feminine. We have mentioned the fruits of this task many times in conjunction with Tomberg's Meditations on the Holy Spirit, the Virgin, and the birth of the Christ. That is the religious teaching on the macro level, but on the micro level, i.e., the esoteric teaching, it has a different significance. It is about the birth of one's true self, putting on the mind of Christ. Yet, there is that old joke about where can you find a virgin today? Hence, that is the first alchemical task, the beginning of the "lab work", which involves the purification of the soul, i.e., a virginal soul.



Anyone who has been reading attentively will have an idea of what that entails. This does not mean that the task is easy and without risks. What is understood in the abstract does not necessarily transfer to self-understanding. The ego, the false self, has been carefully constructed over a lifetime and serves as a sort of buffer zone to protect the psyche from the lower psychic elements in the environment. Unfortunately, it also protects the self from hearing anything higher.

Without the feedback and support of a group, there are dangers in this. First of all, as the egoic psyche is broken up, there is a real danger

of insanity unless something higher and more solid can replace it. Another danger is that the ego, while resisting its dissolution, will still claim ownership of higher states; this is a form of ego inflation. There is no point to continue in this vein. Nevertheless, the prize is worth the game for those who persist. Once devoid of subjectivity, negative emotions, irrational fears, unsupportable opinions, and so on, a man is able to operate freely in the world, secure in himself. What a group of such men can accomplish is not yet known.

I have never asked a woman for money. I have often asked for her soul, which she willingly gives, probably because she believes it doesn't cost anything. She doesn't realize that she is the man's soul; a man mistakenly assumes he wants the body, when it is really completeness that is his true desire.

A man is complete in himself, at least virtually. He has both an X and a Y chromosome, so he can create both the male and the female. As below, so above, so he also comprises both possibilities spiritually. The woman, with two X chromosomes, can only beget another woman. Only a miracle, the action of the spirit on her can beget a male child, the I, the true Self.

For this to occur, the woman must be compliant or must be made compliant. Such a woman is beautiful, and the man who has possessed her, has a beautiful soul. St Theresa d'Avila claimed that if you could see your soul in its purity, you would think you saw God.

The meeting of the spirit and the soul is the sign of the cross, the soul moving horizontally and the Spirit descending vertically until they meet and join together. Yet that initial meeting is incomplete, as they still must take part in the alchemical marriage, the *mysterium coniunctionis*.

Posted on 2013-07-23 by Cologero

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JA on 2013-07-24 at 19:27 said:

Cologero, how would you differentiate on the esoteric level between the alchemical marriage and the "pandrogony" of a Genesis P-Orridge ? or some aspects of transgender (people that claim to be both male and female)...also what do you make of this Gurdjieff-derived teaching that apparently claims the Maitreya Buddha will be some sort of transsexual ?

<http://www.eboards4all.com/717093/messages/49634.html>

Cologero on 2013-07-24 at 22:44 said:

Since you want to bring Gurdjieff into it, he wrote that this obsession with sex is the cause of mechanicalness and self-deception:

At the same time sex plays a tremendous role in maintaining the mechanicalness of life. Everything that people do is connected with 'sex'. politics, religion, art, the theater, music, is all 'sex'. Do you think people go to the theater or to church to pray or to see some new play? That is only for the sake of appearances. The principal thing, in the theater as well as in church, is that there will be a lot of women or a lot of men. This is the center of gravity of all gatherings. What do you think brings people to cafés, to restaurants, to various fetes? One thing only. Sex: it is the principal motive force of all mechanicalness. All sleep, all hypnosis, depends upon it.

Ultimately, what counts is not talking about it, but rather actually achieving something. If you want to believe that Genesis P-Orridge is some enlightened being, then you can follow his path and send us a postcard every now and then describing your progress.

The alchemical marriage is about the transmutation of inner states, not corporeality. Maybe not what you want to hear, but if you get your inner life organized, the outer will follow.

JA on 2013-07-25 at 00:49 said:

Cologero I hope you have not the wrong impression of me ! As a man and as a warrior if you are insinuating what I suppose you may be insinuating if we knew each other in person I might have to challenge to a duel to defend my honour !

Back to the matter at hand, you've made a definitive answer in that true enlightenment is in the interior. Too many "occultists" (P-Orridge whom I mentioned but many many others as well) focus on the body. Decadence disguised as Tantra as you've mentioned before. I'm interested to hear your upcoming commentaries on the Serrano book which I have read before.

I am on the right track as I don't particularly think about sex all that much in my life, if I talk about it's because I am bewildered by the heroin-like cravings I see in those around me.....

CaseyAnn on 2013-10-22 at 20:00 said:

Hi Cologero,

I think there's a typo here:

"Now there is a lot of ineffective erudition surrounding alchemy, because it can never be understood with doing the 'lab work.'"

I assume you meant "it can never be understood without doing the 'lab work.'" (At least, that's the only way it makes sense to me in the surrounding context.)

Blessings

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Thanks for picking up on that. It is now fixed. – Cologero

Metaphysics of Love

2.1 Fedele d'Amore and the Tantric Path

The *Fedele d'Amore* was an initiatic society of Italian poets, and Dante was the most prominent among them. For these poets, the image of the beloved revealed the Divine Sophia, thereby awakening higher stages of consciousness. For Dante, it was Beatrice who served as his guide.

A similar tradition existed among the Islamic poets. Ibn Arabi had his Nizam, the beautiful and intelligent daughter of a patron. For Hafiz, it was the vision of the beautiful daughter of a nobleman that led to his vocation as poet and mystic.

Some suspect a direct connection between the Sufis and Dante. However, Dante learned his craft from the Sicilian poets in the court of the Viking Holy Roman Emperor, Frederick II, in Palermo. Since Sicily had previously been ruled by the Arabs, it is not unreasonable to postulate an indirect connection through those Sicilian poets. However, a typological similarity does not necessarily involve an historical connection.

In an attempt to clarify and justify such a spiritual way, I will list the

major ways.

The Way of the Fakir The way of the Fakir involves the use of physical austerities to develop concentration and will. This is continued in certain practices of Christian monks who use painful tourniquets or among Orthodox Jews who wear abrasive underwear. Although certain powers and a strong will can follow from such practices, as the Buddha discovered, they are insufficient to lead to full awakening.

The Way of the Monk The way of the Monk uses devotional practices and rituals to transcend ordinary life. In this way, the emotions can be purified and lower desires transcended. The study of theology can lead to sound doctrine and a steady mind. However, this type of knowing is still at the level of the rational mind or faith, and does not rise to the level of gnosis or Wisdom.

The Way of the Yogi The way of the Yogi is what is most commonly recognized as the ultimate spiritual path. The Yogi transcends all the personal or individual states of being, and may become a *jivan-mukti* — that is, someone enlightened while still in the body. More commonly, such states are not permanent, and usually involve a series of epiphanies that leave an indelible mark on consciousness. The examples of Plotinus and Solovyov come to mind.

This way is what Guenon describes, and is characteristic of the Brahmin caste.

The Way of the Knight This is the way of someone active in the world, and is characteristic of the Kshatriya, the way favored by Evola. It involves both the development of the intellect and the will. Since all material effects have their origin in spiritual causes, this path requires not only a deep understanding of the world of spirit, but also the power and

courage to bring such ideas into manifestation. Furthermore, it is only through the power of the human will that the will of the angels (or gods) can manifest on the plane of human consciousness.

Although this path involves the whole being, and may be sufficient in itself, since it deals with the action of the world-soul or Sophia, there is often something lacking. That is why the knights of yore took up the practice of courtly love.

The Way of Tantrika This is the most mysterious way, little known until recent times, and subject to many misconceptions. It is usually confused with pure sensuality, whereas its real aim is the development of power through the harnessing of sexual or attractive energies, particularly the power to bring cosmic ideation into material manifestation.

Often women are attracted to the sensual nature, particularly if they have been introduced to certain tantric practices prematurely. (It is not so important for men.)

The other manifestation of this way is Sex Magick. However, in practice this devolves to little more than a sexualized way of the Fakir. For example, Aleister Crowley's descriptions of sex magick¹ are hardly appealing and turn out to be little more than tedious sexual gymnastics. Certain powers appropriate to the Fakir may be developed in this way, but it is ultimately self-limiting.

The true way of Tantrika involves a Knight and a Lady, who participate on the path together. Indications of this are give by Miguel Serrano² and Boris Mouravieff in **Gnosis**. Further elaboration of this topic must await future essays.

Posted on 2010-06-23 by Cologero

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¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?cat=51>

²Section 3,3 in this book.

Will on 2010-06-24 at 12:09 said:

I agree that Dante used his love for Beatrice as a path to the Divine, but I'm not convinced that the Fedele d'Amore were an initiatic organization. It seems difficult to make that case in regards to Guido Cavalcanti, for example. Do you know of a good source of information about this?

Your point about possible Sufi influence on Dante is well-made. A Spanish author in the 1920s made the case for Dante having effectively 'stolen' the work of Ibn Arabi, but I tend to take a more Traditionalist approach that if their insights coincide, it points to a common realization rather than simple borrowing.

It seems to me that the way Dante used his love for Beatrice as a method or technique – a love that was never physically consummated – has a parallel in Plato's descriptions of the erotic ascent, which also involve using the energies of sexual desire and appreciation of beauty to open a path to the Divine. The Phaedrus and Symposium both contain striking descriptions of this.

And by the way, the translation of *The Individual and the Becoming of the World* is great. Thanks for making it available.

Will on 2010-06-24 at 18:35 said:

Do we know that the Fedele d'Amore were an initiatic organization? While it seems clear that Dante used his love for Beatrice as a path to Divine Love, I'm not sure if we can say that Guido Cavalcanti and the other poets were engaged in similar practices. Can you refer me to any good sources on this?

I am struck by the similarity of Dante's method to the one described by Plato in the Phaedrus and Symposium. He also advocates using the energies of sexual desire and appreciation of beauty to open a path to the Divine. I wonder if perhaps the Sufi practices you mention were not influenced by the Platonic tradition. After all, the Muslim world was the keeper of ancient Greek philosophy at this time.

Regardless, I am in agreement that just because Dante and Ibn Arabi and Plato share similar insights, it does not mean there was any direct influence. Rather, it speaks to a common realization, or a kind of 'objective metaphysics.'

Cologero on 2010-06-27 at 11:20 said:

Are you familiar with "Insights into Christian Esoterism", where Rene Guenon includes several chapters about the Fedeli d'Amore under the heading of "Some Christian Initiatic Organizations"? There is simply too much information to be summarized in a comment.

In "The Esoterism of Dante", Guenon writes:

The history of the Hermetic tradition is intimately linked to that of the Orders of Chivalry, and was preserved at the time in question by initiatic organizations such as the *Fede Santa* and

the **Fedeli d'Amore** ,..

You can also look at the reference to Dante in Evola's "The Hermetic Tradition".

Your insights are good, and you should see the connections between "love", "eros", the "woman", "Wisdom". Solovyov has similar insights and tried to bring them into the outer church. Even Auguste Comte, in his strange way, stumbled on a rudimentary understanding of this symbolism.

Will on 2010-06-27 at 20:46 said:

Thank you. I have read Guenon's book on Dante, but not the other that you mention. I am also largely ignorant of Comte and Solovyov, so I will add them to my list of thinkers to look into.

When I was doing research on Dante a couple years ago, the most helpful sources that I found were *The Metaphysics of Dante's Comedy* by Christian Moevs, Titus Burckhardt's essay "Because Dante Is Right," and Henry Corbin's *Creative Imagination in the Sufism of Ibn Arabi*, in which he has some discussion of Beatrice as a "theophanic" figure.

This is the article that led me to Corbin's work:

<http://henrycorbinproject.blogspot.com/2009/02/corbin-dante-i-fedeli-damore.html>

The author of this piece makes similar claims about the Fedele d'Amore, and says that Guido Cavalcanti was their leader. However, when I read Cavalcanti's poetry (albeit in English translation) it seemed to lack the transcendent dimension that so dominates Dante's work.

This, of course, does not mean that he wasn't an initiate or that the Fedeli d'Amore was not an initiatic organization. Perhaps Cavalcanti failed where Dante had succeeded in growing his earthly love up to the heavens. Or perhaps he did not fail, and his realization simply took a different expression which is not as externally religious as Dante's.

I don't pretend to fully understand this method, but from what I can see, I think you are right to compare it to Tantra. Some Buddhist lineages teach a method wherein one views the whole phenomenal world as one's lover. Still other tantric methods involve viewing one's lover as an enlightened being, and thereby practicing 'pure view.' The idea, as I understand it, is that when one falls in love, it is due to the enlightened nature shining through, and so one can use that as part of the path, trying to extend the appreciation and pure vision one naturally feels towards the beloved towards all of existence.

Cologero on 2010-06-27 at 21:17 said:

There is an excellent book that contains commentary and all of Solovyov's works on Sophia, published as "Divine Sophia" by Judith Kornblatt.

I am not recommending Comte without reservation, as he was somewhat of a strange character. I have a quirky interest in him because he was also a mathematician and for his counter-revolutionary views. He was not a Traditionalist. Nevertheless, I was quite pleased to

read a favorable essay about Comte by Solovyov; so there are at least two of us who noticed the same thing about Comte.

For an overview of Comte see here: Auguste Comte³.

Will on 2010-06-27 at 22:35 said:

Vladimir Solovyov sounds like a fascinating person. I will check out the book you recommended.

Here is a nice quote from Henry Corbin on this matter:

"In ... 1201 when he reached Mecca, the first goal of his pilgrimage, Ibn 'Arabi was thirty-six years of age.... He received the hospitality of a noble Iranian family from Ispahan, the head of the house being a shaikh occupying a high post in Mecca. This shaikh had a daughter who combined extraordinary physical beauty with great spiritual wisdom. She was for Ibn 'Arabi what Beatrice was to be for Dante; she was and remained for him the earthly manifestation, the theophanic figure, of Sophia aeterna.... For theophanism there is no dilemma, because it is equally far removed from allegorism and literalism; it presupposes the existence of the concrete person, but invests that person with a function which transfigures him, because he is perceived in the light of another world."

And from Seyyed Hossein Nasr:

"The beauty of woman is, for spiritual man, an unveiling of the beauty of the paradise that he carries at the center of his being ... She is the theophany of esotericism and, in certain modes of spirituality, Divine Wisdom ... reveals itself to the gnostic as a beautiful woman."

2.2 Fedeli d'Amore

To every heart which the sweet pain doth move,
And unto which these words may now be brought
For true interpretation and kind thought,
Be greeting in our Lord's name, which is Love.

DANTE, *from his initiation poem to the Fedeli d'Amore*

The various 'ladies' celebrated by the poets attached to the mysterious organization of the Fedeli d'Amore from Dante, Guido

³<http://www.gornahoor.net/library/AugusteComte.pdf>

Cavalcante, and their contemporaries to Boccaccio and Petrarch, are not women who actually lived on this earth but are all, under different names, one and the same symbolic 'Lady'. who represents transcendent Intelligence or Divine Wisdom.

RENE GUENON, *Insights into Christian a Esoterism*

It was necessary to write a poem in order to be initiated into the Fedeli d'Amore. In 1283, Dante sent the group a poem about a dream he had, asking for an interpretation. In his dream Amor (Love) appeared with Beatrice. He received several responses and was allowed into the group.

Alchemy The Divine Comedy can be regarded as an alchemical work, since it describes, the transformation of human matter to the gold. There is this correspondence with the alchemical process:

- **Nigredo:** inferno, the fire that burns
- **Albedo:** purgatory, the fire that purifies
- **Rubedo:** heaven, the creative fire of love

There has been speculation about Dante's ties to the Knights Templar. We are not really interested in the conspiracy theories or any external evidence. Rather, for us, what matters is the internal evidence. Esoteric works contain "Easter Eggs", i.e., unexpected clues that are the key to the deeper meaning.

The obvious connection link is **Saint Bernard of Clairvaux**, who was both the spiritual director of the Templars and Dante's final guide. Dante chose St Bernard as his final guide to indicate his affinity to the Templars. Before exploring the transformation described by the Fedeli d'Amore, there are some items that may seem speculative initially.

Satanic Trinity Satanic trinity is the ape of the Divine Trinity. It is depicted as the three headed Satan. These refer to Lucifer, Mephistopheles or Ahriman, and one unnamed for now.

The Female Trinity The other trinity consists of Mary, Lucia, and Beatrice.

Mary is the second Eva. This is also indicated in the Ave, which is the reverse spelling of Eva.

St Lucia is an interesting insertion, since “Lucia” is the anagram of acuil (=aquila), the eagle. **Valentin Tomberg** deals with the symbolism of the eagle in the Empress card. For example,

The eagle shows the aim of magical power; it is its emblem and its motto, which reads: “Liberation in order to ascend”. Together they represent a magnificent flight; they aim, as a whole and each taken individually, at the ideal of the sublimation of human nature.

“The science of LOVE” is the sceptre of the Empress, which represents the means by which the aim of magic is attained.

Beatrice is the celestial reflection of Dante’s first love, and stands for Wisdom.

The Troubadours and the Sicilian School Although the ideal of love in spiritual literature is ancient (Song of Songs, for example), the more immediate precursors of the Fedeli d’Amore were the Troubadours of Southern France. They sang of Courtly love, which was based on nobility and chivalry.

Its roots go back to the French Troubadours, whose theme was always courtly love between a Lady and a Knight. Courtly love was [and is?] experienced as erotic attraction mixed with spiritual attainment. However, the relationship was not sexually consummated. Rather, the knight

sought the admiration of his Lady through his deeds and accomplishments, often undergoing ordeals at her request.

The same theme was adapted by the Sicilian School⁴ under the patronage of Holy Roman Emperor **Frederick II**. They invented the sonnet form, and an initiate had to write a sonnet in order to be accepted into the school. This spread to the *Fedeli d'Amore* where Dante perfected the sonnet form.

Polar Beings There are three levels of attraction between a man and a woman: carnal, psychic, and courtly or spiritual love. Carnal love, obviously, desire the physical act and nothing more. With psychic love, there is an emotional connection. Traditionally, there has always been a period of engagement before the couple has carnal relations, despite their strong physical attraction.

The deeper the connection, the more creativity is expressed in the relationship. **Boris Mouravieff** describes this phenomenon:

On all planes, the objective sign of Love's participation is the creative spirit which animates the subjects for whom it has become an aim. Conversely, if we think we are in Love but objectively do not notice an increase in creativity on any plane, either in ourselves or in our partner, we can be sure that the relationship is based on anything but Love.

Tomberg likewise asserts that true creativity cannot exist without love. Emotional bonds may fade, but there is a higher love between polar beings. In this case the commitment is much deeper:

The Knight and the Lady of his dreams, whether they are so in truth or honestly claiming to be so, must endeavour to act in all circumstances of their inner and outer life as if they were already

⁴https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sicilian_School

united in their consciousness of the real I, which is indivisible although bipolar, and ONE for their two Personalities and their two bodies.

A Polar couple will meet each other once in their lifetimes, but will seldom recognize each other. The Knight must learn to see the image of his Lady in his consciousness, and vice versa. Even when they do meet, there may still be obstacles. That is due to the deformations in their inner being and different karmic burdens.

Transformation Carnal love is connected to the etheric body (vegetative soul) and psychic love to the astral body (animal soul). In the fallen state, these two bodies are under the influence of demonic spirits indifferent to, or even opposed to, human attainment. The etheric body will create images in the astral body, or the astral body may be so overcome with emotion that it does not seek anything higher.

This is the clue to the alchemical transformation. The etheric and astral bodies need to be purified. Eva represents the astral body in the Fall, so the opposite of the Fall is Mary. The goal, then, is the transmutation of the chaotic soul into the pure mirror of the divine word.

For the individual, this will be the development of the Real I. For the polar couple, they will develop the I together.

Posted on 2018-09-16 by Cologero

2.3 A Theory of Love

The Temptation of Love is to overwhelm the lovers, to hypnotise them as it were, and reduce them willing or unwilling, to a state of passivity which is actually, in the end, the state they desire.

CHARLES WILLIAMS

In our current age of extremes, in which MGTOW and dogmatic feminism each seems reasonable positions to their proponents, we can forget how previous generations understood the ideal of Romance between men and women.

Charles Williams and Romantic Theology The Inkling **Charles Williams** wrote a thesis that attempted to provide an outline for Romantic Theology, which he regarded as a new branch of the subject. Although he could not find a publisher in his lifetime, it was published about a dozen years ago. The theological part of the book is rather conventional, so is less interesting to me. However, Williams' real skill is in literary criticism. He mentions **Plato's** *Symposium* and *Phaedrus* as well as the *Zohar* as valuable to his topic. However, since they are not explicitly Christian, he does not make use of them. Instead, he refers to three "masters" in particular:

- **Dante**
- *La Morte d'Arthur* by **Malory**
- **John Donne**

Williams describes Donne as a writer of "love-poetry expressing itself in a religious vocabulary." Besides Donne, Williams looks at several other poets; however, it would be too distracting to cover them in this piece.

Since Williams wrote an influential study of Dante, *The Figure of Beatrice*, it is no surprise to see him as the first Master. Dante, he says, "is the spring of all modern love literature." Unfortunately, Williams doesn't follow the trail back to the Sicilian poets who influenced Dante, and beyond them, even, to the Troubadours. On the



other hand, Dante did it better than his predecessors. He had the ability for deep introspection as well as the ability to express it in words. This is how Dante described his falling in love with Beatrice:

I say that when she appeared from any place, there was no enemy remaining to me, but a flame of *caritas* possessed me, which made me pardon anyone who had offended me; and if anyone had then asked me concerning anything, my answer would have been only Love, with a face clothed in humility.

La Vita Nuova

The story of King Arthur's knights, with the quest for the grail, needs to be unravelled. Williams uses three of the knights to illustrate the different degrees of love.

- **Bors:** love in marriage.
- **Percival:** love between two persons who are in contemplation of, but without desire for, each other, their desire being only towards God
- **Galahad:** love whose contemplation and desire is alike towards nothing but God

Three Degrees of Marriage

There is no accepted agreement upon what the state which our grandfathers used to call 'falling in love' involves. It is neither sex appetite pure and simple; not, on the other hand, is it necessarily related to marriage. It is something like a state of adoration.

CHARLES WILLIAMS

I suspect that his grandfathers believed that love led to marriage, but to understand Williams' larger point, we can look at the evolution of the idea of marriage.

- **Age of the Father:** Divorce and even polygamy were allowed due to the weakness of the people.
- **Age of the Son:** Marriage is monogamous without the possibility of divorce. Only the death of one of the spouses can end the marriage. The two become one flesh.
- **Age of the Spirit:** Alchemical marriage or the union of souls. The two become one spirit.

Baldassare Castiglione seems to see things more deeply than Williams, when he writes:

Love is defined as desire awakened by beauty, and by progressive illumination passes from sensible beauty to spiritual, and from spiritual beauty to divine: from lust to love, and from love to religion. The duty of the lover is service and honour; the reward of the right lover is intellectual communion with his lady.

The character Jane in one of **Dumas'** novels says:

Let us forget earth, let us realize heaven; let us share our thoughts, our joys, our griefs, our aspirations, our tears, so that in this un-fleshly communion of minds and souls there may be in our eyes pride, in our heart-throbs purity, in our speech chastity, in our consciences calm.

Has your girlfriend ever spoken to you like that? Perhaps the pressures arising from marriage obscure that state of adoration. Finally, here is a thought from Castiglione, that is the very opposite of the Playboy/Charlie Sheen philosophy:

Who does not know that women cleanse our hearts of all evil and low thoughts, of cares, of troubles, and of those heavy dejections that follow in the trains of these? And if we consider well, we shall recognize also, that in respect to the knowledge of high things, so far from turning away men's mind, women rather awaken them.

Francis and Clare The relationship between Francis and Clare is an unusual case. It is threatening to clerics and friars who fail to understand it. For example, some see a scandal in the fact the Francis and Clare would sometimes travel together. Hence, they try to downplay the erotic element, even if some moderns can see nothing but the erotic element.

We are embodied beings, so a complete love includes body, soul, and spirit; there is attraction on all three levels of being. In ordinary cases, however, the erotic element takes the form of sexual imagery. Eros then turns inward and demands its satisfaction, thereby preventing its ascent to the spiritual. When the mind is purged of all such sensory images, then eros is turned upwards. Beatrice led Dante to the knowledge of the higher things, yet Dante still experienced his love for her on multiple levels. Williams describes Dante's reaction in terms of the three centres recognised in medieval physiology: the heart, the brain, and the liver.

- The **heart**, where the spirit of life dwelled, exclaimed to him: "Behold a god stronger than I, who is to come and rule over me."
- The **brain** declared: "Now your beatitude has appeared to you".
- The **liver**, where natural emotions such as sex inhabited, said: "O misery! How I shall be disturbed henceforward!"

Yet, the lower emotions can be overcome. Williams describes a different mode.

Virginal love is that which, arising normally between a man and a woman, finds its method in the rejection rather than the acceptance of the ordinary physical approach. It is not particular ascetic: that is, it does not deliberately set aside the graces of the body: it may rather be defined as that kind of love which is so occupied with contemplation that it has no room for desire.

This ideal was *de rigueur* in certain Russian spiritual circles early last century, including Jacques Maritain and his Russian bride Raissa. Perhaps, as saints, Francis and Clare are its perfect embodiment.

Polar Beings

Nevertheless, neither is the woman without the man, nor man without the woman in the Lord.

I CORINTHIANS II:II

Drawing on the Orthodox tradition, **Boris Mouravieff** describes what he calls “polar beings”. There are three paths to follow, with mastery of the sexual centre a necessary part of the training:

- **The monk:** avoids the influences of the world
- **The man in the world:** although the past is difficult, life itself offers more opportunities for spiritual growth. By control of the sexual centre, love can be experienced in the emotional and intellectual parts of the soul. This leads to the realisation of the real I.
- **Polar beings:** a man and a woman working together can produce even more rapid results. However, this requires that they be perfectly compatible for that purpose. They will realise the Real I together, as on. Everyone will meet his or her polar opposite in this life, but will most likely not recognize the other as such.

I will quote Mouraviëff extensively without comment, since there is little to add.

The romance, by which Christian society expressed the principle of reciprocal choice, reached its climax in the Middle Ages. ... this romance of tomorrow is called on to cement the indissoluble union between two strictly polar beings, a union which will assure their integration in the bosom of the Absolute.

The vision of such a romance has haunted the highest minds for thousands of years. We find it in platonic love, the basis of the singular romance in the myths of the Androgyne man; of Orpheus and Euridice; of Pygmalion and Galatea... This is the aspiration of the human heart, which cries in secrecy because of its great loneliness. This romance forms the essential aim of esoteric work. Here is that love which will unite man to that being who is unique for him, the Sister-wife, the glory of man, as he will be the glory of God. Having entered into the light of Tabor, no longer two, but one drinking at the fount of true Love, the transfigurer: the conqueror of Death.

This work, done by man and woman working together, can develop with extraordinary power and give rapid results... on condition that from the esoteric point of view the two beings entirely condition that they are a perfect couple, that is, that their combination reservations concerning the peculiarities of their human type — reflects the relation between the absolute 'I' and the 'You' before the Creation of the Universe.

In centres of culture in the cycle of the Holy Spirit, the love-romance—a feature of the previous Cycle—will give place to the unique love-romance of polar beings, those who will be called upon to shape the society of tomorrow.

In this true Romance, the attitude of the Lady contributes much if not all to the victory of the Knight. Her refined and artistic intuition will understand the meaning of love: that is, to love

with all the fibres of one's being, up to integral identification, in a glorious dash towards the same goal.

This return to the perfect unity of polar beings is not given freely. It is the exclusive privilege of those who have crossed, or are ready to cross, the second Threshold of the Way. It is through realization of the totally indivisible unity of their real 'I' by two polar Individualities arrived at the second Birth, that the original sin can and must be redeemed. This is the solution for private and for public life. This is also the peace of the Lord.

A man must begin by a conscious search for his polar being. Polar beings will necessarily meet in life, in certain cases more than once. Only the confused ties contracted in this life by each of them, as a result of their free movements, combined with the karmic consequences of one or more previous experiences, can divert the man or woman from the only being with whom they could form a Microcosmos.

Deeply buried in lies, they do not generally know how to appreciate the gift they are given. Often, they do not even recognize each other. If this is the case, then an agonizing question is put: is there one or more means to detect our polar being, and if so, what are these means? To meet that person, to do so without recognition, to let our polar being pass by, is the worst mistake we could possibly make: because we would remain in our factitious life, without light. Distortions of this kind make it more difficult to recognize the polar being,

It is necessary to permit every being coming into this world to carry within himself the image of the polar being; this image is expressed, in each case, by means of the organ of the opposite sex which exists in every being in a state of non-development.

For man to recognize his polar being, he must be fully attentive on all planes accessible to his consciousness. In fact, as a result of the distortion of the film, the meeting always occurs in circumstances and in a manner least expected, generally at a moment

and in a form which resembles nothing he could have ever imagined. The rule enforced is precise: to recognise his polar being, man must know himself. This is obviously logical: to recognize his alter ego, man must first recognize his own ego.

From the first meeting, in the presence of the polar being, both the 'I' of the Personality and the 'I' of the body vibrate in a manner which resembles nothing felt before. The reason for this is that these 'I's find themselves then in the presence of their first love which continues through the centuries. Without clearly being conscious of it, the polar beings know each other; and this knowledge, as ancient as they are themselves, is expressed by the voice of their subconsciousness. This creates an atmosphere of absolute confidence and sincerity from the moment they meet. There is a touchstone here: polar beings do not lie to each other. Soon afterwards, vague reminiscences of past experiences will start to come to the surface in their waking consciousness.

Only an infinitely small minority of human beings feel the anguish caused by their inward isolation and ardently aspire to find the Lady of their dreams. Before one can aspire (to something) one must at least think (about it). This thought must literally devour the Knight's heart, forcing him to accomplish the most perilous feats with the aim of finding the object of his aspirations.

The great mystery lies in the fact that the real I of polar beings is one and indivisible. One for the two of them.

Now we will represent the case of polar beings who are conscious of their polarity and who aspire to royal union: that of the Knight and the Lady of his Thoughts. As a prelude to their complete union this aspiration, after it penetrates into their waking consciousness, will gradually impregnate the I's of their Personalities, thus creating an amorous or courtly love which is quite different from that experienced by the normal run of human beings. This sets their hearts aflame and inspires them with the courage to look for the means which will enable them to overcome all the

karmic obstacles that appear on their road.

by the autonomy of his life, every Personality produces a particular Karma. Among other consequences, one result is that two polar beings can be born, not at the same time, as should normally happen, but with a difference in time which in certain cases can be considerable. All this ‘muddle’ explains why polar beings so rarely recognize each other spontaneously at the moment of their encounter.

If a man, burning with a valiant heart, becomes a Knight in order to follow the Fifth Way, he must list for that alone. He must cultivate a double desire:

1. To merit the joy of recognizing in himself the image of his polar being
2. To merit the joy of recognizing her when they meet

The general rule, which should be rigorously applied is: to attain the desired goal it is necessary to think of it without ceasing. This is the active concentration that is needed.

Courtly Love is the *raison d'être* for the couple of polar beings: for the Knight and the Lady of his Dreams; without it, their polarity remains spiritually sterile and they fall back into the common condition. Its practice, however, demands sacrifices and ‘exploits’. These are tests. For those who surmount them, the salutary effect of Gnosis is doubled; when it is enriched by experience, theoretical knowledge becomes living knowledge.

In the Middle Ages, the Knight and his Lady, who considered themselves spiritually ONE — in our terminology, polar beings— did not venture into marriage. On the contrary, they parted, accepting the risk of never meeting again and knowing that if they did not triumph over a hard test, their love would degenerate, losing its meaning and its marvellous power. They knew that, by separating from each other for an exploit, they stood the chance, while a premature marriage would be reduced to nothing.

There is no exception to this rule: it applies to all, beginning

with the couple of young and just polar beings; and it is even more obligatory between two polar beings who meet at a mature age, when life has already burdened each of them with a karmic load. In such cases, the first sacrifice demanded is the renunciation of a physical relationship, and the first exploit consists in the methodical liquidation of the respective karmic burdens, keeping in mind that the big or small 'Gordian knots' which make up these burdens must be untied, not cut.

If the presumed polar beings ardently and effectively undertake some esoteric work in the same direction, useful to the Cause, the moment will come when they will be purified. Having become courtly, their Love will assume all its objective force, and in the purity rediscovered in this way, they will finally be convinced of the reality of a polarity that they had felt intuitively. There is no possibility of error at this stage. At this moment, the Second Birth will unite them forever in the midst of the vivifying Love; and death, finally conquered by this, will lose all semblance of catastrophe for them.

Posted on 2019-01-31 by Cologero

* * *

Han Fei on 2019-02-05 at 00:46 said:

Might I ask the obvious question. Why should lovers avoid physical union? What is wrong with it?

Of course deep down inside some of us may suspect the general direction in which the answer may lie. Among the Romans, there was a seemingly profane custom of keeping a wife, a mistress and a slave. Each woman satisfied one of man's particular needs, for procreation and co-management of the house, another for loving companionship and the last for satisfaction of carnal lusts. When one is in the company of his or her beloved, doesn't the impulse to procreate often fall into the background, at least when our minds are lucid?

In his lesser known works, J.R.R. Tolkien seems to have touched upon the theme of the polar couple extensively, from his description of Celeborn and Galadriel to the tragic and perilous romance between Beren and Luthien. And of course one can draw a parallel from his own marriage as an impeccable example of such a union.

33 on 2019-02-06 at 07:52 said:

There isn't anything 'wrong' with it, Han Fei, but what Cologero discusses here is not ordinary marriage. (Of course from the Christian perspective, sexual relationships outside real marriage commitment should be abstained from; why this is so can be explained thoroughly in esoteric.) But in this case we're dealing with a special path. The voluntary renunciation of sexual consummation with a 'polar being' here is not due to the 'sinfulness' of a legitimate human sexual relationship, but rather one of methodological initiatory expediency: the voluntary renunciation of consummation on that natural bodily plane may serve to intensify realization of the corresponding union on a higher, inner plane. These powerful alchemical energies are directed inwardly instead of being released outwardly. That being said, there are certain tantric traditions, even in Buddhist Vajrayana, that incorporate the energies of union on the physical plane as well in a related form of alchemical romance, attempting to synthesise the higher and the lower union. But for my own part, I tend to believe that the latter path is actually more difficult, and that deliberate renunciation of outer consummation of such polar attraction is more powerful in effectuating the inner realization. This will not be the same in all cases, of course, but the right-handed approach has something very important to teach the contemporary world, with its obsession that 'love' must necessarily lead to sexual union, which is its desired end.

By the way, I don't know if Cologero has read what Philip Sherrard has to say on the problem of the sexual relationship in Christianity:

http://www.studiesincomparativereligion.com/public/articles/The_Sexual_Relationship_in_Christian_Thought-by_Philip_Sherrard.aspx

Apparently there's also a book titled 'Eros and Christianity' which I have not read.

Simon on 2020-01-07 at 07:48 said:

Great article, it inspires me to think about my encounters with women much more deeply. There are two points, both regarding karmic influences, which I could use some further elucidation on, due to my lack of doctrinal knowledge.

1. „Only the confused ties contracted in this life by each of them, as a result of their free movements, combined with the karmic consequences of one or more previous experiences...”

Regarding the „experiences“ mentioned here in the last sentence, do they refer to romantic experiences or to experiences on other planes of being, potentially „before“ this earthly life in which they then play out?

2. „...every Personality produces a particular Karma. Among other consequences, one result is that two polar beings can be born, not at the same time, as should normally happen, but with a difference in time which in certain cases can be considerable.“

If anybody could shed further light on this for me, I would be most thankful. As far as I know (and have read on this site as well), the popular modern conception of reincarnation (i.e. multiple earthly and human incarnations, each carrying karmic load from the preceding ones) is most certainly not in line with Tradition properly so called. If this is so, how am I to properly understand Mouravieff here, that is where do these karmic influences that determine the differential in age come from? From freely chosen actions or thoughts in pre-incarnate existence on another plane?

Thanks in advance and please excuse my naïveté regarding this issue.

2.4 David and Bathsheba

I have found in David, the son of Jesse, a man after my heart, who will do all my will.

ACTS 13:22

My flesh and my heart may fail, but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever.

PSALM 73:26

And David had success in all his undertakings, for the Lord was with him.

1 SAMUEL 18:14

David King David is one of the Nine Worthies⁵ who best represent the Chivalric ideal. As a proto-knight, he engaged in battle, he loved, he had friends and enemies, he sinned, he repented, he cried out to God. He was the King of the Heavenly City on earth and a Prophet of God

That made him a real man in the traditional sense, a man who has actualized all his possibilities. Valentin Tomberg explains:

⁵<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=331>

King David was more human than all men of his time. This is why he was anointed by divine order by the prophet Samuel, and for this reason the Eternal gave him the solemn promise that his throne would be established for ever.

In this respect, he is a type of Adam. Adam, as the first man, was also a ruler, having dominion over the earth, plants, and animals. Adam brought wisdom to his kingdom and taught survival skills to the human race.

So David serves as an example, not necessarily for monks or other religious types, but certainly for men active in the world. That is why Ibn Arabi's meditation on the *Wisdom of Existence in the Word of David* emphasizes the Will:

The power of the Will is immense. Nothing occurs in existence nor disappears from it without the Will.

Nothing can thwart God's will. However, man chooses the means, which may either be in opposition or in conformity to the Divine Will.

It is only commanding the means, not the command, which brings things into being. None opposes God at all in what He does in respect to the command of the Will. Opposition only occurs in respect of the command of means. So understand that!

If there is anything transgressive in David's behaviour, it was not because he was opposed to God's will; rather, the means may have been inappropriate. However, "All's fair in love and war," as the saying goes.

The Imaginal Realm

Changing the appearances of things, walking on water, climbing Mount Qaf, all fall in the category of events that Suhrawardi mentions as taking place in the "intermediate Orient". In other words,

they are psychic events whose scene and action are set in neither the sensible nor the intelligible world, but the intermediate world of the Imaginable, the world of symbol and of typefications, the place of all visionary recitals. it is the world in which spirits are corporealized and bodies spiritualized.

HENRY CORBIN, *Avicenna and the Visionary Recital*

We are familiar with the metaphysical distinction between the world of the Intellect and the world of the Senses. What is often lost, however, is awareness of the Imaginal realm in between the two. Corbin has done much to recover the ancient interest in the imaginal realm. Each realm is associated with a specific sense:

- **The Intellectual Realm** is associated with the sense of hearing, which is the most subtle sense. That is why the highest revelations come from hearing.
- **The Imaginal Realm** is associated with the sense of sight. It is the place of visionary experiences.
- **The Sensual Realm** is associated with the sense of touch, which is the deciding factor in determining the real. Thus, a rainbow is not real, because it can't be touched, even though it can be seen.

Usually the imaginal realm is unconscious, i.e., that part of the world that is not represented in consciousness. As such, there is little or no awareness of its existence. In esoteric training the student is taught how to become aware of the contents of the subconscious. However, if the visions arise spontaneously or unexpectedly, they can be frightening. Corbin develops this idea:

This darkness is ignorance or, more precisely, unconsciousness of ignorance — that is to say the natural man is in a state of ignorance and cannot even be conscious of that state. To free himself from it, he must pass to the darkness; this is a terrifying and painful experience, for it ruins and destroys all the patencies and norms on which the natural man lived and depended — a true “descent into hell”, the hell of the unconscious. That [Suhrawardi] discerned the psychic event, the redoubtable initiation into knowledge in the true sense, into the saving gnosis, is greatly to his credit.

When reading a sacred text, we often come upon passages that seem contradictory, impossible, or even scandalous. That is a clue that the text should not be understood at the sensual level. Rather, the images are part of the Imaginal Realm. So the answer is not more historical research or textual analysis. Instead, the reader must look deep within; often the meaning will be found there. Obviously, there is no point in relating random historical events if no deeper meaning can be attached.

The story of David and Bathsheba is like that. On the material level it sounds scandalous. But on the Imaginal level, there may be some deep insights. This story, then, is not just about two historical personages, but about events in your psyche which you can observe.

After all, David and even Bathsheba have been held in high regard, the former as a model of chivalry, as a king, as a prophet, and even a type of Jesus, not just by men but even by God. And Bathsheba has traditionally been considered a type to the Virgin Mary, Sophia, the Queen of Heaven.

So consider this a small meditation on their love story, which can be recreated today in your own consciousness, as a psychic event.

Bathsheba David was walking on the roof when he spotted Bathsheba bathing. The roof indicates that David was observing from a higher state of being, the level of the Spirit. After seven wives, and a harem, the sight

of yet another naked woman cannot account for David's strong reaction to Bathsheba. Just as Adam recognized in Eve:

She is bone of my bone and flesh of my flesh.

David saw in Bathsheba the "soul of his soul".

Unlike his other wives and concubines, Bathsheba was unique, the woman of destiny with whom he has been entangled for eternity. What he saw was the beauty of his soul. As **Saint Theresa d'Avila** expressed it:

we shall see that the soul of the just man is a paradise, in which God takes His delight. Nothing can be compared to the great beauty and capabilities of a soul; however keen our intellects may be, they are as unable to comprehend them as to comprehend God.

Ordinary men can only see physical beauty. A real man finds true beauty in the soul of a woman. When a man is truly attracted to a woman, he will go to extraordinary lengths to get her attention. That is because the quest for unity is also the quest for God.

She, on the other hand, had to do nothing to attract David's attention. That is why a man's love can be so mystifying to a woman. Sibylle told me⁶:

To a woman the love of a man is incomprehensible. She sees it, she hears it, she might enjoy it, be overwhelmed by it and eventually fall in love, but she does not comprehend it.

Does not that incomprehension echo Saint Theresa? If you try to understand love intellectually, you will misunderstand. If you try to judge by human standards, you will misjudge.

⁶<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=13757>

David and Bathsheba desired a spiritual marriage. Earthly marriage ends at death, and sometimes mercifully so. Uriah is a symbol of that, because, on earth, we all too soon get wrapped up in relationships that are inappropriate. Hence, Uriah represents Bathsheba's lingering attachment to carnal things, and her bathing is a symbol of her purification.

David must also be purified. To possess Bathsheba, he needs to come to terms with his lust and his jealousy of Uriah. Since David's means displeased God, he was convicted of sin by the prophet Nathan. The spiritual child born of that relationship is spiritually dead. David confesses:

I have gone astray like a lost sheep; seek thy servant, for I do not forget thy commandments.

PSALM 119:176

Then David is purified when Nathan forgives his sins. Only then, was a special son, Solomon, born.

Solomon

She came from the ends of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon, and behold, something greater than Solomon is here.

MATTHEW 12:42

The hieros gamos produces a child of wisdom, the true self. Solomon personifies Wisdom. As such, he is the type of Jesus. Solomon's kingdom prefigures the Kingdom of Christ, the eternal kingdom.

As Solomon's mother, Bathsheba is the type of Mary, the Queen of Heaven. At that time, the mother of the King served as Queen. (Otherwise, which of Solomon's wives would be queen?) So the true offspring of David and Bathsheba is Wisdom, just as Mary's offspring is Jesus. David and Solomon had faults, otherwise revelation would have ended with them.

Note on Art In the Middle Ages, Eve and Bathsheba were the only nudes that could be painted, for obvious reasons. However, I have refrained from including such art in the body of the text to avoid misunderstandings.

Posted on 2021-08-29 by Cologero

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Tannheuser on 2022-04-05 at 14:29 said:

It's worth comparing the Bathsheba episode to how David came beforehand to possess his wife Abigail. She too was married to an unworthy husband, Nabal, but David refrained from killing him, and the Lord himself struck Nabal down (1 Samuel 25:38), after which David married Abigail (the mother of the prophet Daniel). In a similar way to how David threw aside his earthly armor and weapons in his fight with Goliath in order to rely purely on the help of the Lord, here we see the same attitude with regard to his courtship of a married woman.

2.5 Dreaming the Same Dream

I don't remember well, and in fact I know nothing absolutely nothing at all, about the women I have loved.

Papan answered: That simply means that you have never loved. You simply have no idea of love as an absolute concept. Loving is knowing. It is also like a crime since it involves death, burial, and resurrection. ... Love is something very serious. Today it is completely forgotten.

Love in fact is a strange and secret chemistry, in which the androgynous is born. This is true and complete love; everything else is different. Have you ever noticed how impossible it was to fuse yourself with the person you thought you loved, even though sleeping in the same bed? There is always something separating you, a thread of air, a different dream. Can the lovers be truly united if each one dreams a different dream? If you ever begin

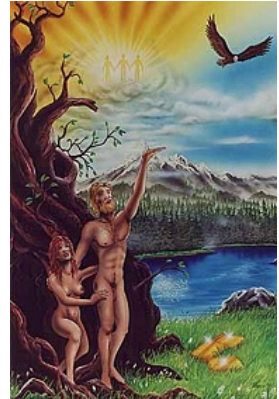
to dream the same dreams as your love, then you will be able to create the new star, the star of Him-Her, El-Ella.

MIGUEL SERRANO, *The Ultimate Flower*

The ideas of Tantra Yoga have been capturing the popular imagination, not least of all because of the lascivious interpretations put upon it. But metaphysical writers such as Miguel Serrano⁷, Aleister Crowley⁸, and Julius Evola have made Tantra Yoga an integral element of their thought. Few are aware that this is also part of Esoteric Christian teaching as revealed by Boris Mouravieff with the idea of Polar Beings. Only Serrano and Mouravieff, however, tie it in with the idea of Love, such that the woman is more than the instrumental means for the man's enlightenment (or pleasure). A discussion of Mouravieff's system will await another time.

Serrano was greatly influenced by Jung's idea of the *Mysterium Coniunctionis*, or the creation of the Androgyne. If every man and woman is a star, the spiritual and inner union of man and woman creates a new star. In a sense the woman surrenders her separate life, living on in the man in his consciousness. As Papan tells him:

All that remains for me therefore is that other road of magical love which will deliver me over to you when I die. In this way I will continue to live, preserved in your memory. Do you realize that in a sense you are a kind of cemetery? You carry so many other around in you, and give them life through your memory of them.



⁷See Section 3.3 in this book.

⁸<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=51>

By “dreaming the same dream” and sharing visions, the man and women are united. Her salvation comes from him, while she, embodying Wisdom or Sophia, reveals himself:

When I came into her room I no longer spoke, but sat down in a wicker chair beside the window, and silently allowed her visions to pour over me, certain that hers and mine were the same, while all the time she looked through me as though I were a window.

Serrano, as a champion of the ascetic-heroic attitude, rejects the physical possession of the beloved:

It should be known then that, in reality, the solution is to be able to bring Her back to life to resurrect Her within his soul.

Obviously, this refers back to **Kalacharaka Tradition** in Tibetan Buddhism. There are three levels of Tantra corresponding to the tripartite nature of man.

Karma mudra	This involves a real female partner, part of the realm of desire.	Body
Jnana mudra	At this level, the Yogi creates an image in his imagination. The realm of form.	Soul
Maha Mudra	At this level, the Tantrika is formless, with no separate existence.	Spirit

Karma mudra (physical woman) and jnana mudra (imaginary woman) are common occurrences, available to anyone, with no discernible effect on any sort of gnosis or enlightenment. It is the practice of the Maha Mudra that interests us. In the first two levels, the woman is a privation to the man, while at the third the privation is overcome. The female element is absorbed into the man, creating a being superior to either of them separately.

Sophia, or the Virgin, is the World Process unfolding in our consciousness. As long as the Virgin is objectified, the World Process represents a privation to us, something outside us, beyond our command. It runs on its own. We represent this Process as horizontal, while the action of the Spirit is vertical. The separation and objectification limits the Power of Spirit. The male principle is Spirit (formless), the female principle is the flow of forms revealed in consciousness.

The task of the Yogi is to bring those principles in harmony, to “dream the same dream”. By ascetical and hermetic practices, he quiets the mind, to open a clearing in Being, where Spirit can act. The Virgin then is the perfect reflector of Spirit, revealing to him what He is. In this way, a new child is born⁹: the Androgyne, the Self, the Christ.

Posted on 2011-06-08 by Cologero

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Cologero on 2011-06-24 at 22:52 said:

I found this rather odd story about “dreaming the same dream” in the Rolling Stone hit piece on Michelle Bachmann¹⁰:

Bachmann claimed that back in her college days, she was up one night praying with a female friend of hers when “the Lord gave each one of us the same, exact vision... It was a picture of me, marrying this man, in the valley where his parents have a farm in western Wisconsin.” Meanwhile, miles away, Marcus “was repairing a fence on the farm where he worked, and the Lord showed him in a vision that he was supposed to marry me.”

Leaving aside the unappealing content of her neo-Christianity, Bachmann illustrates the remnants of an archaic consciousness in the modern world: visions, communications with a god, destiny, and the obsession with the ties of family and religion. In contrast, the author represents

⁹<https://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/the-word-is-made-flesh>

¹⁰<http://www.rollingstone.com/politics/news/michele-bachmanns-holy-war-20110622?page=3>

the post-modern mind and there is, apparently, no point of contact between the two. Instead of an objective and dispassionate essay, he resorts to hysteria, a quality unbecoming in a man. For “those who know”, however, this is just another battle between fideists and post-modernists and is viewed differently. The post-modernist rejects every aspect of the archaic consciousness, while the fideist claims to hold a monopoly of every preternatural and supernatural manifestation in that consciousness.

2.6 Absolute Man, Absolute Woman

In the chapter “Man and Woman” in *Revolt against the Modern World*, **Julius Evola** establishes the proper relationship between the two principles. The feminine force is centrifugal with its tendency to chaos, but when aligned with the masculine stability, a synthesis results. Thus, the masculine principle must become more fully itself, while the feminine becomes aligned with the masculine. Evola mentions the symbolism of the “bride” in this regard, just as **Ananda Coomaraswamy** points out that the king is the bride in relation to the *purohita*.

Evola points out that birth is not by chance. Hence, the being who is a man or a woman must reflect a spiritual difference. This differs from the modern view which sees one’s birth sex as something arbitrary, and now, given new medical technology, as even a matter of choice. However, traditionally, a man must fulfill himself as a man and a woman as a woman.

For a man, according to Evola, the highest ways belong to the Ascetic and the Warrior, corresponding to the Brahmin and Kshatriya castes respectively. Both these paths “affirm themselves in a life that is beyond life”, the former through *jnana yoga*, or total detachment, and the latter through *bhakti yoga*, or pure action. The woman, on the other hand, fulfills herself as Lover or as Mother. Note, here, that in Evola’s scheme the man can fulfill himself totally on his own, but a woman only in relation to a man. Through devotion to her lover or her son, a woman gives herself totally to another being, thereby fulfilling herself. Evola concludes

this discussion:

To realize oneself in an ever more decisive way along these two distinct and unmistakable directions, limiting in the woman everything that is man and in man everything that is woman, approaching the absolute man and the absolute woman – such is the traditional law for the sexes, according to the various planes of life.

Perhaps Evola did not exhaust all the roles since men can also be Fathers and some women are ascetics. Logically, it is necessary for men to be Fathers otherwise women could not be fulfilled as mothers. Even among the Kshatriyas, there is the archetype of the Judge who decides with perfect justice. The vaishyas are neglected, but there are many who through dedication to knowledge or service to the community can find fulfillment.

To return to the spectrum of the absolute man and woman, we are left wondering. For example, where do the Ascetic and Warrior sit on this spectrum? Guenon answers this question when he points out that the Brahmin is oriented to superhuman states while the Kshatriya (warrior) tends to the realization of all the possibilities of the human state. This makes it clear that the Ascetic is more transcendent than the Warrior.

The Absolute Man What then is the archetype of the absolute man? Evola alludes to it at the beginning of the chapter when he mentions the purusha and prakriti, the yang and the yin. But **Alexander Jacob** in *A Reconstruction of the Solar Cosmology of the Indo-Europeans* confirms it. He writes:

The formation of the deity as Purusha/Vishnu, the Ideal Man, is the result of the promptings of the divine heart or spirit. This ideal Man is however actually androgynous.

Thus Purusha is the Ideal or Absolute Man, which is clear once the masculine principle is fully understood. Moreover, a man approaches to this Ideal not by eliminating the feminine principle but rather by uniting with it in the *Mysterium Coniunctionis* or Spiritual Marriage. To transcend all lower states is the non-dual state, as the Purusha is also Atman.

A clue to this state is given by the warrior who actualizes all the possibilities of the human state. Or stated differently, he manifests in matter all his latent possibilities; this requires the cooperation of the feminine principle and especially the domination of it. A fortiori, the jnani actualizes all the possibilities of all the states so there is no longer duality between essence and existence. This defines precisely, in the West, God, for whom essence and existence are one.

The Absolute Woman If Purusha is the absolute man, then Prakriti is the absolute woman. Prakriti alone is chaotic, undifferentiated, formless, and blind. As such, Prakriti can never be manifested as it is a metaphysical impossibility. Prakriti must be informed by the masculine principle in order to be anything in particular. But Evola had just pointed out that the woman is fulfilled by her relationship to a man, so the Absolute Woman is not Prakriti separate from all influences of the male principle, but rather the woman who is in the perfect relationship to the higher male principle. In other words, she participates in the same Spiritual Marriage mentioned above.

Excursus on German Idealism To make these principles real, they demonstrate how German philosophy of the 18th and 19th centuries fed the process of the feminization of the West. When Kant attempted to show that the pure reason was incapable of any knowledge, the result was the abandonment of the male principle. The pure reason, or intellect, is the tool of contemplation. Only the practical reason, or action, could lead to knowledge of God, freedom, and immortality. This is equivalent

to raising the feminine principle to the peak.

Those who followed Kant realized the consequences of his philosophy and concluded that the Will was the fundamental principle of the world. Schopenhauer did this quite thoroughly and consistently. In his system, the Will is fundamental, but if the will is not guided by the pure reason, it must therefore be arbitrary, blind, illogical, purposeless, and directionless. Nevertheless, there had to be something more, the Platonic ideas, to give form to the world. However, apparently the will was not directed by the ideas. Because of this Schopenhauer's philosophy provides many interesting insights. Had he raised the ideas above the will, he would have come closer to a real metaphysics. At least he understood the Will to be transcendent to the world.

Nietzsche borrowed Schopenhauer's concept of Will and gave it a direction, the Will to Power. He also dropped the ideas and regarded the world of appearances, all superficial, i.e., not as appearances of anything transcendental. The Will to Power, as a particular manifestation of Shakti, is feminine, and the denial of transcendence eliminates the masculine element totally from his system.

Posted on 2013-02-06 by Cologero

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Jason-Adam on 2013-02-07 at 14:55 said:

Wow. This article destroys the foundations of the New Right and pseudo-traditionalist movement based on German idealism entirely.

Philosophically, we need to get back to knowledge of God through as Aquinas taught us.

Mihai on 2013-02-08 at 03:24 said:

This should also make clear to the enthusiasts who put Nietzsche's philosophy on the same level with traditional ideas, that there is nothing traditional about his worldview, quite the contrary. He is much closer to a Marx than to a Guenon and even Evola.

Jason-Adam on 2013-02-08 at 15:01 said:

The famous Protocols of the Learned Elders of Zion, which Evola considered worthy of reading, classify Nietzsche along with Marx and Darwin as agents of subversion.

Also, the Abbe Barruel reported that Kant was a member of the Illuminati. When taken together, the facts show that German Idealism was devised as a means of destroying traditional Catholic Europe.

Cologero on 2013-02-09 at 06:45 said:

If this has any merit: the real history of white Europeans¹¹, it would explain why Western history has been dominated by the kshatriya mentality and why true intellectuality has been difficult to establish. German idealism is a philosophy compatible with the kshatriya spirit.

Janus on 2013-02-10 at 23:56 said:

I don't think the new right claims to be based on German idealism, though Evola certainly was influenced by it in his early years.

I wonder about the possibilities for initiation or illumination for women, in this case. I have always wondered whether the masculine and feminine are really limited in the hardline way Evola prescribes. For example, he goes so far in this chapter of *Revolt* to suggest that while the woman must love the man, the man does not return this love (I'd cite directly but I don't have my copy on hand...perhaps someone knows the passage?), or else risks losing his pure masculinity. Among Traditionalists, I think Charles Upton at least would find problems with this. Tradition in Europe seemed to encourage love given by both parties (and Evola notes this, but seems to think it a deviation of sorts).

Moreover, I find it interesting that it seems like this suggests that the masculine and feminine only "really" exist in the man, whereas the woman in her pure femininity must submit herself to this. Thus, it seems like while the man is ascending toward his "true Self", the woman has no Self outside of that of the man. Perhaps this could be more clearly explained and corrected? It seems to me more likely that the masculine and feminine manifest themselves in different ways in different people, surely. We may look at St. Joan of Arc, who clearly manifested a more masculine principle akin to the kshatriya. than any feminine role. I have also heard a similar explanation of those cases where relations happen between those of the same sex; there usually seems to be a "masculine" vs "feminine" role, so perhaps these principles may be harmonized even when it does not appear to be the case on the profane or physical level (this is, of course, the exception, not the rule). Even the sacrament of marriage can be viewed in this light as the masculine and feminine being completed in complementary beings, the man and wife, thus manifesting the Divine unity.

¹¹<http://vimeo.com/48152436>

Paulo on 2014-11-16 at 11:44 said:

Janus

"I wonder about the possibilities for initiation or illumination for women, in this case. I have always wondered whether the masculine and feminine are really limited in the hardline way Evola prescribes. For example, he goes so far in this chapter of *Revolt* to suggest that while the woman must love the man, the man does not return this love (I'd cite directly but I don't have my copy on hand...perhaps someone knows the passage?), or else risks losing his pure masculinity."

You dont get the point her,the love of men toward women is not the love of dependence,the love of using women as a lifeline,of the reproduction of the same dependece a baby have toward his mother.He gives consciousness love.

"Moreover, I find it interesting that it seems like this suggests that the masculine and feminine only "really" exist in the man, whereas the woman in her pure femininity must submit herself to this. Thus, it seems like while the man is ascending toward his "true Self", the woman has no Self outside of that of the man. Perhaps this could be more clearly explained and corrected?"

Being women the passive element,she must receive the masculine principle in her self.When men is fully,that is,had aquire the true masculinity,then he can"fecundate"women!

" It seems to me more likely that the masculine and feminine manifest themselves in different ways in different people, surely. We may look at St. Joan of Arc, who clearly manifested a more masculine principle akin to the kshatriya. than any feminine role"

Even in her case,she had visions of swords coming from the sky,had seen visions,a clearly feminine mode of function.

Hank on 2017-02-28 at 18:25 said:

Ibn Ashir said « Purity is thine through water which naught else hath changed »

On this, Shaykh al-Alawi said, « Purity is reached through Absolute Water, the Water of the Unseen, that is, the Limpidity which is variegated in Its manifestation, One with Itself in Its seeming multiplicity, Self-manifested, Hidden through the intensity of its manifestation, Absolute in Its relativity-- this is the Water which is free from any taint and which availeth for purification; and of It one fo the Gnostics said: 'With the Water of the Unseen make thine ablution

If thou hast the secret and if not, with earth or stone.'

This is the Water of the Unseen which avileth for purification, and all other water in relation unto it is as dry sand, not to be used except when this Water hath been lost.»

tr. by Martin Lings

2.7 Man, Woman, and Self

In **Emmanuel Swedenborg**'s interpretation of Genesis, Eve appears as the "self" of Adam. The male principle is the Intelligence and the female principle symbolizes the Will. The Will is the "nucleus, the inmost heart of the human being." The True Will, then, is man's true self...

How then does a man know his true Self, which is not something that can be observed directly, as one of the objects in the world? **E. F. Schumacher** outlined the four fields of knowledge¹². So, if I cannot adequately answer the question "Who am I", then there is the question, "Who do you say I am?" A person usually deludes himself about who he is, whereas others easily see through his pretenses.

If Swedenborg is providing the esoteric interpretation, the exoteric understanding is not precluded; to the contrary, it is necessary. For Adam, the Self is dead, represented by the rib since the bones are the last to decay. That rib is vivified by Eve, who appears therefore as the *exteriorization* of his own Self. She is almost his identical twin, genetically the same apart from her having two X chromosomes, his "reciprocal". Hence, she is the perfect woman for him. In knowing Eve, Adam is knowing himself.

Every woman desires a man who "gets" her, that is, someone who understands her in a deep way. The converse is not identical. A woman, too, wants to know her man, but not always just in his actuality, but also in his potentiality. This often comes across as a desire to change him, leading to a degree of conflict. If this conflict subsides, it indicates she has decided to "settle", as they



Figure 2.1: Adam And Eve In Paradise

¹²<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=507>

put it. On the other hand, it may impel the man to exceed himself. In *Gnosis*¹³, **Boris Mouravieff** provides, as examples, **Wagner** and **Goethe** who achieved great moments of creativity, inspired by infatuations with younger women.

Sometimes, even among the Medievalists, a woman is represented as an imperfect man. However, that is putting her on the wrong scale, as there do exist imperfect men on the scale whose peak is the Absolute Male. A woman can only be represented on the corresponding scale with the Absolute Female at its peak.

This is a difficult teaching. If the woman is the perfect helpmeet for a man, why is it not always experienced that way? In a relationship, a man is, in some deep way, confronting his own self. To the degree that he lacks self-awareness, the less he sees that. Mouravieff writes:

just as one particular woman produces a different effect of carnal attraction on different types of men, so, on the psychic plane, the creative spirit of a man produces a different psycho-sexual attraction on different women.

The complexities of attraction must be understood on the three levels: carnal, psychic, and spiritual. So called “success” at the carnal level can be mastered if desired. An intelligent man can make changes to himself as he learns to master himself. However, although that is celebrated in the modern world, it is not likely the best use of one’s inner resources. Often, a man will entangle himself in harmful karmic relationships that become difficult to extract himself from.

The lower a man is on the scale of the Absolute Male, there is less and less differentiation. Hence, the woman attracted by such a man is likely to be very much like him. At the lowest levels, the lack of differentiation may even appear as an attraction to the same gender. There is little challenge in this case and hence less possibility of achieving self-knowledge.

¹³<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/mouravieff3.pdf>

The higher on the scale, then, the woman will also be correspondingly higher, thereby deviating more and more from each other. That is, ultimately the Absolute Man will attract the Absolute Female, and their respective qualities will be quite different from each other. This hardly means that things go so smoothly, as the higher stages of self-realization get more difficult. In one incident, **Dante** passed Beatrice and two of her friends on a street in Florence. When she snubbed him, he was so upset he hid in an alley and cried for hours.

Yet Beatrice was the one who prayed for Dante on his journey to Paradise, and became his ultimate guide to the Supreme Identity. Scholars today still debate the identity of Beatrice. But Gornahoor readers now know exactly who she is.

For further reading, see Swedenborg and Esoteric Islam by Henry Corbin.

Posted on 2012-09-08 by Cologero

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O on 2016-12-09 at 20:45 said:

If the Absolute Man is the same as the sexually differentiated Adam prior to the fall from the centre of the human state, what happens if the spiritual reintegration goes deeper still, becoming the Primordial Androgynous Man? Can we still speak of the Absolute Man if it doesn't have Absolute Woman as its opposite pole, precisely because both poles are reintegrated into the principle preceding them? What is the reaction of the Absolute Woman to a being having realised that state, integrated his opposite and hence become completely free of desire?

Cologero on 2016-12-11 at 10:45 said:

@O, I don't think we want to understand "Absolute Man" in such biological terms. Rather, it is the union of the Intelligence and the Will, the head and the heart. Such as we are, the Will and the Intellect are not united, they are usually at war with each other. It is as though we have multiple selves. In Hermetic terms, this union is the alchemical marriage: the Holy Spirit (intelligence) is reflected in the soul (will) giving birth to the Christ, or Logos, as the true self.

O on 2016-12-11 at 20:29 said:

That is succinctly put, Cologero, and I agree. But the article differentiates between 'Absolute Man' and 'Absolute Woman', which of course is well known from Evola. That is a 'sexual' distinction on an archetypal level, but not necessarily a biological phenomenon as known in our existential state. (I think it was C.S. Lewis who wrote somewhere that 'gender' differentiation in beings is manifested in modes more essential than biological sex.) What you now explained seems to be different from the notion of an Absolute Man having as his opposite an externally manifested/embodyed Absolute Woman, which would be a dual and complementary relation.

Cologero on 2016-12-11 at 21:33 said:

@O, rather than repeat myself, perhaps you could comment on this: Absolute Man, Absolute Woman.

Aren't Yin and Yang the ultimate distinction? I believe that the Tao, then, is the union. The Chinese translate the word "Logos" by "Tao".

Max on 2019-09-09 at 14:12 said:

Swedenborg also treats the subject of Polar Beings in his book "Conjugal Love". So far, I have only had time to eye through it rather briefly, and there seems to be both agreements and some differences when compared to Mouravieff's teaching. From memory, Swedenborg maintains that the prospective polar beings will increasingly polarize according to their efforts, and gradually adapt to one another. There is a potential polarity which is only effectively realised through the sacrament of marriage and conjugal love. In other words, the perfectly polar couple is most likely not found in some sort of "state of nature". First of all they must crucially be able to recognize one another, which is heavily stressed by Mouraieff.

2.8 Creativity, Personality, Sex

Julius Evola has mentioned the philosopher **Nicholas Berdyaev** several times, including his review of *The Meaning of History*¹⁴. But Evola has also mentioned him in the context of the possible recovery of Christianity to tradition. However, Evola ultimately rejected that approach, and I'm not sure if that was meant in the relative sense that Berdyaev's work

¹⁴<https://gornahoor.net/?p=6200>

had little impact in the wider sphere, or in the absolute sense that it was ultimately insufficient in itself. Nevertheless, there are certainly points of contact, such as the emphasis on action and creativity, pre-existence of souls, the priority of the person, not to mention his interest in **J J Bachofen** and appreciation for **Friedrich Nietzsche**. Some ideas gleaned from his magnum opus, the *Destiny of Man*, will give an insight into his thought.

Man as Creative Berdyaev sees the essence of human nature as a whole, at least virtually, since there are certainly antinomies and inner conflicts that need to be resolved. To get there, he rejects the evolutionistic explanation, since it makes man a natural creature bound by necessity, rather than free. The Roman view, in his opinion, is limited by seeing man as natural rather than spiritual, who needs grace. The reformed view is worse, seeing man as totally depraved. However, Berdyaev sees in **Soren Kierkegaard** a “thinker of genius” for his psychological insights into anxiety and the paradoxical nature of man. Evola, however, wrote this about that tragic sense of life:

To exalt the romantic, tragic, anxious soul, always in search of new “truths”, is essentially something of a civilization sick and damaged in its race. Calmness, style, clarity, command, discipline, power, and the Olympic spirit are instead the points of reference for every formation of character and life.

Berdyaev then indicates his understanding of the Christian conception of man, which is based on these two ideas:

1. Man is the image and likeness of God the Creator
2. God became man, the Son of God manifested Himself to us as the God-Man.

Berdyaev next draws out this conclusion from those premises: As the image and likeness of the Creator, man is a creator too and is called to creative cooperation, i.e., he is a creative being. This goes beyond the conceptions mentioned above. This, he emphasizes, is deeper than the idea of man as the “toolmaker”; in his words:

Man can only be a creative being if he has freedom. There are two elements in human nature, and it is their combination and interaction that constitute man. There is in him the element of primeval, utterly undetermined potential freedom springing from the abyss of non-being, and the element determined by the fact that man is the image and likeness of God, a Divine idea which his freedom may realize or destroy.

Assuming this view of man, Berdyaev makes an intriguing point about the Fall, which, he explains, arises from the “third principle”, i.e.,

uncreated freedom, non-being which is prior to being, the meonic abyss which is neither Creator nor creature ... This is the ultimate mystery behind reality. Endless consequences follow from it. It accounts both for evil and for the creation of what has never existed before. The ethics of creativeness goes back to this primary truth.

Yet, for us, this is an elegant restatement of the Hermetic principle of forces. The creature as Destiny, the Creator as Providence, mediated by the Will.

The Person and Pre-Existence Another point of contact between Evola and Berdyaev is their understanding of the Person vis-à-vis the individual. For both, the individual is a natural and biological category, whereas the person is spiritual. Berdyaev claims that the

early moral consciousness of mankind is wholly dominated by the mystical power of kinship. Man had to wage a heroic struggle to free himself from it. ... primitive, archaic human morality is entirely communal and traces of it have not completely disappeared among the civilized races of today.

Here, unfortunately, Berdyaev is veering close to an evolutionistic understanding of man. Gornahoor in this regard prefers Evola's idea of spiritual races. Rather than indicating an evolution, Berdyaev's observation is better explained by the co-existence of different spiritual races, so that struggle he mentioned is always a here and now battle, and its victory at some point in the past cannot be assumed. Certainly that communal attitude is alive and well in our time as this recent controversial story shows¹⁵. Personhood is an achievement, a difficult achievement in fact, and not common to all.

Berdyaev claims that Christianity freed man from the power of cosmic forces and the blood tie, making the moral life of the individual independent of the tribe or of any collective unit. In his devotion to empire and rejection of the determinism of biological race, Evola likewise sees the person as free of such ties. However, Evola does not see that as exclusively Christian.

Berdyaev concludes his discussion of the person with the idea of the pre-existence of the soul. Obviously, the soul is not a product of the genetic process. Nor is it created in time at the moment of conception, otherwise it could not be free as the third force. Hence, he concludes that it is created by God in eternity, in the spiritual world. Keep in mind that priority can be understood in five ways. Pre-existence in the sense of temporal priority was condemned, but Berdyaev is talking in terms of an ontological priority.

¹⁵<http://www.lifesitenews.com/news/msnbc-host-digs-in-heels-over-controversial-psa-claiming-children-belong-to>

The Masculine and the Feminine Along with Kierkegaard, Berdyaev regards **J J Bachofen** as the other genius in understanding the nature of man. Berdyaev explains why:

Bachofen discovered the deep primeval layer of human nature, its original connection with the maternal element, the struggle of the masculine solar principle with the feminine telluric one, the metaphysics of sex in man. For Bachofen polarity is man's essential characteristic. The cosmic struggle between the sun and the earth, personalism and collectivism, takes place in man.

Evola, too, held Bachofen in very high regard, and his adherence to Bachofen's ideas is what makes Evola's thought different from Guenon's in significant ways. Building on Bachofen, Berdyaev understands that man is a sexual being and sexual polarity is characteristic of human nature. This is not merely a biological category but a fundamental quality of man as a whole being. Without mentioning **Otto Weininger**, Berdyaev's view is amazingly similar. They both understand that the human being combines masculine and feminine elements in different proportions. Here again, the tragic sense of life arises. Although the masculine and the feminine principles seek union, they are also engaged in a cosmic struggle, waging war against each other like deadly enemies.

Bachofen has shown the presence of this struggle in the world. The Sun is the masculine principle: spirit, paternity. The Earth is the feminine principle: matter, flesh, maternity. The Moon is then the "masculinely feminine intermediary principle". Bachofen sees history as the result of how these principles meet, interact, and come into conflict within the cosmos.

Berdyaev points out that Bachofen was a Christian. This is important because Berdyaev draws from Bachofen his idea of the person and its separation from blood ties. If original humanity was matriarchal, patriarchy arose with the awakening of the spirit and personality.

Berdyayev next gets pretty alchemical. Following on Plato and **Jacob Boehme**, man is both personality and cosmos, logos and earth, masculine and feminine:

God's conception of man is a complete, masculinely feminine being, solar and tellurgic, logoic and cosmic at the same time. Only insofar as he is complete is he chaste, wise, and Sophian in his perfect wholeness. As a sexual halved, divided being he is not chaste, or wise, and is doomed to disharmony, to passionate longing and dissatisfaction.

Berdyayev refers to the "horror and curse of sex", calling it a problem which has never been solved, despite the efforts of the ascetics. Sex is the source of life and of death. Man is sick, wounded, and disharmonious because he has lost his wholeness and integrity. There is also a distinction between procreation and creation. Creativity in man depends on the pre-existing world, since only God creates the world.

Man as person is created by God in eternity, but as individual, he is born, or procreated, in time. The masculine and feminine principles interact and complete each other. Woman inspires man to create. Through creation and procreation man strives to attain the wholeness of his being. Berdyayev sums up his view this way:

The power of sex may be overcome and sublimated. Instead of being generative it may become creative and be a spiritual power. Creativeness is closely allied to sexuality. Sexlessness makes man sterile. A sexless being can neither procreate nor create. The moral task is not to destroy the power of sex but to sublimate it, transforming it into a force that creates values. Erotic love is one of such values. Man generates and creates because he is an incomplete being, divided into two and striving for the completeness and wholeness of the androgyne.

Posted on 2013-04-16 by Cologero

* * *

David on 2013-04-17 at 19:49 said:

Good articles, is it interesting to see someone else speaking in the terms of Bachofen with somewhat different conclusions. Two things :

1- «man is both personality and cosmos» Here man is taken as humanity, or as masculine ?

2- This is a general question, but most of the time, there is a neoplatonic and dualistic struggle involved (as in Personhood vs Individualhood; that is, soul vs body). Apart from ancient sources (such as the Advaita Vedanta or the Bible), is there any traditional writers or «first line» writers that wrote about a more monistic view of the Personhood within Tradition? Or is neoplatonism the best way to represent the anthropological point of view of Tradition? Thank you

Cologero on 2013-04-18 at 00:00 said:

Ironically, both Berdyaev and Evola understand Bachofen in the same way: the solar, virile path is to transcend the matriarchal telluric collective. They just don't see eye to eye on the best path to accomplish that, since Berdyaev is Christian and Evola rejects Christianity. That is why labels are never the whole story.

As for point 1, Berdyaev lists three related dichotomies (man is both personality and cosmos, logos and earth, masculine and feminine). How would you understand that.

Don't forget that there are six schools of Vedanta. The corresponding "dualist" school is the Samkhya; it doesn't rule out the non-dual Advaita. So both perspectives are necessary. I think all the writers, at least the ones we are interested in here, have written about the monistic view. This requires the surpassing of the human state. Guido de Giorgio in particular has tried to express that view.

David on 2013-04-18 at 12:37 said:

Thank you for the answer. I will try to read more of De Giorgio. As for point one, my question was badly phrased. If man and woman can both have feminine and masculine, when he says man, does he mean man or human ? This may be clear for you, but in french, we instinctively use man or human and so this is not clear for me. Is he writing only in an andropocentric point of view ? Or does this applies to woman as well ? Thank you.

Cologero on 2013-04-18 at 12:57 said:

Since the book was originally published in French, you may want to check your library. DE LA DESTINATION DE L'HOMME, Part I, Chapter III, section 3. How do you understand the title? I

assume he means women, too, have both characteristics. But more fundamentally, for Berdyaev, there is no “man” as such; there are only men and women.

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-18 at 13:09 said:

Is it possible to use Bachofen to come to a traditional understanding of the transgender phenomenon we are witnessing in this postmodern world of today where all boundaries and categories are being dissolved? From some readings of Evola, it seems to me that he was supportive of “sex changes” as he did see transnies as “women trapped in men’s bodies.”

I am wondering if the presence of male and female elements in the soul of a man means that things can get reversed and deviations could result, thus causing the formation of “tranny” thoughts.

Strangely, Dr Harry Benjamin, one of the pioneers of “sex changes” was part of the New York “fascist” scene and was a friend of Francis Yockey, Lawrence Dennis and Keith Thompson...

...

David on 2013-04-18 at 14:34 said:

Thank you, I will look into the original version.

Cologero on 2013-04-19 at 00:15 said:

J-A, you don’t need Bachofen, since formlessness is the hallmark of the kali yuga; it was predicted and it is occurring. The same too for “deviations” as you mention. They don’t “cause” tranny thoughts, since thought is free. However, as some recent posts have shown, thoughts and images arise from all sources. Those that are dwelled upon can lead to acting them out in strange ways.

I had to dig out Dreamers of the Day to catch your references. It calls Dr. Benjamin a “highly cultured German Jew.” Apparently, only the “uncultured” are uninterested in such deviations. Isn’t he advocating a reverse alchemy, turning gold into lead, or more precisely a man into a woman? That is quite remote from the Great Work. I don’t see how Yockey, et al, represent any sort of fascist spirit, although it may have been an interesting “scene”, and it is being reprised now in San Fran.

It is difficult to be counter cultural, or counter current, today, since those values are now the culture and the current. Perhaps you can launch the venerable tradition of right-wing Catholicism as the new hipster scene in NYC, although without all that “high culture”. Keep me on the evite list for your parties.

Cologero on 2013-04-21 at 11:08 said:

I went back to review Evola’s thoughts on Bachofen, particularly Ch 27 of Revolt, “The Civilization of the Mother”. He points out several consequences of the “dismissal of the virile

element" in the matriarchal cultures. These included:

"Sometimes the priests who felt possessed by the Goddess would go so far as emasculating themselves in order to resemble her and to become transformed into the female type."

"The Lydian Hercules was dressed as a women"

"Those who participated in some Mysteries often wore women's clothes"

"Priests dressed in women's clothes would keep watch in the sacred woods by some ancient Germanic trees"

Certain cults were celebrated with "women dressed as men and men dressed as women"

Perhaps Evola "evolved" on this issue (and you provided no reference, J-A), but what I quoted is hardly "supportive" of your thesis. A different way to look at it is to regard the work of Dr. Benjamin as the symptom of the devolution of the modern world into a gynocratic culture. Her is a further symptom from the same chapter:

"The masculine element and men in general came to be looked down upon as irrelevant, innerly inconsistent, ephemeral, of little value, and as a source of embarrassment."

In our time, I think it is quite obvious which men in particular are regarded in that way, so I'll leave it to readers to figure it out. A clue: it has nothing to do with "glorious" or "virile" pagans.

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-22 at 12:00 said:

As strange as it might sound, the tradition of right wing Catholicism does live in NYC at St Christopher's SSPX chapel on Lexington Avenue & 37th Street every Sunday at 1:30 PM under the tutelage of Fr Kevin Robinson, the only priest I have ever met whom every time I am in his prescence I feel humbled to be before a true man of the cloth.... from personal experience I can say it quite a tough struggle to live tradition in the heart of the city that is alll of the world's decadence but I thrive in a struggle so that is why I chose this life....

You hit upon a noteworthy matter – Christianity when it first appeared, as I see it, was a truly "conservative revolution" in the sense that the pagan Roman society had become utterly and completely corrupt beyond all hope of repair. Guenon goes into this in *Crisis of the Modern World*, also Fabre D'Olivet had mentioned this as well. Nowadays with society being as immoral as Caligula and Nero (is there any shock over why those 2 men are icons of the fag movements of today ?) the situation allow for the Church to reemerge as the counterculture of sanity again as it was during its first 300 years....

While we're on the subject, what is your opinion of Yockey and his ideas ? Dreamer of the Day puzzled me because from my reading of Imperium and his other works, Yockey struck me as a right wing Catholic but Coogan's biography claims he was a sexual deviant and theosophic-minded occultist.... I don't trust Coogan the liberal to write truth though....

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-22 at 12:08 said:

This is the passage from METAPHYSICS OF SEX that cause me to believe Evola supported transgenderism and sex changes :

In natural homosexuality or in the predisposition to it, the most straightforward explanation is provided by what we said earlier about the differing levels of sexual development and about the fact that the process of sexual development in its physical and, even more so, in its psychic aspects can be incomplete. In that way, the original bisexual nature is surpassed to a lesser extent than in a “normal” human being, the characteristics of one sex not being predominant over those of the other sex to the same extent. Next we must deal with what M. Hirschfeld called the “intermediate sexual forms”. In cases of this kind (for instance, when a person who is nominally a man is only 60 percent male) it is impossible that the erotic attraction based on the polarity of the sexes in heterosexuality – which is much stronger the more the man is male and the woman is female – can also be born between individuals who, according to the birth registry and as regards only the so-called primary sexual characteristics, belong to the same sex, because in actual fact they are “intermediate forms”. In the case of pederasts, Ulrich said rightly that it is possible to find “the soul of a woman born in the body of a man”.

Cologero on 2013-04-22 at 20:07 said:

This may serve as an explanation, but it not necessarily indicate “support”. In any case, such a being is “incomplete” and an “intermediate form”. It doesn’t follow that any surgical or hormonal reassignment can result in completion.

Cologero on 2013-04-23 at 07:27 said:

You may have touched on a nerve, J-A, since Coogan’s book soured me on Yockey; perhaps unfairly as you point out. Yet, some, who believe they are part of “tradition”, are obsessed with the dark, the macabre, the ugly, the perverse, the deviant, bondage, domination, etc., in short, everything that is the opposite of solarly. And their footprint on the Internet is not insignificant.

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-23 at 13:39 said:

I fully agree, the worldview of Gothic rock has no place in the life of an aristocrat. Light shall triumph over the darkness.

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-23 at 13:42 said:

Indeed, a “transwoman” is simply a man who has mutilated his body, as the Church teaches us – so the question I have regarding fags, trannies and other deviants is – should they be “saved” via deprogramming as many Christians attempt to do, with poor results usually, or should we just allow them to exist as the dregs of society as Evola – and also the Hindus and Buddhists – counsels ?

2.9 Journey through the Planets

All things are in pairs, each the opposite of the other, but nothing the Lord made is incomplete. Everything completes the goodness of something else. Could anyone ever see enough of this splendor?

SIRACH 42:24-25

Quantum Entanglements Two quantum physical particles are entangled when their states are not independent of each other. That is, if the quantum state of one particle changes, then the corresponding state of the other also changes. This happens instantaneously, even at a distance.

By the Law of Correspondences, two beings can also be entangled. **Henry Corbin**, in *The Man of Light in Iranian Sufism*, develops this idea from traditional sources. He describes the entanglement this way:

To speak of the polar dimension as the transcendent dimension of the earthly individuality is to point out that it includes a counterpart, a heavenly “partner”, and that its total structure is that of a bi-unity, a unus-ambo. This unus-ambo can be taken as an alternation of the first and second person, as forming a dialogic unity thanks to the identity of their essence and yet without confusion of persons.

That implies that every being in the human state has a counterpart. They share the same essence, yet they are different persons. Their “alteration”, although it takes place as conversation, is more like a mirror. The orientations differ, yet they are intertwined: a change in one results in an immediate and corresponding change in the other; hence they share an essential nature. Yet neither one alone is the “real” being. Rather, the two together form a unity, i.e., the true Self.

Adam and Eve In *Swedenborg and Esoteric Islam*, Corbin brings this concept closer to home based on revelations to Emmanuel Swedenborg. Analogous to Paul's description of the pneumatic, psychical, and hylic persons, Swedenborg identifies them based on one's own understanding of selfhood or ipseity:

- The **Material person** believes that his own self is everything, so his existence would cease without it. This situation is infernal.
- The **Spiritual person** understands, but only in a theoretical way, that the power of thinking and acting arise from his Principle.
- The **Celestial person** has the actual experience of his Self. This Self is like that of an angel.

Adam, in the state of deep sleep, believes that he lives, thinks, speaks, and acts from himself alone. Spinoza, for example, recognized the illusion of that state, although he lacked an adequate solution. Adam rouses from sleep as he sees the illusory aspect of his belief. Fully awakened, he sees that he is no longer alone. Corbin emphasizes the importance of this insight:

it is one of the most profound arcana that there is to meditate upon.

Before this transformation, Adam's proprium, or inmost self, appears to the angels as something bony and inanimate. The ribs surround the heart.

Afterwards, Adam's proprium is vivified. Eve is Adam's proprium or Self. Corbin elaborates on this symbolism:

the masculine or man symbolizes the intelligence and everything that relates to it, consequently all things of wisdom and faith, while

the feminine or woman signifies or symbolizes the will, consequently all things relating to love, and consequently relating to life, since life proceeds only from love.

Hence, this will is the nucleus or inmost heart of the human being. Thus, the heart is not the nous as some believe, but rather resides in the emotional center. While Eve is the proprium of the internal man, the projection of Eve as other than Adam results in a process of exteriorization. Adam is no longer simply material, but he is not yet celestial. Although he realizes that he is incomplete, he cannot recognize his Self interiorly. Hence, Eve is a projection onto a different person.

Eve, on the other hand, longs for the wholeness that Adam fails to see.

The Double The idea of the Double has been part of Tradition, even if the understanding is not always complete. **Charles Stang**, in *Our Divine Double*, documents the history of this idea. He distinguishes the double into horizontal and vertical versions. The horizontal double appears in pagan stories as well as more contemporary writers. This double is uncanny and even menacing. Rudolf Steiner saw that double in terms of lower beings named Lucifer and Ahriman.

The vertical, or divine, double, on the other hand, was known to Plato. The divine double makes possible the ascent to the Intelligible reality of the divine forms. In the *Phaedo*, Socrates suggests that the Lover and the Beloved should serve as mirrors to each other. Each sees the best version of himself in that mirror. That does not mean that “Love is Blind,” but rather just the opposite. Love sees what is True and Beautiful in the other, beyond merely material forms.

The Vertical Ascent Dante saw the full significance of the Divine Double. On the Earth, our essences are hidden from each other because of the interference of our physical bodies. The outside can conceal the

inside. Specifically, our facial expressions and gestures can hide our true thoughts and feelings as much as they might also reveal those thoughts. Hence, Beatrice did not recognize Dante in this life as her double or polar being.

The vertical ascent through the planetary spheres represents the attainment of higher states of being. Here, the polar couple help each other; they see in the other what could not be seen. If the gross body veils the truth, then each planet lifts another veil until all is revealed.

Jacob Boehme reveals that Adam was originally separated from Sophia, his feminine Self. In compensation, Eve, the external feminine, was given to Adam. Corbin explains this:

Adam-Eve is the sophianic couple, because Eve is the proprium of Adam, his proprium vivified by the Divine Presence; the Adam-Eve couple has the perception of all the Good of love and the Truth of faith and consequently possesses all wisdom and all intelligence in ineffable joy.

The polar couple experiences such joy as they journey through the planets. There is no hurry, they have eternity on their side, leading ultimately to the alchemical marriage.

Posted on 2021-05-16 by Cologero

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Hugo Smith on 2021-05-17 at 22:35 said:

In the alchemical marriage, shouldn't the two halves be temperamental opposites, since they are incomplete on their own?

Cologero on 2021-05-17 at 23:31 said:

temperamental opposites? You are restricting yourself to the psychological plane, not the metaphysical plane. Mirror images are opposite in a way. Next time, try to quote the text where your concern is properly addressed.

Hugo Smith on 2021-05-19 at 03:12 said:

Sorry, I was actually searching for the right word there and settled on “temperamental”. The part of the text that gave me pause was “...Socrates suggests that the Lover and the Beloved should serve as mirrors to each other”.

Like you said, this doesn't necessarily imply that the lover and beloved aren't opposites. I was thinking of the Hermetic idea that the lovers must reconcile themselves in each other, like extremes meeting in a sort of spiritual paradox (passive/active, red king/white queen, sun/moon etc).

Cologero on 2021-05-19 at 07:45 said:

Do you understand at all how to have a conversation? You don't get a mulligan, i.e., a second chance to make the same point. Consider this from **Rumi**:

*Listen to the story told by the reed, of being separated.
“Since I was cut from the reedbed,
I have made this crying sound.
Anyone apart from someone he loves
understands what I say.”*

Do you feel that? Have you experienced that separation from your Beloved? Have you longed to unite? Then you might understand the point.

Of do you wake up every morning, thinking: “I'd really like to reconcile the spiritual paradox today.” We are talking about persons, not abstractions.

Start taking your life seriously.

Hugo Smith on 2021-05-19 at 12:43 said:

Did I write something that made you mad?

In conversation, people often rephrase things when they think someone doesn't understand. I'll try to take that last sentence to heart.

Cologero on 2021-05-23 at 18:35 said:

No, I don't get “mad”, I am just a good actor. Trust me, I do understand.

2.10 Diotima Unveiled

As I have been seeking inspiration for a personal project this week, my muse suggested this addendum to the discussion of Diotima. She can

not only see past, present, and future, but she can lift souls out of the depths of ignorance and darkness.

The idea of Absolute Beauty is timeless. Hence, one does not ascend the ladder in successive, well demarcated steps. Each step can be associated with a state of being and Guenon explains its meaning.

All states of the being, considered under their primary aspect,
abide in perfect simultaneousness in the eternal now.

Hence, one abides on all the steps of the ladder simultaneously. The step you are “on” is just the one to which you direct conscious attention. The most common state is to be in a dream-like state of semi wakefulness, and will therefore, unconsciously, be drawn to the most material step of the ladder, which is physical love.

Sweet Love Unlike blasphemy, murder, theft, perjury and so on, which are intrinsically evil, physical love is in itself not evil in itself. However, it may be situationally evil, or perhaps better said, it may be expressed in appropriate or inappropriate ways. That is why such lovers are in the first, or the least painful, level of hell.

Such love is quite delightful which is why it also serves as a trap. Even when it grows sour, as it often does, the being tries to “fix” it or else find it again with someone else. A being on this step is reluctant to move on to higher stages.

Soul Love The first stage is restricted to the two lower sheaths of the subtle body: desire and emotional connections. The creative power of sexual energy is restricted to procreation. Obviously, children are necessary for the nation and the family to perpetuate and thrive. There is human love for nation, family, and children, although even animals care for their offspring. To do less, is to live even below the animals. For the

ancient Romans, the *proletariat* were those who had nothing to offer society other than their children. So, it is not yet the fulfilment of all human possibilities.

This requires the training of the emotions to feel a wider range of emotions and to experience them more deeply. And what is distinctly human is intellectual development: the ability to distinguish right from wrong, the real from the unreal. It is the seat of creativity, innovation, and so on.



The more one actualizes his intellectual soul, the more he will be able to recognize those qualities in another. His intellectual life becomes so fascinating and pleasurable, the memories of sweet love begin to fade. Instead, he longs for a higher connection. His desire is to share ideas on music, literature, poetry, history, metaphysics, and the like. Procreation reappears as intellectual creation at this stage.

Sweet love follows a pattern of exhaustion and replenishment; energy is dissipated in its act. Soul love is not like that. It is energizing, energy doubles, so nothing is lost.

When the opportunity is presented, it is taken.

Possession It must again be emphasized that this has nothing to do with evolution, or psychological growth. All the stages exist simultaneously; the limitations of human language make it sound like some sort of progress.

A fortiori, soul love is not a substitute for failures at a lower level. If there is no desire at the physical level, there can be no desire, not in its full expression, at the intellectual level. And many men today lack such desire.

Since the present age is a deviation from previous eras, what follows

my not follow current trends exactly.

In the past, love and marriage was an option reserved for the lower classes. High status people often had to marry for other reasons, particularly to strengthen political or commercial alliances. For them, the purpose of sex was to create children.

Man tends to want to enjoy before possessing while woman needs to possess before enjoying. This was necessary when women needed a stable relationship in which to raise children and to be protected from strangers intent on enjoying. So the high status woman was secure in her possession but love had to be found elsewhere.

Hence, the notion of courtly love arose. The wandering knight became suitable for that purpose. He is able to enjoy, but he is not in a position to possess because of his wanderings. The early knights were purely physical brutes tied to a particular area, but the solo knight errant developed a code of chivalry and high culture. Thus, the knight could fulfil the soul needs of the high status woman without thereby threatening her marriage or children.

The Veil There is a misconception about the veil, as though its sole purpose is to control woman; this is used by Westerners to belittle cultures that still practice it. In more ancient times, pagan and even Christian cultures used the veil. However, it was restricted to high status women. It is a sign that she is more than just a beauty that can be put on display willy nilly for just anyone to see.

The custom persisted until a few generations ago. On more formal occasions, my mother wore a light veil that covered her entire face. Even today a bride wears such a veil at her wedding.

In our time, we can use imaginary veils. Keep that thought as a reminder to try to pierce the veil to see the soul life of the other. If you need some other motivation, that is a necessary Hermetic exercise.

Posted on 2021-02-16 by Cologero

* * *

Tannheuser on 2021-02-17 at 17:51 said:

The difference between “sweet love” and “soul love” can also be characterized a difference between passivity and activity. Sweet love (“I am in love”) begins as a passion, something that happens to you, whereas soul love (“I love”) is really an action, or something you do – it requires focus, effort, and engages the higher faculties of the soul. As you say, however, the active and passive exist simultaneously and are interdependent.

Tannheuser on 2021-02-18 at 13:18 said:

As for the lack of desire and eroticism on a physical level, Yukio Mishima described this condition as resulting from a lack of contact with the Absolute, or God. It takes only a little reflection to realize the truth of this – it is the only thing separating human eroticism from that of animals mating on a Discovery Channel documentary.

From an interview shortly before his death:

“The beauty-eroticism-death diagram, to which I referred a little while ago, is a concept that demands that the second element, eroticism, cannot exist except in the realm of the absolute. As for Europe, eroticism is only found in the world of Catholicism. This religion has severe commandments whose violation constitutes sin. And the sinner, whether he likes it or not, must appear before God. Well, eroticism is the method of establishing contact with divinity through sin... In the relativism of today’s world, however, eroticism is no more than a kind of free sex. It’s not opposed to anything. It is sex without any relation to the absolute. In my opinion, nothing could be further from true eroticism.

...In my opinion, one should only speak of eroticism when the human being risks his life and seeks pleasure until death, which is as if he arrived at the absolute from the reverse. If the gods did not exist, they would have to be reborn. And without God there is no eroticism. And because of this way of thinking of mine, I have done the impossible to make the absolute reborn. That is when eroticism arises. What does all this have to do with everyday sex? Well, nothing. Let’s say it is a kind of ‘paneroticism’.

That’s it. This search is the main objective of my literature.”

Paulo Adolpho Zeymer Netto on 2021-02-19 at 03:09 said:

“The *âme soeur* (literally “soul sister”) is not just another life partner, and certainly not a concubine. The idea of “sister” should indicate that it is a chaste, not sexual, relationship. Moreover, it indicates a close bond of affinity, not in the biological or genetic sense, but certainly in terms of spiritual races.”

Cologero, please clarify this to me, i have found her, but i could never feel sexual desire for her, so how exactly can we finally be together??? What exactly can bind us together for real and

for ever, in a physical sense?

Cologero on 2021-02-21 at 09:39 said:

You are an astute reader, Paulo, as I had forgotten that passage. If you look back, one of our very first posts, that has set the trajectory all these years, was about that complete relationship that you desire.

But pay attention to the idea expressed that all the states exist simultaneously, so it is not either/or. It depends on where your consciousness is focused. At one time, you desire her sexually. That is how you experience her for yourself.

Yet, at another time, you will see your kindred soul in her, and relate that non-sexual way. Then you will see here as she is in-herself and for-herself, as a thinking, feeling, willing being complementary to you.

I wish you all the best.

2.II Love is Blind

Anyone who does not love does not know God, because God is love.

I JOHN 4:8

The proof of love is the showing forth of the work.

GREGORY THE GREAT, *Homily XXX*

You may have heard it said that the Intellect is superior to Love, because the Intellect knows, but Love is blind. The opposite is the case. The Intellect is passive because it can only reflect the Truth, but Love is Active because it acts and can create the Good.

Thus Plato stopped short at the contemplation of the Idea of the Good, mistaking that for God. Since God is Love, the next stage is to bring the Good into manifestation, as Gregory the Great said. Nevertheless, Plato was correct because one should only love what is good, and only the Intellect, or nous, knows the Good. Therefore, the role of the Intellect is to show Love what is worthy to be loved.

- Will of Heaven: Upward Pull
- Mystical marriage
- Nous: Free choice of the Good
- Thumos: Emotional Attachment
- Eros: Blind Attraction
- Physical: Fundamental forces
- Gravity: Downward pull to matter

Love is manifested differently in each of the states of being. At the physical layer, attraction is automatic and indiscriminate. Magnets attract just because they are magnetic. At the lower levels of the human being, eros and thumos, Love is truly blind. Eros drives the sexual instinct without regard to the goodness of the object of desire. Thumos adds a strong emotional content to desire. Emotions make Love blind to the idea of goodness or badness. We see that frequently in relationships. Even after the loved one is bad, emotions make it difficult the end things.

Nous, on the other hand, is objective and can distinguish between the good and bad. In an ordered soul, the knowledge of the nous will dominate thumos and eros: it will desire what is good and feel a corresponding attraction. Otherwise, desires and emotions will overwhelm the Intellect so that it serves man's lower nature instead of leading the being to seek the Good.

Alchemical Marriage

For whoever has achieved the perfect realization of unity in himself, all opposition has ceased and with it the state of war, for from

the standpoint of totality, which lies beyond all particular standpoints, nothing remains but absolute order. Nothing can thereafter harm such a being, since for him there are no longer any enemies, either within him or without.

RENE GUENON, *Symbolism of the Cross*

The psychic preparation described by Dorn an alchemist is therefore an attempt, uninfluenced by the East, to bring about a union of opposites in accordance with the great Eastern philosophies, and to establish for this purpose a principle freed from the opposites and similar to the atman or tao.

CARL JUNG, *Mysterium Coniunctionis*

The highest good of the human state is to achieve wholeness. The alchemists described a path to that realization, albeit cloaked in symbolic language. It begins with self-knowledge. It is imperative to emphasize that knowledge of the Self is NOT the same as knowledge of the ego or one's personality quirks.

That wholeness is a return to the Primordial State, the union of Adam-Eve. The metals of alchemical symbolism refer to the male and female aspects of the soul. For a man, the love of a woman, real or imagined, who transcends the duties of human marriage, helps awaken that self-knowledge. Ultimately, they will unite in a higher state of being.

Posted on 2022-07-31 by Cologero

* * *

Ole on 2022-08-01 at 07:40 said:
The Wedding at Cana :-)

Adil on 2022-08-01 at 12:34 said:

One has to wonder whether the metaphysical cause to the gender dysphoria of the current age is a result of the disintegration of this Adam-Eve principle, where the poles come in conflict. That would mean that there is an ironic merit to the gender fluid aspirations of postmodernism, albeit not in the sense of physically changing your gender, but actually achieving the “non-binary” wholeness that comes from integrating the anima or animus.

The feminine heart of the Catholic Church once greatly attracted me to her, which seemed to have a mystical lure that simply was gone in the Protestant Christianity. I realize now it was the Virgin, who has been neglected in the West.

Auld Wat on 2022-08-01 at 17:16 said:

Will of Heaven: Upward Pull

Mystical marriage

Nous: Free choice of the Good

Thumos: Emotional Attachment

Eros: Blind Attraction

Physical: Fundamental forces

Gravity: Downward pull to matter

Is the first part missing from no. 2?

Balder on 2022-08-02 at 17:55 said:

@Adil: Robert Bolton has a very good phrase in his *The Order of the Ages* that can be related to the gender dysphoria: *The Submergence of Distinctions*. In this he describes how Man and Woman are archetypes incarnated in human beings, and I would say that the gender dysphoria some increasingly feel is one sign of the times in which the divine archetypes are increasingly under dissolution from inside and outside. I regard the propaganda related to the issue to be almost absolutely evil in which a mental illness related to the relentless dissolution is given an almost holy appearance, as in the sense of “cursed saints of our times”. I can easily recommend the book as a whole to see what is going on and how universal time realizes evil. The “submergence of distinctions” is a one way to say how the diabolical impulse can realize the perversion of divine unity.

3.1 Leaving the Cave

In his science fiction short story “The Crime and the Glory of Commander Suzdal”, former Pentagon official and expert on psychological warfare Cordwainer Smith describes a planet which is toxic to femininity. Colonists from earth survive by making their women male. As a result of this modification the colonists start developing a massive hate for normal women and families back on earth and aim for their destruction.

The Need for Intimacy “Feminism” has never been about anything feminine. Neither is the invention of the term “toxic masculinity” aimed at men. Both expressions are meant to conceal femininity. They create a narrative which makes it impossible to achieve any kind of consistency between what you really see and feel and what you are supposed to see and feel according to that narrative. As a consequence, men went into hiding and women became male, which in turn rendered femininity an unknown mystery to both men and women.

However, most women on planet Earth are still women and many of them would like to develop more intimacy in their relationships with men. We cannot do this however if deep within their souls men remain detached not only from their wives or girlfriends but even from themselves. Femininity is incapable of making a decision. It cannot become an end in itself — it is searching for a purpose. Intimacy then arises from the feeling of being needed. A man's indifference towards himself makes it impossible for a woman to feel needed as a lover, let alone as a resemblance of his Anima. She will never be able to make up for a man's missing self-respect, because she is thriving on that man's Self. She will cherish, inspire and even submit to it, but she cannot create it.



Integrity vs. Potential

It is foolish to judge woman with the values of the absolute man even in cases where, by doing violence to her own self, she makes a show of following those values and even sincerely believes that she is following them.

JULIUS EVOLA, *The Metaphysics of Sex*

The question is, why should a quality be viewed as a flaw? This development has led to so many misunderstandings, anger, and sadness for men and women alike that it is almost impossible to take a step back and have a look at where we came from. When Weininger bemoans a woman's "lack of being" or Evola explains that for a woman a lie never "breaks her own existential law", it might seem well and rationally explained from a male perspective, but still contains a judgement or rather a measurement. A woman never draws a border like that. In fact, she cannot.

Potential is to woman what integrity is to man. Potential is boundless and needs to be actualised. There have been many such concepts mentioned on this site, e.g., Purusha and Prakriti, Hyle and Morphe etc. In order to understand a woman's sudden change of opinion, mood, preferences and her simultaneous vacuous conformity to so-called public opinion it is helpful to leave judgement aside for a moment and ask why should somebody want to be like that? Without principles? Without imagination? Is it a conscious choice to be like that? Is it a choice at all? Why should something exist that morphs into something else the moment it feels needed? Without bothering that it is contradicting itself or behaving seemingly disloyal to earlier promises?

There are many disappointed mothers out there who take great pleasure in sharing little anecdotes about how the character of their daughters has undergone a sudden change since their wedding day. Not only did these daughters pick up the vocabulary of their spouses, but all of a sudden also preferred different food, changed their denomination, or even their religion altogether — the list of “changes” those mothers are keen to spot in their estranged married daughters is endless. Likewise, you will hear complaints from ex-boyfriends and ex-husbands who are perplexed when they realise that their former lovers or wives are finally dressing the way they had always begged them to dress or engage in exactly the kind of sexual practices they had always dreamed of — but they do it now with their new man and would have never done so for their ex-boyfriends or ex-husbands.

So again, why would anyone want to be like that? What is the reason for such a behaviour or is it really simply weakness? Are men not better off without women? No risks, no strings attached?

Authority and Submission Of course a woman understands the difference between truth and a lie. She even expects to be told the truth and detects a lie faster than any man would be able to, simply because he does

not expect to be lied to. So why does she not feel affected by her own lies whereas a man gets the feeling of utter destruction when faced with a lie? If the mode of existence for women is potentiality this means there is no real lie, no right nor wrong unless a certain potential has been realised.

This realisation is something women cannot do by themselves. I agree, this sounds strange after more than a century during which we have been told that women can do just whatever they want. Maybe we can — if we know what we want. But what we want changes ceaselessly unless there is a real call for submission. However, the following act of submission needs to be received by someone. So why do men tend to run away from that gift? Live up to it! That's exactly what a woman's potential is all about: It is a gift to a man's quest for integrity.

As Nietzsche describes the quest for Sophia in *Thus spoke Zarathustra*:

Brave, untroubled, mocking, violent — that is how wisdom wants us to be: she is a woman and never loves anyone but a warrior.

Male integrity needs to be proven in the same way female potentiality needs to remain opaque, uncategorised and uncharacterised. If a woman is constantly forced into the act of deciding and determining, sexual attraction becomes impossible. A man that does not even bother to take care of himself can't expect a woman to decide what his life is all about.

Women are not capable of creating a man. He has to make the effort to know himself before he can reveal that Self to a woman in order to *know her*. What women can do is to create themselves according to the information they receive from a man. It is an expression of gratitude and not a sign of weakness due to a "lack of being" on the part of the woman as Weininger put it. It is the essence of femininity. What follows actually comes close to what has been termed "Authority" on this blog. It is a natural acknowledgement of the risks a man went through to encounter his own Self.

If this quality of femininity is deemed unnecessary, weak or even a flaw, women become superfluous. Where there is no need for femininity, women deteriorate into a state of always remaining the lesser part, insufficient strange creatures who “lack being” and will be measured according to the values of men, which is probably the reason why, perceiving themselves as lesser men, women have a hard time living up to their own expectations.

Nowadays harm is caused not so much anymore by propaganda which is so obviously nonsensical, but by refusing to see what is right there in front of you. Men and women haven’t changed. Words and terms can’t create reality. However, perception and acknowledgement of what actually exists influence the way we deal with that reality. That’s a challenge men face as well as women. Why not try and work this out together? Leaving the cave¹ and opening up that space for women again would be a first step.

In the science fiction story Commander Suzdal managed to save femininity on earth from destruction by the male-females from the space colony. Subsequently he was stripped of his rank and his name. He was denied life as well as death for not asking for permission to act the way he did. Smith writes: “But the crime was that he had succeeded.” — The same goes for his glory.

Posted on 2021-01-03 by Sibylle

* * *

Solphomeron on 2021-01-08 at 22:42 said:

“Body of a woman, white hills, white thighs,
you look like a world, lying in surrender.
My rough peasant’s body digs in you
and makes the son leap from the depth of the earth.

¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=13522>

I was lone like a tunnel. The birds fled from me,
and night swamped me with its crushing invasion.
To survive myself I forged you like a weapon,
like an arrow in my bow, a stone in my sling. ...”

Sibylle on 2021-01-09 at 17:15 said:

“I am asham’d that women are so simple
To offer war where they should kneel for peace;
Or seek for rule, supremacy, and sway,
When they are bound to serve, love, and obey.
Why are our bodies soft and weak and smooth,
Unapt to toil and trouble in the world,
But that our soft conditions and our hearts
Should well agree with our external parts?”

3.2 Nigredo, Albedo and Rubedo

Imagine the life of a contemporary version of “Snow White”. The Evil Queen still wants to kill her stepdaughter. But she has learned from her previous mistakes and got the seven dwarves to abandon their mine. Instead, they are roaming the lands of World of Warcraft, because the Queen made them regard their hard labour as an unnecessary relict from some dark, uncivilised past. For reasons of animal welfare, the hunter was banned from hunting and moved away. So what about the Prince? He is nowhere to be found. Rumour has it that he probably never existed in the first place and had only been designed as a distraction to prevent young girls from becoming astrophysicists and CEOs. By removing every male character from the fairy tale, will the Evil Queen finally achieve the death of Snow White?

The Killing of Snow White Nobel Laureate Elfriede Jelinek makes short work of Snow White in her drama *Death and the Maiden I*: her hunter shoots Snow White dead. Needless to say, this act of violence is

celebrated as a feminist victory over the so-called patriarchal stereotype of beauty and the feminine wish to please. Snow White is dead and women are no longer perceived as beautiful “objects”. If this assertion were to be correct, it would mean that the only force responsible for the “eternal enslavement” of woman is woman herself. So doing away with her is the way out then?

In her collection of plays called *Princess dramas*, Jelinek alleges that woman is excluded from truth, because she is incapable of knowing herself as a “subject”. She further states: “[My] texts are partly very philosophic, they make fun of the philosophy of Heidegger, because the areas where woman has been excluded the most have always been thinking and music.” In other words: killing Snow White wasn’t enough for Jelinek, she also wishes to exclude woman from Western heritage by negating the very point of music and thinking — i.e., the inclusion of woman into the hearts and minds of men.



In defence of Jelinek one could argue that she might not have had much of a choice other than to kill her inner Snow White in order to survive the harassment by her own mother. If faced with the envy of an Evil Queen and no male rescuers at hand, what is Snow White supposed to do if she wants to stay alive? So before condemning Jelinek for her brutality one has to acknowledge that the death of Snow White could have been her last resort. If the feature that constitutes Snow White’s existence is a crime, she simply cannot exist. Matriarchy means the extinction of Snow White as well as the Prince — that is to say: the extinction of love.

Transformation

But I have no time for such things; and the reason, my friend, is this. I am still unable, as the Delphic inscription orders, to know myself; and it really seems to be ridiculous to look into other things before I have understood that.

PLATO, *Phaedrus*

The list of psychological analyses of Snow White is long, rumours about a Rosicrucian origin of the symbolism are widespread — I am not going to recount them here. I would rather like to dismiss the superficial notion that the story is merely about a mother-daughter conflict which will be resolved once Snow White grows up, ceases to be an object of pleasure and finally gets hold of the keys to her own “subjectivity”. The impossibility of being Snow White arises from the Evil Queen’s desire for subjectivity. She cannot tolerate beauty that has no intention of its own. Snow White does not suffer from a lack of subjectivity. Under the tyranny of the Evil Queen she is nothing but subjectivity. Without men to marvel at her beauty, to turn her into an object, to save her from death and no dwarves to take care of, she will never be able to “transform” — and fulfil the destiny of the fairy tale.

I am really no expert on alchemy, but in order to achieve “transformation” you need to do something to a substance. If Snow White is supposed to transform from “nigredo” to “albedo” to “rubedo”, she needs an impulse from the outside. There is no way for her to develop, if she cannot experience herself as an object. However, it is certainly not the Evil Queen who will bring that change about: her poisoned “gifts” are only meant to encourage vanity and tie Snow White ever closer to her matriarchic rule of total subjectivity.

What possibilities does Snow White have without the hunter, the dwarves and the Prince? How is she supposed to relate to the world if nobody relates to her? There is simply no Snow White left to write a fairy tale about. Without the “transformation” of the subject into an object

— dialectic — there would be no “fourth kind of madness” in *Phaedrus*, no pity with Francesca da Rimini in Dante’s *Commedia*, no path to any kind of knowledge beyond personal emotions and opinions.

Marcela Maybe the “post-structuralist” writer Jelinek sincerely believes subjects have a story of their own. But wasn’t it Jelinek’s compatriot Wittgenstein who showed that the “thinking, imagining subject” does not exist? That the “I” as a subject remains unattainable for thought because it constitutes “a border of the world”? By killing Snow White Jelinek excluded herself — and as a sophist who is trying to justify her action by claiming the status of a victim, she remains the Evil Queen’s most submissive slave.

Now that Snow White has accepted the fact that there will be no hunter, no dwarves and certainly no Prince, she can either become like her tormented and jealous (step)mother or a “sexually emancipated” (Jelinek’s self-description), mentally mutilated writer who tries to avoid death by killing herself. So far so good. Maybe there is a third option. Instead of getting bruised by struggling against Wittgenstein’s border she could ask Marcela for asylum and accept her own existence without being either ashamed of or sorry for it. Dialectic and devotion can be powerful tools to reduce subjectivity. If she tries really hard, Snow White might manage to transform from “nigredo” to “albedo”. “Rubedo” however will remain out of reach until the Prince finally hears what heaven wills, realises what fate ordains and does his job.

I suppose some would say “rubedo” is dispensable. Those are the ones that tell you the Prince is merely a fantasy and Snow White needs to be killed in order for women to become “subjects”. If “red” were dispensable, *Phaedrus* would remain without Socrates’ second speech and we would know nothing of the “fourth kind of madness”. Some say Marcela represents that fourth kind of madness. Really? Others frame her as the first feminist. Think again: Marcela is the absolute object, completely

void of subjectivity and will — thus the negation of the Evil Queen. What the Evil Queen, and Jelinek, fail to grasp, Marcela articulates unmistakably:

until now Heaven has not ordained that I love. And to think that I shall love of my own accord [amar por elección] is to think the impossible.

CERVANTES, *Don Quixote*

Love is not a choice. Either you love or you don't, but it is not a decision. You can decide to pursue a relationship with someone. It is a choice to sleep with somebody. You can choose to get married. But to love is not a choice. The choice a woman has to make though is to let go of herself — let go of “subjectivity”. Otherwise she will not recognise love even if a man is on his knees begging for her love. So yes: Snow White actually has to die, not as a victim of the Queen but as a sacrifice to the Prince.

To a woman the love of a man is incomprehensible. She sees it, she hears it, she might enjoy it, be overwhelmed by it and eventually fall in love, but she does not comprehend it. So Marcela is cruel? Is it cruel not to be able to love “of your own accord”? To be unable to feel love unless a man makes you feel it? Why else would music exist? Poetry and art? Are they dispensable? Objects are thought of, written and sung about. Unlike subjects, they are never excluded.

The meaning of the alchemical stages are:

- **Nigredo:** spiritual death
- **Albedo:** purification
- **Rubedo:** the attainment of a coherent sense of self

Posted on 2021-01-27 by Sibylle

3.3 The Test

Although Evola always writes in a discursive style, he advises us that it is only the rishis, the seers, the clairvoyants who can fully understand. In many ways, Miguel Serrano picks up on some of Evola's themes, though from the perspective of a clairvoyant rather than a metaphysician. In the following passage, Serrano describes the highest Tantric teachings while bringing in the major elements of the esoteric teachings from the Middle Ages: the Grail legends, the Templars, troubadours.

The ultimate end is identical for both Evola and Serrano. Both reject the mysticism of pantheism which looks to the annihilation of the Self and its merging into the Totality. Rather, they proclaim the Absolute Self, the raising up from the merely human to the higher states, the process of deification, atman=brahman.

Thus were completed the different stages of this most ancient Hyperborean Initiation of A-Mor, revealed in the mystery of the Grail, in the esotericism of the troubadours and the Minnesänger of the High Middle Ages. Transported to the icy wastes of the south of the world, with Parsifal, in a Templars' ship, with the Vermilion Cross on its white sails and all its lights on, as the saga tells us, and from 'whence it never returned'. To the true Kingdom of Hyperborea of the White Gods of America-Albania.

And while the ultimate test of this initiation was taking place in that ancient night, with a man and a woman lying naked side by side, separated by a sword, without taking possession of each other's physical body, she explained to him in her musical voice full of longing for eternity: 'The light doesn't come from the east. Light is only truly light in the depths of midnight. Now is the depths of midnight. The followers of Lucifer, of the Morning Star, do not beg to be allowed into heaven. They demand to be, because they feel that they have done everything possible to merit being deified. At the end of our road, no fusion with a god or redeemer

awaits us. Our way is not the way of ecstasy of the saints but the way of separation of the magicians, of the White Gods who have become absorbed into the sources of creative energy. Creating worlds, loving each other inside and outside eternity. We do not beg, like the lunar troubadour: "Take us back to where you took us from!" We are going to try and change God, giving him a face. Therefore, my love, do not take possession of my body. Let us not create children of the flesh. I will make you pregnant with the son of death. And we will both remain virgins.'

'I understand,' he whispered. 'The chastity of the sacred warrior is the nobility of his sexual act, the refusal to tolerate all that is brutal, because his feeling for the beauty of that act prevents him doing so. The Wounded King also said this.'

'It is an immaterial irrevocability. The Grail doesn't tolerate unbridled passions, it loves pious reticence, a reverent attitude. And I will not destroy your magic virility, dividing your flesh and mine, giving you children of the flesh to bring new opportunities to other individuals, when such a great possibility already exists for us. I will not lure you into loving my body in the only way known to the dark age, because that way death will swallow you up. I will never be the Great devouring Mother, the Primordial Female, who will turn you into a vanquished warrior, living in a dream of unfulfilled glories. I will be the She who leads you to heaven. Because it is your magic virility which will enable us to travel along the river of death. Your sacred virility will enable us to return to life. Do you remember the words of the ascetic of the Grail?: "You will become a woman if you love the body of a woman." This is so: because *only by becoming effeminate could you satisfy the erotic sensibilities of a woman's physical body*. The chaste warrior is the more virile one. To take physical possession of the beloved is to lose one's soul. True possession is the mental possession of all the other bodies. With the memory or your beloved in your heart, you will achieve the Grail. *The genuine or-*

gasm isn't a physical one but another which is endless, and which is produced by your contact with my invisible bodies, where you will find the perfume of my visible body, the warmth of my lips, the amorous racing of my blood intensified. As I will find in yours. We must discover this love together, when we are no longer made of mortal flesh but of red imperishable matter. By loving my body, which lies beside you, you will make it even more material, you will turn it into a body made of lead.'

MIGUEL SERRANO, *Nos: Book of the Resurrection*

[emphasis by editor]

Posted on 2008-08-30 by Cologero

* * *

imperator on 2008-09-08 at 18:08 said:

Wonderful section, packed with philosophical fury. Warrior-asceticism, something like a new Templar order to combat the mafias and anarchists of modernity, is what shall bring salvation to the West, not masochistic limp-wristed priests.

JA on 2013-07-25 at 01:56 said:

Serrano was a strange man, his books sometimes contain profound insight, more profound than even Evola at times, and more wise than even many eastern sages of our day yet.....his overall worldview is insane, no other way to put it, Hitler as God? I wonder how such a gifted person could err so wrongly.....

3.4 The Eternal Wedding

Notwithstanding his idiosyncratic gnostic visions, **Miguel Serrano** can be astute in his estimations of Indian spirituality. During his pilgrimage to India, he visited the temples at Khajuraho. They are decorated with erotic sculptures, which seems rather strange in a country that is still shocked by an on-screen kiss. Serrano sees the erotic temples as a representation. He writes:

The form of the temple is always the same. On the outer walls there are always hundreds of images reflecting war, life, death, love, procreation—in a word, Maya, or Illusion. But inside, in the most secret shrines, Siva meditates as a lingam. . . . the lingam symbolizes ecstatic concentration; it is the erect dorsal spine, along which the fire of the Serpent rises towards Samadhi. The interior Self or god remains unchanged in a profound dream, unaffected by what goes on externally, by its own creation which is reflected in the images on the outer walls of the temple.

Serrano recognizes that this is all symbolism. He intuits the differences between the female and male figures in the sculptures. Of the former, he writes:

Everywhere the female is fervent in love; she is wholly enveloped in the supreme passion, engaged in giving herself away. She searches for her lover, taking his head into her hands, enveloping him with her thighs, and bending and swinging her body. On her face is an expression of complete ecstasy, for she is engaged in making him wise and in perfecting him, while her body and her soul are totally lost in the act of giving.

Note the contrast with the attitude of the male:

The face of the male lover expresses no desire, but total absence. He is shown as though he were dreaming, with only one part of him remaining to sustain his lover, giving her protection and infinite tenderness. He appreciates her sacrifice and the pain she endures for his cause; he appreciates the technique which she has perfected in order to liberate him. . . . she is the creation of the world. He is beyond her, he is beyond everything at the other end of the cord and he loves her with an infinite tenderness since he loves her as himself. He is immobile and abandoned.

Serrano discusses the training of the men and women. In particular,

The woman was not taught to satisfy man physically, but to touch his intimate centers, or chakras, and to impel him towards the Self. Thus the woman taught man to abandon her physically and to incorporate her spiritually within himself, so that he married not a woman but his own soul.

Thus, for the man, Tantra has nothing to do with the pursuit of pleasure or sexual ecstasy as Evola mistakenly believed. Quite the contrary, as Serrano explains:

The Tantric hero is forbidden to practice love passionately or compulsively. This is a rule permitted only to the woman.

Serrano sums everything up:

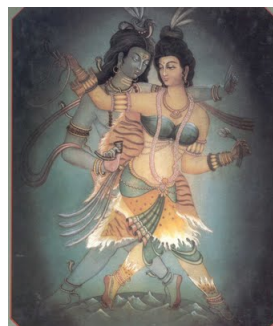
In all of this it must not be forgotten that what is important is the symbolic meaning or metaphor. Although written language and sculptured images may appear to be heavily overladen with sex, they are so only in appearance. On its highest plane, when it is practiced among the more sophisticated members of the cult, *the Tantric ceremony is only a symbolic act*, for Maithuna [sexual union] occurs only with the body of the man.

The union of opposites occurs progressively. Siva, the static principle, unites with Shakti, the dynamic principle. The feminine energy, Shakti, is Kundalini, the serpent; this unites with Atman, the achievement of Sunya or Emptiness.

Serrano points out that the practice of Tantra can lead to excesses, orgies, and aberrations, due to misunderstandings of the complex symbolism. However, he gets to the heart of the matter:

The Tantrism of the Left Hand asserts that the road to liberation excludes nothing. It claims that self-denial and asceticism are absurd, since the Supreme Emptiness achieved in Sunya produces the same results, only more satisfactorily. Yet the Tantric method is the most difficult of all, for it demands continual vigilance over all parts of existence. It is the science of Siva, the Serpent.

Is this at all clear? The Tantric path is easily confused with the pursuit of experiences that, despite their intensely pleasurable and ecstatic nature, are still no more than human, all too human. Ultimately, what is there to pursue since Atman, the unmoved mover, has no needs? There is nothing to seek, nothing to give up. All parts of existence provide us with the raw materials for transmutation, fuel for the awakening of the power of Shakti. The one thing necessary is to be ever vigilant, to be conscious of all that is moving, the images of Maya. That is to be as wise as the serpent.



Posted on 2012-03-04 by Cologero

* * *

Matt on 2012-03-04 at 22:10 said:

Yes, with all of Serrano's idiosyncrasies (the hidden nazi bases, ufo's, parallel universes etc.), he could be quite astute. He was also, to me at least, a great writer (even when his idiosyncrasies would reveal themselves and risk the coherency of his thought process). I found his writings to be very poetic. I read the *Serpent of Paradise* about 2 years ago at the bar/cafe at my university (ha I know, reading some Serrano at a university bar) after my classes were done for the week. I was so enthralled by it that I could not put it down and read it all the way through in that one sitting, never distracted by the chatter, hustle and bustle that went on all around me.

I think I'll revisit that book soon.

3.5 The Alma Dancer

Woman is not a “thing”, but an animal, which is worse: she is becoming a marionette, since that is what man liked. The aversion for woman, with that sacred fixation of “value”, is a modern obsession that proves the weakness of European man as ascetic and as warrior. The two attitudes that man should adopt before woman are all there: pure attitudes not dulled by rancor or bitterness.

The Easterner, unlike a vulgar man, sees things differently: he knows that woman is a being whose superiority is obvious in a domain where man is very poor: freedom — although without light and without consciousness like children — an absence of prejudices, miraculous clarity, and a smile that man calls “evil”; not affirmation, but a shrug of the shoulder in the face of what man builds in a bourgeois way; to be capable of everything, accessible to everything, the receptacle of everything, bottomless, symbol of the cosmic matrix, insatiable. The Easterner, who is man in an absolute sense that the Westerner does not know, owes that to the fact that he is also woman, a thing that the Westerner will never know how to be.



Figure 3.1: Alma Dancer

That is why the Easterner is exquisite with woman; he caresses her, kills her, and confines her. He gives her, in short, her true freedom, her real strength. Taken such as she is, and not as man constructs her, woman has a value and that is why divinity gave her that miraculous thing which is the dance: the rhythm of her hip, the song the crowns the rhythm, the smile of evasion that is found only in the Ascetic who swims and empties himself: that smile that in maithuna [sexual union in Tantra]

man does not have and only woman has, and who, speaking aesthetically, is visible only on certain Khemer heads. And I never saw the outcrop of the inexpressible change so well in plastic fixation except on those Khmer stones, and in the sculpture of Ellora, absolute figuration of absolute conjunction and absolute integration — beatitude, ananda.

That is the smile that woman, the sleeping child, and the Ascetic have: man attains this smile only when the infusion is absolute, when the sea overflows the rivers and waters. The Easterners see things thus, they can only see things thus.

At the time of medieval Chivalry, there was in man — this is mathematically certain — a freedom that he no longer has, and in woman, a submission and a sweetness that she can find again today only if man becomes again simple man, that is to say, more woman. Let Man be woman, and we will see what woman will become: a very fertile, docile, subtle being. At present the European is a Male and woman a Female wearing the mask of the Male. But man truly man (the East) more feminine than woman, subtle, ophidian, makes woman become again what she is.

Practically: let woman no longer roam about, let her be locked up, let her be respected; let what Westerners call “corruption” be, not exterior and visible, but confined — therefore free, not traditional. Women in the house and men outside: and you will see the action of woman — Dionysian, dissolving, Maenad-like action — recover her ancient strength.

In regard to the woman, the Islamic system was complete, whole. In Europe, the situation is horrendous: man pushes woman into the street, removes her veil, prostitutes her in sunlight, places her where she cannot be, where it is against nature for her to be: in the schools, trains, cafes, in the pigsty. The Anglo-Saxon peoples wanted that: and among us, with the stupidity that pushes us toward the ordure, we are following the example of those coarse beasts.

One final observation: the dance is solo (Oriental dance: the belly dance): Europe destroyed that, too, and introduced the couple’s dance.

If we follow the thread of this thought, we will go very far in the vision of Western perversion.

Guido De Giorgio's essay *Short Notes on Ascesis and Anti-Europe*² is missing a note. Although this section was present in the original Ur journal and even the first collections, it was excluded in all the editions after 1955. I don't know why.

This note is collected in *L'Instant et l'Eternité*. It appeared just before the incident about the sirocco in Tunisia. It extols the Traditional role of woman, particularly as it was, and might still be, found in Islamic nations.

Posted on 2013-05-17 by Cologero

* * *

Saladin on 2013-05-21 at 22:46 said:

while agreeing with De Giorgio's tenants and his overall Weltanschauung, I understand why these paragraphs were omitted. They are totally confusing (at least to me).

Cologero on 2013-05-21 at 23:25 said:

Saladin, is the incomprehension the fault of the translation? If any passages are unclear, I can take another try at them.

Saladin on 2013-05-23 at 19:51 said:

I doubt it is due to translation (and let me thank you once more for all the precious translations you have made available). In my humble opinion the passages do not completely make sense.

Take for example this paragraph: "The Easterner sees things differently: he knows that woman is, opposite vulgar man, a being whose superiority is obvious in a domain where man is very poor: freedom—although without light and without consciousness like children—an absence of prejudices, miraculous clarity, and a smile that man calls "evil".

What does De Giorgio really wants to convey? That woman is more liberated (in spiritual sense) and less prejudiced? Cologero, I am sure you have a better grasp of what De Giorgio

²<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=6397>

wants to convey here. Maybe you can clarify and comment on these passages which will be very much appreciated.

I really enjoyed your other translations of De Giorgio and I can only think that he himself decided that above note was not entirely coherent and he decided to omit from subsequent editions.

What does he really mean when he say: "Let Man be woman, and we will see what woman will become: a very fertile, docile, subtle being."?

Mihai on 2013-05-24 at 03:42 said:

I have read somewhere a comment by Evola in which he describes DeGiorgio as a "chaotic type of initiate". I really wondered what he meant by that, but now, like you, I know.

Saladin on 2013-05-24 at 19:15 said:

I had read that same comment (I am pretty sure on this blog) by Evola but totally forgotten it. However, granted De Giorgio may not be as lucid as Evola but I think he is nevertheless Traditional and immensely interesting.

Arts and Poetry about Love

4.1 Divine Sophia

I seemed to be sleeping
But was awakening to my true Self
Divine Sophia appeared to me in my dreams.

She lay down beside me
Her beauty penetrated my soul as
She read to me from her book of Wisdom.

I awoke with a start
And have passed 24 hours in sublime ecstasy

Posted on 2010-04-16 by Cologero

* * *

Anonymous on 2010-04-26 at 19:19 said:

I know what you're talking about. Didn't have the exact same experience but am caught up in a similar "flow". I keep the subject icon on my desk here at home and on a shelf in my office. It has become a wisdom transponder. For Her.

4.2 Laura and the Fedeli d'Amore

Petrarch wrote 300 sonnets about his love, **Laura**.

Rene Guenon claims that Laura was not a real woman, and that Petrarch was passing on esoteric teaching, as this quotation shows:

The various “ladies” celebrated by poets relating to the mysterious organization of the Fedeli d'Amore, since Dante, Guido Cavalcanti, Boccaccio and Petrarch, are not women who really lived on this earth. They are all, under different names, the one and the same symbolic “lady”, which represents the transcendent intelligence (Madonna Intelligenza de Dino Compagni) or Divine Wisdom. The most unintelligible poems in the literal sense become perfectly clear with the hypothesis of a “jargon”. In Persian Sufi writing, a similar meaning has also been concealed under the appearances of a simple poetry of love.



Sonnet #156 This is my translation of sonnet #156, so you can decide if Laura is real, or perhaps it does not matter:

I saw her on earth disguised as an angel
 Her celestial beauty was the sun in the world
 And to remember her brings both joy and melancholy
 As I gaze upon dreams, shadows, and smoke.

And I saw those two lovely eyes cry,
 Which caused the sun envy again and again;
 And I heard words said with longing

That would make the mountains move and rivers stand still.

Love, Wisdom, Virtue, Compassion, and Suffering
Make weeping a sweeter harmony
Than any other accustomed to be heard in the world.

Heaven was so intent on the harmony
That no leaf was seen to move on the bough,
So much sweetness had filled the air and the wind.

Franz Liszt put Sonnet #156 to music.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gvx5YUp9EiA>

Posted on 2021-06-23 by Cologero

4.3 The Animus and Mrs Muir

In *Animus and Anima*¹, **Emma Jung** describes the psychological meaning of the Animus and Anima as they relate to female and male consciousness respectively. Now Jung has some “bad press” in certain circles, yet there is a better way to understand him. To wit, spiritual events have corresponding psychical events; a way to picture them is to consider the psychic event as a projection of the spiritual. In this way, Jung, strictly as a psychologist, cannot infringe on spiritual topics. Emma Jung makes it clear at the outset:

I present the animus and its manifestations as realities, the reader must remember that I am speaking of psychic realities, which are incommensurable with concrete realities but no less effective for that reason.

¹https://www.gornahoor.net/library/Emma_Jung_Animus_and_Anima.pdf

Obviously, this runs counter to the positivist position that consciousness has no causal efficacy and so it can be safely ignored in understanding the world. On the other hand, the notion is entirely compatible with Guenonian metaphysics as well as Hermetic philosophy. As for archetypes having a quasi-independent existence in the mind, this is also compatible. Guenon gives the example of the “dream” in which the self creates all the characters in the dream, who seem to have independent existences. A major aspect of Hermetic practice is to integrate all these separate “I”s into a unified Self.

Even secular philosophy is slowly adopting pansychism. Timothy Sprigge argued for it in the *Vindication of Absolute Idealism*. Others include Galen Strawson (the son of Peter Strawson), and Philip Goff, recently interviewed in *The Scientific American*². In traditional terms, this is the recognition that the Subtle Body is just as much a part of manifestation as the Gross, or Physical, Body.

Animus Emma Jung, in order to define the Animus as masculine principle, uses **Goethe’s** *Faust*. Faust is dissatisfied with the translations of John’s Gospel that claim, “In the beginning is the word.” That does not fully express the Greek *Logos*. Faust instead proposes four steps: In the beginning were:

1. Power
2. Deed
3. Word
4. Meaning

²<https://www.scientificamerican.com/article/does-consciousness-permeate-the-universe/>

Better yet, Power is “directed will.” These stages clearly require consciousness. Depending on her own development, a woman may experience the Animus in one of those four aspects. Emma Jung elaborates:

For the primitive woman, or the young woman, or for the primitive in every woman. A man distinguished by physical prowess becomes an animus figure. Typical examples are the heroes of legend, or sports celebrities, cowboys, bullfighters, aviators, and so on.

For more exacting women, the animus figure is a man who accomplishes deeds, in the sense that he directs his power toward something of great significance.

A man who rules over the “word” or “meaning” represents an essentially intellectual tendency because word and meaning correspond par excellence to mental capacities. Such a man exemplifies the animus in the narrower sense, understood as being a spiritual guide and as representing the intellectual gifts of the woman.

Mrs. Muir The film *The Ghost and Mrs. Muir*³ is based on the novel by Josephine Leslie. Whether consciously and deliberately, or not, it illustrates the Animus, described by Emma Jung, in its fullness.

The young widow Lucy Muir moves to the English seashore only to discover that the cottage she rented is haunted by the ghost of Captain Daniel Gregg, a rough and tough seafaring man. Undaunted, she develops a relationship with him. His crude and direct manners contrast



³https://www.imdb.com/title/tt0039420/?ref_=tt_mv_close

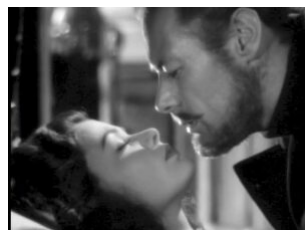
with her prissy upbringing. When challenged, he explains to her:

“I’ve lived a man’s life and I’m not ashamed of it. And no woman has been the worse from knowing me.”

The first thought is that if she is going to fall in love with a ghost, then why not the ghost of her deceased husband? In a moment of lucidity, she confesses to the Captain that, in truth, she did not really love him, and settled for him. He gave her first kiss and it was like a romance novel to her. In actuality he was not a very good architect, nor, for that matter, a good husband.

The Captain and she had many conversations. Clearly, the Captain is her Animus. Previously, she had been dependent on her father, then her husband and then her in-laws. He teaches her independence. He even renames her “Lucia”, a name suitable for a queen, better than the commonplace “Lucy”. So the Captain had Will and he accomplished Deeds, the first two stages in her awakening.

The Captain Lucy’s relationship with the masculine Captain was not at all “toxic”. On the contrary, Lucy became independent, confident, and creative. When her stocks lost their value, she needed a source of income. The Captain suggested that she write his biography. Night after night they worked on it. Now the captain became Word and Meaning for her.



However, their relationship was becoming dangerously and inappropriately romantic. Alone with her thoughts, Lucy pondered, “Oh Captain, what have you done.”

Captain then encouraged Lucy to go out and even meet men. She was seduced by a slimy children’s book author, whom she met at her publishing house; I’ve met such authors and advise you to stay away. He

promised marriage until Lucy fortuitously discovered that he was married with children! When the Captain learned of this, she feigned innocence; but he chided her: “No woman since Eve was ever caught unaware.”

The Captain concluded that it was time to leave Lucy alone. Before he left, he whispered to her in her sleep that he was only her dream. From then on, Lucy’s memory of him faded like a long-forgotten memory. She realized that she was the creative power behind the best-selling book she wrote. She never married again but grew old in that cottage by the sea. One night, she died peacefully in her chair.

Alchemical Marriage Then Captain arrived to take her spirit away with him, making them both happy and fulfilled. Profane marriage ends at death, but the alchemical marriage is eternal. The psychological became the spiritual. The Captain gave life to Lucy; now Lucy gives life to the Captain.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zIA6Ny_B8rg

Posted on 2021-07-15 by Cologero

4.4 Orpheus and Eurydice: The Happy Ending

We made from water every living thing.

In this manner even the gods give special honor to zeal and courage in concerns of love. But Orpheus, son of Oeagrus, they sent back with failure from Hades, showing him only a wraith of the woman for whom he came; her real self they would not bestow, for he was accounted to have gone upon a coward’s quest, too like the minstrel that he was, and to have lacked the spirit to die as Alcestis

did for the sake of love, when he contrived the means of entering Hades alive. Wherefore they laid upon him the penalty he deserved, and caused him to meet his death.

PLATO, *Symposium*

The recent movie *Reminiscence*⁴ is a retelling of the story of Orpheus and Eurydice. Nick Bannister, played by Hugh Jackman, runs a service that vividly recalls his clients' memories. It recreates the film noir style with the cynical antihero, including voiceovers that reveal his inner thoughts, and, of course, the alluring femme fatale, Mae, played by Rebecca Ferguson. Like its black and white predecessor, this film relies on dream-like states, understated eroticism, ambivalent morals, and cruelty.

The story begins a few years into the future when, due to climate change, the streets of Miami are flooded, with sections navigable like a new Venice. The wealthy are ensconced on the few areas of high ground.

At closing time, Mae shows up at Nick's establishment asking for a session so she can remember where she had lost her keys. Mae is like a Naiad who emerges from the waters of life and Nick is immediately infatuated. The next evening, he goes to the night club where Mae is a torch singer. He is entranced by her melancholy love songs and tells her so at the end of her set. She replies, "In four years, you are the only man who noticed me for my singing and not for my beauty."

Thus begins their romantic relationship. Mae asks Nick to tell her a story, but he retorts cynically, "Stories don't have happy endings."

She responds, hopefully, "Then tell me a story but end it in the middle."

The middle comes all too soon when Mae disappears without a word. Through a chance encounter with the relived memories of a criminal, Nick is able to trace Mae back to a night club

⁴https://www.imdb.com/title/tt3272066/?ref_=sr_srsg_0



in New Orleans. Nick then embarks on a trip to the underworld of crime and drugs. There he encounters the underworld boss Saint Joe, who kept Mae as his mistress and got her addicted to “baca”.

This led to a confrontation that would have led to Nick’s death, had not his business partner Watts, who was secretly in love with him, arrived to rescue him. Unlike Orpheus, Nick was willing to die for his love rather than to be alone without her.

But the Fates cannot be mocked. Dejected because he believed that Mae’s love was false, he needs to find out more. He learns that Mae was working with Boothe, a “fixer” and ex-cop to dispose of the mistress and bastard son of a wealthy landowner. Nick tracks down Boothe, subdues him, and hooks him up to his memory machine.

He then learns the truth about Mae’s involvement and how she tried to protect the illegitimate heir. He also discovers that Mae truly did love him. She plays out a scene with Boothe, knowing that Nick would somehow find out, in which she pledges her love to Nick. Nick is, of course, thrilled to learn that although it is too late.

The legend is that Eurydice in Hades was only a shade, a mere image of the real woman. That thought, that doubt, led Orpheus to look back. The truth sent her back to the underworld.

Likewise Nick hooks himself up to his memory machine so that he can re-experience his memories of Mai, over and over for the rest of his life. Yet Mae is forever merely a shade, a shadowy image in his mind.

Where or When https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ze0o_TIysJc

Posted on 2021-09-10 by Cologero

* * *

Auld Wat on 2021-09-11 at 13:02 said:
For a happy ending see Sir Orfeo.

4.5 Doctor Zhivago Unveiled

Then lovers hastily are drawn
To one another, vague and dreaming,

BORIS PASTERNAK, *Unique Days*

There is no need to repeat the details. Doctor Zhivago⁵ was a novel written by Boris Pasternak, which was banned in the Soviet Union, smuggled into Italy, and finally published in 1957. This is a review solely of the film version, which deviates from the book in some ways. Despite its length, the movie was very popular when it was released.

You lay life on a table and cut out all the tumors of injustice. Marvelous. Ah, but cutting out the tumours of injustice, that's a deep operation. Someone must keep life alive while you do it. By living. Isn't that right?

Only the solitary seek the truth, and they break with all those who don't love it sufficiently.

All of the Communist Parties, upon attaining power, have become completely merciless. But at the stage before they achieve power, it is necessary to use disguises.

quotes from Doctor Zhivago

⁵https://www.imdb.com/title/tt0059113/?ref_=nv_sr_srsq_0

The story is ostensibly about a Doctor Zhivago, who was a general practitioner like Dr. Harvey — after all, specialization is for insects. He also wrote popular poetry; you all know a doctor like that. Part of the movie is about the individual lives of the main characters and the other part is about the historical events that affect their lives in oh so many ways.

The personal part glamorizes the doctor's adultery, infidelity, and fatherhood of an illegitimate daughter. He abandoned his son by his wife, who was "inconsolable" to be without a father. He also abandoned his daughter with his enticing mistress, Lara, played by more than beautiful Julie Christie. In the end, he lost both his wife and his mistress. Years later, old and in poor health, the Doctor, looking out through the window of the street car, spots Lara wandering on the street. He disembarks, hoping to have his *Sehnsucht* satisfied. While chasing after her, he suffered a heart attack. He died alone in the streets, watched over by strangers. But, heck, love the one you're with and it's all good. He turned out to be more popular dead than alive.

Historical Background While the Doctor was on the German front during World War One, the Bolshevik revolution was nearing completion back home. When Zhivago returned home, he was surprised to find 13 other families living in his home. He, his wife, child, and father-in-law were confined to a small upstairs room without sufficient fuel to keep warm.

Marx is dangerous not because he is wrong, but because he is often right. Marx predicted that a late capitalist system would smoothly embrace communism as the next step. Lenin had readjusted expectations and believed that a revolution would be necessary to make the transition. It turns out that Lenin was wrong, and Marx may still be right.

Matter, in the Marxist sense, is not the matter of the physicist. It has a direction that is expressed through the world process. The sequence starts with feudal society, enters the capitalist phase, and culminates in

the equality of communism.

The process is ineluctable and there is no meaning to free thought. One's worldview is a creation of the material process, so there can be no thought that transcends it or judge it. If you think the revolution, you are the vanguard of the revolution. Otherwise, you retard it so your thinking needs to be readjusted.

Bourgeois thinking cannot lead to happiness, since it depends on subjectivity and inequality. Since the material circumstances of life creates thought, then one's thought becomes free only when the social structure is consistent with the absence of coercion by capital. With inequality eliminated, so also is envy, and everyone should be happy.

The Bourgeois Poet On Schopenhauer's principle, the important thing is to understand the inner states of the characters in a book or a movie. Hence, we want to understand the inner life of both the revolutionaries and the bourgeoisie. The remarkable thing is that we can see the same inner life in the revolutionaries of our own time.

The Doctor's alter ego is the mysterious Strelnikov, the idealistic revolutionary and husband of his mistress Lara. Strelnikov turns out to be too intense even for the Bolsheviks. Strelnikov confronts the Doctor and explains the revolutionary mindset. The Doctor is too bourgeois with his poetry, since it is concerned with his feelings and inner life. The revolutionary needs to be guided by the forces of historical materialism. After some tense interrogation, Strelnikov lets him go. We are led to believe that, in a moment of weakness, Strelnikov lets his past association with the Doctor affect his judgment.

In the course of the story, the Doctor seems to be frequently menaced by the authorities. Nevertheless, he remains free, even publishing his poetry to popular acclaim. On the other hand, the two women in his life are not so fortunate. His wife flees to Paris with their children, and Lara escapes to the East, abandoning their daughter in the process.

In the book, the Doctor starts a new family, which he also abandons, and Lara returns to Russia after his death. The film version realizes that Lara has to be the love of his life, with no other. Hence, he catches one final glimpse of her. We may hope that Lara is his Beatrice, the revelation of Sophia, assuming that his life and poetry had made him wise.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M1iQ5hQTR5s>

Posted on 2021-11-21 by Cologero

4.6 Lady of Shalott

To all the knights of the Round Table sends health this lady of Shalott, as to the best people of the world. And if you want to know why I came to my end, that is because of the greatest knight in the world, and the most ungracious; that is my lord Sir Lancelot of the Lake, whom I was unable to pray of his love such that he would have pity of me. And thus, weary, I died, for loving well, as you can see!

Final letter of the Lady of Shalott

In the **Matter of Britain**, the **Lady of Shalott** was **Elaine of Astolat**. Elaine was in love with Lancelot. When the knight was injured in battle, she nursed him back to health. After he recovered, he treated her like hired help, unaware of her feelings for him. Her love unrequited, she died of heartbreak ten days later.

At that time, people participated in the world by experience unironically, not as they do today. Thus, they “felt” the world, with emotions that were more deeply and strongly experienced,



with a range that exceeds the limited emotional responses of our time.

So the story is plausible to me, since I witnessed my mother die about 10 days after my father with the same disease: heartache. At least they had a lifetime together. Lancelot spurned such a strong love that was freely offered to him. Elaine had no more reason to live.

Alfred, Lord Tennyson retold the story in the poem *The Lady of Shalott*, of which he published two versions.

Part I (1832)

On either side the river lie
Long fields of barley and of rye,
That clothe the wold and meet the sky;
And thro' the field the road runs by

To many-tower'd Camelot;
The yellow-leaved waterlily
The green-sheathed daffodilly
Tremble in the water chilly
Round about Shalott.

Willows whiten, aspens shiver.
The sunbeam showers break and quiver
In the stream that runneth ever
By the island in the river

Flowing down to Camelot.
Four gray walls, and four gray towers
Overlook a space of flowers,
And the silent isle imbowers
The Lady of Shalott.

Underneath the bearded barley,
The reaper, reaping late and early,
Hears her ever chanting cheerly,

Part I (1842)

On either side the river lie
Long fields of barley and of rye,
That clothe the wold and meet the sky;
And thro' the field the road runs by

To many-tower'd Camelot;
And up and down the people go,
Gazing where the lilies blow
Round an island there below,
The island of Shalott.

Willows whiten, aspens quiver,
Little breezes dusk and shiver
Thro' the wave that runs for ever
By the island in the river

Flowing down to Camelot.
Four gray walls, and four gray towers,
Overlook a space of flowers,
And the silent isle imbowers
The Lady of Shalott.

By the margin, willow veil'd,
Slide the heavy barges trail'd
By slow horses; and unhail'd

Like an angel, singing clearly,
 O'er the stream of Camelot.
 Piling the sheaves in furrows airy,
 Beneath the moon, the reaper weary
 Listening whispers, "Tis the fairy,
 Lady of Shalott."

The little isle is all inrail'd
 With a rose-fence, and overtrail'd
 With roses: by the marge unhail'd
 The shallop flitteth silken sail'd,
 Skimming down to Camelot.
 A pearl garland winds her head:
 She leaneth on a velvet bed,
 Full royally apparelled,
 The Lady of Shalott.

Part II

No time hath she to sport and play:
 A charmed web she weaves alway.
 A curse is on her, if she stay
 Her weaving, either night or day,
 To look down to Camelot.
 She knows not what the curse may be;
 Therefore she weaveth steadily,
 Therefore no other care hath she,
 The Lady of Shalott.

She lives with little joy or fear.
 Over the water, running near,
 The sheepbell tinkles in her ear.
 Before her hangs a mirror clear,
 Reflecting tower'd Camelot.
 And as the mazy web she whirls,
 She sees the surly village churls,
 And the red cloaks of market girls
 Pass onward from Shalott.

The shallop flitteth silken-sail'd
 Skimming down to Camelot:
 But who hath seen her wave her hand?
 Or at the casement seen her stand?
 Or is she known in all the land,
 The Lady of Shalott?

Only reapers, reaping early
 In among the bearded barley,
 Hear a song that echoes cheerly
 From the river winding clearly,
 Down to tower'd Camelot:
 And by the moon the reaper weary,
 Piling sheaves in uplands airy,
 Listening, whispers "Tis the fairy
 Lady of Shalott."

Part II

There she weaves by night and day
 A magic web with colours gay.
 She has heard a whisper say,
 A curse is on her if she stay
 To look down to Camelot.
 She knows not what the curse may be,
 And so she weaveth steadily,
 And little other care hath she,
 The Lady of Shalott.

And moving thro' a mirror clear
 That hangs before her all the year,
 Shadows of the world appear.
 There she sees the highway near
 Winding down to Camelot:
 There the river eddy whirls,
 And there the surly village-churls,
 And the red cloaks of market girls,
 Pass onward from Shalott.

Sometimes a troop of damsels glad,
An abbot on an ambling pad,
Sometimes a curly shepherd lad,
Or long-hair'd page in crimson clad,
Goes by to tower'd Camelot:
And sometimes thro' the mirror blue
The knights come riding two and two:
She hath no loyal knight and true,
The Lady of Shalott.

But in her web she still delights
To weave the mirror's magic sights,
For often thro' the silent nights
A funeral, with plumes and lights
And music, came from Camelot:
Or when the moon was overhead
Came two young lovers lately wed;
'I am half sick of shadows,' said
The Lady of Shalott.

Part III

A bow-shot from her bower-eaves,
He rode between the barley-sheaves,
The sun came dazzling thro' the leaves,
And flam'd upon the brazen greaves
Of bold Sir Lancelot.
A red-cross knight for ever kneel'd
To a lady in his shield,
That sparkled on the yellow field,
Beside remote Shalott.

The gemmy bridle glitter'd free,
Like to some branch of stars we see
Hung in the golden Galaxy.
The bridle bells rang merrily
As he rode down from Camelot:
And from his blazon'd baldric slung
A mighty silver bugle hung,

Sometimes a troop of damsels glad,
An abbot on an ambling pad,
Sometimes a curly shepherd-lad,
Or long-hair'd page in crimson clad,
Goes by to tower'd Camelot;
And sometimes thro' the mirror blue
The knights come riding two and two:
She hath no loyal knight and true,
The Lady of Shalott.

But in her web she still delights
To weave the mirror's magic sights,
For often thro' the silent nights
A funeral, with plumes and lights
And music, went to Camelot:
Or when the moon was overhead,
Came two young lovers lately wed:
"I am half sick of shadows," said
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That sparkled on the yellow field,
Beside remote Shalott.

The gemmy bridle glitter'd free,
Like to some branch of stars we see
Hung in the golden Galaxy.
The bridle bells rang merrily
As he rode down to Camelot:
And from his blazon'd baldric slung
A mighty silver bugle hung,

And as he rode his armour rung,
Beside remote Shalott.

All in the blue unclouded weather
Thick-jewell'd shone the saddle-leather,
The helmet and the helmet-feather
Burn'd like one burning flame together,
As he rode down from Camelot.
As often thro' the purple night,
Below the starry clusters bright,
Some bearded meteor, trailing light,
Moves over green Shalott.

His broad clear brow in sunlight glow'd;
On burnish'd hooves his war-horse trode;
From underneath his helmet flow'd
His coal-black curls as on he rode,
As he rode down from Camelot.
From the bank and from the river
He flash'd into the crystal mirror,
'Tirra lirra, tirra lirra:'
Sang Sir Lancelot.

She left the web, she left the loom
She made three paces thro' the room
She saw the water-flower bloom,
She saw the helmet and the plume,
She look'd down to Camelot.
Out flew the web and floated wide;
The mirror crack'd from side to side;
'The curse is come upon me,' cried
The Lady of Shalott.

Part IV

In the stormy east-wind straining,
The pale yellow woods were waning,
The broad stream in his banks complain-
ing,

And as he rode his armour rung,
Beside remote Shalott.

All in the blue unclouded weather
Thick-jewell'd shone the saddle-leather,
The helmet and the helmet-feather
Burn'd like one burning flame together,
As he rode down to Camelot.
As often thro' the purple night,
Below the starry clusters bright,
Some bearded meteor, trailing light,
Moves over still Shalott.

His broad clear brow in sunlight glow'd;
On burnish'd hooves his war-horse trode;
From underneath his helmet flow'd
His coal-black curls as on he rode,
As he rode down to Camelot.
From the bank and from the river
He flash'd into the crystal mirror,
'Tirra lirra,' by the river
Sang Sir Lancelot.

She left the web, she left the loom,
She made three paces thro' the room,
She saw the water-lily bloom,
She saw the helmet and the plume,
She look'd down to Camelot.
Out flew the web and floated wide;
The mirror crack'd from side to side;
'The curse is come upon me,' cried
The Lady of Shalott.

Part IV

In the stormy east-wind straining,
The pale yellow woods were waning,
The broad stream in his banks complain-
ing,

Heavily the low sky raining
Over tower'd Camelot;
Outside the isle a shallow boat
Beneath a willow lay afloat,
Below the carven stern she wrote,
The Lady of Shalott.

A cloudwhite crown of pearl she dight,
All raimented in snowy white
That loosely flew (her zone in sight
Clasp'd with one blinding diamond bright

Her wide eyes fix'd on Camelot,
Though the squally east-wind keenly
Blew, with folded arms serenely
By the water stood the queenly
Lady of Shalott.

With a steady stony glance—
Like some bold seer in a trance,
Beholding all his own mischance,
Mute, with a glassy countenance—
She look'd down to Camelot.

It was the closing of the day:
She loos'd the chain, and down she lay;
The broad stream bore her far away,
The Lady of Shalott.

As when to sailors while they roam,
By creeks and outfalls far from home,
Rising and dropping with the foam,
From dying swans wild warblings come,
Blown shoreward; so to Camelot

Still as the boathead wound along
The willowy hills and fields among,
They heard her chanting her deathsong,
The Lady of Shalott.

Heavily the low sky raining
Over tower'd Camelot;
Down she came and found a boat
Beneath a willow left afloat,
And round about the prow she wrote
The Lady of Shalott.

And down the river's dim expanse
Like some bold seer in a trance,
Seeing all his own mischance—
With a glassy countenance
Did she look to Camelot.
And at the closing of the day
She loos'd the chain, and down she lay;
The broad stream bore her far away,
The Lady of Shalott.

Lying, robed in snowy white
That loosely flew to left and right—
The leaves upon her falling light—
Thro' the noises of the night
She floated down to Camelot:
And as the boat-head wound along
The willowy hills and fields among,
They heard her singing her last song,
The Lady of Shalott.

Heard a carol, mournful, holy,
Chanted loudly, chanted lowly,
Till her blood was frozen slowly,
And her eyes were darken'd wholly,
Turn'd to tower'd Camelot.
For ere she reach'd upon the tide
The first house by the water-side,
Singing in her song she died,
The Lady of Shalott.

Under tower and balcony,

A longdrawn carol, mournful, holy,
 She chanted loudly, chanted lowly,
 Till her eyes were darken'd wholly,
 And her smooth face sharpen'd slowly,
 Turn'd to tower'd Camelot:

For ere she reach'd upon the tide
 The first house by the water-side,
 Singing in her song she died,
 The Lady of Shalott.

Under tower and balcony,
 By garden wall and gallery,
 A pale, pale corpse she floated by,
 Deadcold, between the houses high,
 Dead into tower'd Camelot.

Knight and burgher, lord and dame,
 To the planked wharfage came:
 Below the stern they read her name,
The Lady of Shalott.

By garden-wall and gallery,
 A gleaming shape she floated by,
 Dead-pale between the houses high,
 Silent into Camelot.
 Out upon the wharfs they came,
 Knight and burgher, lord and dame,
 And round the prow they read her name,
The Lady of Shalott.

Who is this? and what is here?
 And in the lighted palace near
 Died the sound of royal cheer;
 And they cross'd themselves for fear,
 All the knights at Camelot:
 But Lancelot mused a little space;
 He said, "She has a lovely face;
 God in his mercy lend her grace,
 The Lady of Shalott."

They cross'd themselves, their stars they blest,

Knight, minstrel, abbot, squire, and guest.

There lay a parchment on her breast,
 That puzzled more than all the rest,
 The wellfed wits at Camelot.

"The web was woven curiously,
 The charm is broken utterly,
 Draw near and fear not, —this is I,
 The Lady of Shalott."

Appendix: An Anima Dream Last night, I had another Anima dream, which surprised me. I spotted a woman at a gathering. I recognized her from some other time, maybe even from a different turn of the spiral of the degrees of Existence. As I sat in an armchair, she approached and sat

on my lap. Then she gently kissed me on my lips. There was such joy, like the ending of Sehnsucht, that I felt it even in my sleep. I vowed never to pass up such love again.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DRIHZr3Pxhc>

Posted on 2021-12-14 by Cologero

4.7 The lover becomes the thing he loves

Luís Vaz de Camões was Portugal's greatest poet, on the order of Shakespeare, Homer, Virgil, and Dante. He wrote several sonnets in the style of Petrarch. And like Petrarch, he seemed to have had a mysterious muse, as this beautiful sonnet reveals. All attempts to identify her are inconclusive. In any event, such attempts are doomed by the fault of literalness; as such, they miss the deep symbolic meaning of the sonnet.

The demigoddess is revealed in Camões's soul. The sonnet reveals his sense of longing or Sehnsucht, which can only arise from experience. Camões was not just an academic, as he lived an active life as a bohemian, traveler, and adventurer, or better said, a real Renaissance man.

by **Luís Vaz de Camões**, 1595

Translation: © 2006, Richard Zenith

Posted on 2021-12-22 by Cologero

* * *

Presbyter Johannes on 2022-06-26 at 00:24 said:

This translation is significantly inaccurate. Is this a professional publicised translation?

Cologero on 2022-06-26 at 13:40 said:

Yes, it is a professionally published translation, because I don't know Portuguese. Poets often take liberties with translations, so I usually do my own whenever possible.

Transforma-se o amador na cousa amada,
por virtude do muito imaginar;
não tenho, logo, mais que desejar,
pois em mim tenho a parte desejada.

Se nela está minh'alma transformada,
que mais deseja o corpo de alcançar?
Em si sòmente pode descansar,
pois consigo tal alma está liada.

Mas esta linda e pura semideia,
que, como um acidente em seu sujeito,
assi co a alma minha se conforma,

está no pensamento como ideia:
o vivo e puro amor de que sou feito,
como a matéria simples busca a forma.

The lover becomes his beloved
by virtue of much imagining;
since what I long for is already in me,
the act of longing should be enough.

If my soul becomes the beloved,
what more can my body long for?
Only in itself will it find peace,
since my body and soul are linked.

But this pure, fair demigoddess,
who with my soul is in accord
like an accident with its subject,

exists in my mind as a mere idea;
the pure and living love I'm made of
seeks, like simple matter, form.

However, Portuguese is a Romance language, so I get the drift of it. It is certainly not “significantly” inaccurate.

Presbyter Johannes on 2022-06-26 at 15:49 said:
It's good that you can tell.

4.8 The Prime of Miss Jean Brodie

The Prime of Miss Jean Brodie is the film version, released in 1969, of the novel of the same name by Muriel Spark; the novel is considered to be in the top 100 English works of fiction. Jean Brodie is a dynamic teacher at a stuffy girl's boarding school in Edinburgh, Scotland. Although her unorthodox style irritates the headmistress, her passion for art, literature, and poetry has a strong influence on her students. A few of them become part of her inner circle, often spending weekends with her.

On a personal level, she has meaningless love interests; one a meaning-

less affair with the music teacher, the other with the art teacher. Although she seems to love the art teacher, he is married with six children. That is obviously a dead end. Nevertheless, Miss Brodie continues to believe that she is in the prime of her life. With no suitors, no friends apart from her students, and her job in jeopardy, her carefully crafted life is about to implode.

Lady of Shalott In one scene Miss Brodie begins to recite by heart the *Lady of Shalott* by Alfred, Lord Tennyson⁶. Elaine, the Lady of Charlotte, fell deeply in love with Lancelot, but that love was not reciprocated. She went down a river in a boat, as she slowly died. The water represents the soul and the lack of love is the death of the soul.

For a young woman, while there is a lack of love, her fantasies keep her soul alive. Elaine did experience real love, which could never be matched by a fantasy because it was unrequited. Hence, her soul slowly died.

We have to wonder, then, about how Miss Brodie experienced herself in that poem. She communicated solely in maxims and inspirational words that seem divorced from any real experience. Through art and poetry, she knew the concept of love but not the reality of love. True art, like the character in the *Neverending Story*, asks us to participate in the soul of the artist, to enjoy his enjoyment.

As it dawns on Miss Brodie that she is past her prime, and she will forever be without love, there is nothing left but death. Her fate is unspecified in the movie.



⁶See Section 4.6 in this book.

Betrayal Sandy, her favorite student, the one with insight but no instinct according to Miss Brodie, soon sees through her teacher. She betrays Miss Brodie to the headmistress who have been looking for an excuse to terminate her. She also has an affair with the art teacher, perhaps to get back at Miss Brodie, but then leaves him when she realizes that he is still in love with Miss Brodie.

In our time, an affair between a 43 year old man and a high school student sounds creepy, but apparently it caused no stir in 1939. We get the impression that it was considered to be an honor to attract the attention of a male teacher.

Virginity For a woman, the question about losing her virginity usually has an import, but no logic as far as I can tell. For example, Elena, in *My Brilliant Friend*, loses it to an older man whom she despises, in a passionless act on the beach at night. Other stories are not much better.

The same story plays out in the decision to marry. Again, it often is a practical decision that must be made before losing her prime. One fellow told me about how he met his wife. He pestered her for six months until she finally yielded to him. He seemed quite proud about his persistence. I did not have the heart to explain to him that she was out and about for those six months looking for someone better. She only returned when she realized that he was the best she was going to do.

At some point she realizes that she is like the Lady of Shalott who has not found love; instead, she is waking up to a stranger every day. The esoteric teaching is that there is one woman for each man, who together form the Adam-Eve couple with is the return to the primordial state. In our current state of being, we find ourselves trapped in a web of relationships before we come to that awareness. Some fortunate ones escape from that web and find the one with whom there has been an entanglement from the beginning of the world.

Postscript on postmortem marriage Although marriage ends with death and there is no marrying in heaven, the idea persists that spouses will reunite in the afterlife. To be cynical, that is not necessarily an incentive for a lot of people. A more serious point is that there will be no physical bodies so souls will be fully exposed to each other. You may not even recognize your spouse in that case because you might not recognize her soul. The point is that it is necessary for a couple to share in each other's interiority. That, and only that, is the alchemical marriage.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IJZQz5U0e10>

Posted on 2022-01-02 by Cologero

* * *

Alex on 2022-01-04 at 09:09 said:

The act of marriage vows, living together for 20 years, arguing, making up, etc does not mean there will be any meeting of the two souls in the afterlife. Reasons for extending meetings into spirit life require some deep connection born of very real feelings which do not often follow from living together. Even if there is some communication between the living and dead it may be brief and not the pressing kind one witnesses with love. The dead are jealous of their new found freedom and checking in with the living is not their main priority.

Arthur Konrad on 2022-01-04 at 10:46 said:

Alex, here is a question, I ask this as somebody who's got no idea.

If church marriage has no super-temporal meaning, which is to say, if marriage is until death do you part, then what's the difference between being married in a church and making religious vows, and doing the same at the city council? Also, since married persons definitely part at death, then why not before death? Why does the Church then oppose divorce at all, if marriage has got nothing to do with eternity? Does it all boil down then, to being loyal to each other in this life in a strictly corporal sense, for the sake of not doing bad (not hurting someone's feelings)? Is that what is holy and sanctified in the institution of marriage as the Church proscribes? I suppose that marriage with divine sanction would suggest something different – that spiritual loyalty precedes even this type of corporeal fidelity, in the sense that even adultery can be atoned for if one spouse's love for another prevails over temporary failings (I am aware of course, that most would not overlook adultery even in this case, but we know such stories)

Alex on 2022-01-04 at 18:53 said:

Now, I think the practical reality of Christian marriage is to encourage the couple to stay together with the congregation supplying support on many levels and to remind them of a future in Heaven together with their loved ones. This support works to provide hope for a spiritual future which the county clerk cannot, making all the difference. We must use our discernment prior to marriage before setting sail on that white water expedition. Then once on the raft expect to get wet.

5.1 The Soul of a Woman

Adam knew Eve his wife

GENESIS 4:1

Although he has copious notes, Cologero has been experiencing writer's block regarding his upcoming posts on the esoteric meaning of Romance. So he called me last night for help in overcoming that block. We had a long talk — or rather he talked and I listened — about Dante, Malory's novel on King Arthur, Donne's love poetry, Charles Williams, and a few other lesser known figures. Of course, this theme goes all the way back to his first writings about Lucinde¹.

Yet his concern was the lack of female authors who have written on the topic. As a psychologist, I could see that this concern was less intellectual and more personal. So I probed a little deeper. Sure enough, he

¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=4>

revealed to me that he had never met a woman who understood what he is writing about. That has caused him to doubt the veracity, or at least the usefulness, of his research.

In exasperation, he informed me that several women have said that “he gets them”, yet they don’t “get him”. I pointed out his naivety: man desires to know, woman desires to be known. It’s in the Bible for heaven’s sake. Over the years, he has engaged in voluminous correspondence, most of which he has shown me for analysis. I hope that this particular story will serve as an introduction to his topic and will free his blockage.

Lila [not her real name] was young and pretty. She claimed to have a 160 IQ. Whether or not that is exactly true, I judged from her writings that she was certainly quite intelligent. Yet that is not the point, she still desired to be known. At one point, she sent him a tape of the movie *Last of*



*the Mohicans*², with a note that it was her favorite film. She asked for Cologero’s opinion of it. Of course, Cologero thought it was a conversation starter, so this was his response:

I actually finished the film yesterday. Clearly a magnificent movie, simultaneously a great adventure and a convincing love story, while demonstrating the variations of human character and the agony of the tough decisions we sometimes need to make.

I looked at Amazon and imdb ... many people are captivated by this film. But what grabs Lila? What secret does she harbor, a secret she holds tight while longing for someone to pry it loose. It reminds me of one of those challenges the medieval knights had to conquer on the quest for the grail.

It must be more than the long hair and skill in the martial arts. The

²https://www.imdb.com/title/tt0104691/?ref_=nv_sr_1

turning point for Cora came when they came upon the massacred family. Cora was distracted from her task and wanted to take time to give them a proper burial. Hawkeye, undeterred from his goal and brusquely dismissive of Cora's request, forces them to press on. She is angered by what she considers his cold-heartedness and moral failing. It is only when he brings her to see the situation in larger terms, that her infatuation begins. Suddenly, she is no longer the protected bourgeois daughter of a British officer. She is exposed to man's world with all its glory, cruelty, sinfulness, and stripped of its veneer of cultured, "civilized" life. She also sees that a life with Duncan is part of that old, false world, and that real Love can only exist in the midst of the real world, with a man at home in that world, while still holding values that transcend it.

Hawkeye's and Cora's love is the beginning of their salvation. In the cave, the knowledge of Hawkeye's love fuels Cora's will to live through the faith he will keep his promise. For Hawkeye, all other concerns are secondary as he single-mindedly looks to rescue Cora. He also has the backing of his father and brother who demonstrate their loyalty. Yet love alone is insufficient and the couple needs to rely on the sacrifice of Duncan who, while not altogether the innocent victim, is yet made innocent by his love for Cora, a non-egoic love as he is willing to give her up for her own happiness.

Unlike Cain and Abel, Uncas dies for his brother . . . and for Cora. But he is unable to save Alice who, not understanding or loving like her sister, yields to her despair. As all the agents — the English, the settlers, the French, the Hurons, the Mohicans — act out their little parts on their stage, they are oblivious to the greater change they inadvertently are bringing about. Only the wise Chingachgook can see it all coming, *sub specie aeternitatis*, as it were.

What Cologero didn't realize was that the question was not about the movie per se, but rather about Lila's soul. This was her response:

Breathtaking. I am awestruck, and humbled. Thank you. I had wondered whether you really knew me. Now I know that you have seen into my very soul.

Yes, analytical, but not with a negative connotation, as in cold or calculating. What I was thinking about was this process you seem to have (correct me if I'm wrong), whereby you appear to step back, almost remove yourself from whatever it is, in order to observe, study, and contemplate an idea or situation (or a person, as it were). Then suddenly you turn around and have this uncanny ability to tell me what was in my head or in my heart before I'm even consciously aware of it. Case in point: *The Last of the Mohicans*. I didn't even know myself why it captivates me, so I was really curious as to what you'd come up with. You figured it out in no time flat, and you were exactly right. Nobody reads me like that, ever. And I guess I was thinking you'll apply those same abilities to look into my dreams, and they'll point up all my flaws. But it would seem they're all too readily apparent anyway. So I quit worrying about it. You're just too perceptive sometimes. It's a little scary! and I like it a lot — go figure.

I think he is looking for a synthesis of identicals rather than of complementaries. Perhaps that is what Charles Williams meant when he wrote:

Christ is the synthesis of the positive, and the Blessed Virgin of the receptive, side of man.

At least, that is my understanding from Cologero's explanation.

Posted on 2018-12-04 by Teresa Chicalinda

* * *

Alistair Fraser on 2018-12-05 at 04:32 said:

Excellent, on the “alice” character there was also something of a conscious choice being displayed prior to her demise , a perceived spiritual death at the hands of her new lovers killers or a physical death taking the same fall that her new lover was forced to take in her and others defence . She chooses the later.

Mikkel on 2018-12-08 at 19:28 said:

Man wishes to know and woman to be known. One knows according to ability, “Everything that is known is comprehended not according to its own nature, but according to the ability to know of those who do the knowing.” not specifically studying the object of knowing, the other person. Woman pushes man to know himself through many ways in life, sometimes these are more ‘correct’ than others, but the true need or goal here is a higher self-knowledge in order to know, it seems even that a woman instinctively dissuades or encourages a man through this, though not always correct, of course given a relationship the man has responsibility for his own discerning. The woman then can be known once the appropriate level of knowing is reached, and man then knows himself. By this, Man encapsulates knowing and being known in his own experience, masculine and feminine together. As well, by this woman may encapsulate knowing as man has brought her to herself and she is known by him.

It appears that there are corresponding levels of knowing of another person, physical, emotional, spiritual, the vehicle to the love understood in the Middle Ages discussed in the “She who must be obeyed” article, “This was Love at the spiritual and objective level, beyond both the carnal and the psychological level.” Many relations today seem to want to be focused on a higher level than carnal or psychological, but people do not carry the type of responsibility appropriate (knowledge) to that higher level, causing much sadness and distress.

As well, man to know and woman to be known speaks even to the direct of which behavior can be seen, although typically these acts are studied mostly in children (Male children acting out externally, while female children withdrawing inwardly).

5.2 Tales from the Anima

Sehnsucht is the inconsolable longing in the heart for we know not what. ... [It is] that unnameable something, desire for which pierces us like a rapier at the smell of bonfire, the sound of wild ducks flying overhead, the title of *The Well at the World's End*, the opening lines of *Kubla Khan*, the morning cobwebs in late summer, or the noise of falling waves.

C S LEWIS

You know that you love someone when you have glimpsed in her something too beautiful to die.

GABRIEL MARCEL

Ye who believe in affection that hopes, and endures, and is patient,
Ye who believe in the beauty and strength of woman's devotion,
List to the mournful tradition still sung by the pines of the forest;
List to a Tale of Love in Acadie, home of the happy.

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW, *Evangeline*

Last night, I had another in a long series of dreams about the Anima. Our lovemaking was so sweet and enduring that we even spent time together afterwards; that is atypical. I even saw her face, which I had never clearly seen before. She was cute and somewhat petite. After three days together, I asked her if it was too soon to discuss marriage. Never before had marriage ever come up in a dream conversation. It was so disappointing to awaken. I never heard her answer.

Arabian Nights An unknown friend just sent me by post the tales of the 1001 Nights, but he neglected to send me a woman as creative as Scheherazade to read them to me. The stories have an urgency, when you consider that they represent a matter of life and death. Now I wonder what it would be like to spend 1001 nights with such a woman.

Fearful that she would be unfaithful to him, the King married a new virgin every day, only to have her beheaded the next morning. Eventually, the kingdom ran out of virgins. The vizier's



daughter, Scheherazade, volunteered to be the king's bride, to her father's consternation. But Scheherazade was quite intelligent and cultured. She had read widely in history, poetry, philosophy, science, and the arts. So on their first night together, she told the king a story, but did not finish it. Curious to hear the ending, he kept her a second night. Scheherazade finished the first story and started a second, again without finishing it. This continued for 1001 nights, at which point he admitted that he had fallen in love with her and spared her life.

Esoterically, Scheherazade risks her personal life to gain her immortal life with the king.

Worthiness of Love Frithjof Schuon points out that, according to an Hadith, **women, perfumes, and prayer** are worthy of love. Schuon explains why:

- **Woman**, synthesizing in her substance virgin nature, the sanctuary and spiritual company, is for man what is most lovable; in her highest aspect, she is the formal projection of merciful and infinite Inwardness in the outward; and in this regard she assumes a quasi-sacramental and liberating function.
- **Perfumes** represent qualities or beauties that are formless, exactly in the same way as music; that is to say that side by side with the formal projection of Inwardness, there exists also a complementary formless projection, symbolized, not by visual or tangible qualities, but by auditory and olfactory ones; perfumes are silent music.
- **Prayer** leads from Outward to Inward, and both consecrates and transmutes the qualitative elements of the outward realm.

My Imaginary Friend

There is only one her for each him. She has been singled out for him in each register of the universe. This cannot be changed because She is the Her who came out of Him. In the turning of the wheel of the Eternal Return, it is not always given for them to meet. One or other may arrive late or too early.

It should be known that, in reality, the solution is to be able to bring Her back to life, to resurrect her within his soul.

Nos

Often impatient with the all too slow process, through dreams, of the revelation of Her, I take it upon myself to imagine Her through my own efforts. But the imagination cannot create *ex nihilo*, so it needs an inspiration to kick it off. There are some women who are so beautiful, that men may be affected physically just by gazing upon her. This is how **Dante** described Beatrice in *La Vita Nuova*:

she showed herself so gentle and so full of all perfection, that she bred in those who looked upon her a soothing quiet beyond any speech; neither could any look upon her without sighing immediately.

Yet even the Girl from Ipanema made the men sigh whenever she passed by. So my imagination requires more, much more. Beatrice, for Dante, represented, not just Beauty, but, more importantly, Wisdom. She guides him through the heavenly spheres toward God, something which the philosophers could not do.

Beyond a physical sigh, there is a spiritual sigh. Like Scheherazade, the image would be someone of high intellect, familiar with “history, poetry, philosophy, science, and the arts”; she would understand the transcendent meaning behind the appearances, often described in terms of the archetypes of the gods and goddesses.

And she is passionate about her life. She is elegant with refined tastes in fashion, art, architecture, perfumes. She intuitively grasps the rhythms of life, knowing when to dance and when to be still, just contemplating the world around her.

She seems to be how I might imagine myself to be, were I a woman.

The Soul of a Woman Although a woman longs to be “known”, for a man to “get her”, she nevertheless keeps many things hidden. She will drop a clue from time to time, and these must be carefully attended to. Yet the more you penetrate, and the more you think you know, something is still off kilter. It is not like looking through a window, but rather “through” a mirror. Left becomes right, and right becomes left, which is disorientating long before you become fully aware of it.

Yet it is necessary, because a man’s soul is deficient. A human being consists of the physical along with the three soul functions of Willing, Feeling, and Thinking. A man focuses on his physical prowess and intellectual skills, the two least permanent parts of the human being. The physical is left behind at death along with most of one’s thoughts. Thoughts have no permanent value. Even such a master of thinking like Thomas Aquinas came to the realization that they are just “so much straw”. What you Will and what you deeply Feel (not feelings in the trivial sense used by the modern world), will follow you, so these faculties also need development.

A child comes into the world with just the Willing and Feeling functions. He has desires and there is no space between his Feelings and their outward expression. Only much later does he learn to think.

Women don’t give up the Willing and Feeling functions so easily, so she can help him reclaim them.

There is a reason men fail at that task — fear. I can still remember the first time I tried to pick up a woman at a nightclub. I was so nervous, it took all my inner force to overcome the self-induced fear. Over

time, it became easier and stress-free. Not necessarily good, since motives are not pure; nevertheless, more possibilities opened up to me, often in unexpected ways.

Case study: Lucy

I know that I will meet you again and that everything will happen once again exactly as it did a long time ago. Except that this time I will not allow you to die. I will hold you in my arms, defending you against the dark waters of death.

Temptation can be spiritual or material. Lucy's was spiritual. I received a strange email, filled with incoherent rantings. I put it away, but got another a month later. This one I answered. Lucy was at a low point in life, desperate for help or reassurance. Clearly, her circle of intimates could not see it or could not help. I responded to the second one, as best I could. The White Knight could not deny a damsel in distress. That calmed her and she became more coherent; we arranged for voice communication.

She turned out to be a woman of remarkable intelligence, deep spirituality, and a Sibylline visionary. She claimed to know my past and foresee my future. She suggested I was chosen to continue her spiritual tradition, which she offered to teach me. The spiritual turned into the personal, even becoming flirtatious.

During our conversations, her most tender moments would melt my heart, but then she would go into an insane rage or enter into extended periods of inconsolable melancholy. Ultimately, she could not understand the possibility of a higher calling, so, like a dog returning to her vomit, she returned to the life circumstances that had caused her distress in the first place.

I was a failure, unable to defend her against the dark waters of death.

Case study: Harriett Harriett represents material temptation. She was raised in a Christian cult and her mother arranged her marriage. He

left her with three children, leaving her burdened and alone. Yet she wanted to be known, and known intimately and completely; discussions about literature, films, metaphysics, religion, while suitable for me, just left her longing for more.

Harriett began mailing me her most intimate fantasies, amounting to several pages; they showed her to be highly intelligent and quite literate. There was a great attention to minute detail, including the scents of candles, titles of background music, clothing, the exact physical circumstances, the colour of the sky, lakes, streets, people, and so on.

Many were quite explicit, poetically describing the intensity of her felt desire and the physical sensations associated with lovemaking. Foreplay was also described in detail. She made no distinction between her experience of the physical and her inner feelings: "I wanted . . . to feel him touch the very core of my being." No woman had ever spoken to me in such terms prior to that.

Other fantasies were so innocent and sweet, like her desire to make breakfast and have coffee on the patio with her lover. When we finally met, I was able to give her the XXX nights, but not the casual coffee in the morning. There was not enough physical attraction and I had no desire to raise another man's children. I expect to be fully punished for this in Purgatory.

Case study: Hafiz

Praise be to God what wonderful wealth is given to me tonight;

Because my Divine Beloved came to me, quite suddenly, tonight.

Although born in modest circumstances, and working in a bakery by day, Hafiz studied assiduously at night. He taught himself law, science, maths, poetry. One day, he made a delivery to a wealthy household, where lived a young woman. Her beauty made him almost lose consciousness; he fell so madly in love, he could no longer eat and sleep normally. He wrote

poems about her, despite his realization that she had been promised to another.

He vowed to keep a vigil of 40 nights at a saint's tomb, after which he would be granted his heart's desire. During one of his deliveries, she came out to meet him, having learned of his poems to her. She said she preferred a man of genius rather than the son of a king. Yet, he was so tired from his vigil, that he walked away.

On the 40th night, the archangel Gabriel came to fulfil the promises of the vigil. Suddenly, Hafiz realized that his heart's desire was for God, not for the woman.

This is what the 13th century Persian Sufi poet Hafiz has to say about self-emptying:

First, the self-emptying:

I Have Learned So much from God That I can no longer call
myself A Christian, a Hindu, A Muslim, a Buddhist, a Jew.

The Truth has shared so much of Itself with me, That I can no
longer call myself A man, a woman, an angel, Or even pure Soul.

Love has befriended Hafiz so completely, It has turned to ash, And
freed me Of every concept and image My mind has ever known.

To be followed by the feast!

Why Just show you God's menu? Hell, we are all starving – Let's
Eat!

The story of Hafiz' awakening is a lesson in itself. It demonstrates the alchemical transformation of a soul from common desire to the gold of enlightenment:

When he was 21 and working as a baker's assistant, Hafiz delivered some bread to a mansion and happened to catch a fleeting glimpse of a beautiful girl on the terrace. That one glimpse captured his heart, and he

fell madly in love with her, though she did not even notice him. She was from a wealthy noble family and he was a poor baker's assistant. She was beautiful, he was short and physically unattractive — the situation was hopeless.

As months went by, Hafiz made up poems and love songs celebrating her beauty and his longing for her. People heard him singing his poems and began to repeat them; the poems were so touching that they became popular all over Shiraz.

Hafiz was oblivious of his new fame as a poet; he thought only of his beloved. Desperate to win her, he undertook and arduous spiritual discipline that required him to keep a vigil at the tomb of a certain saint all night long for forty nights. It was said that anyone who could accomplish this near-impossible austerity would be granted his heart's desire. Every day Hafiz went to work at the bakery. Every night he went to the saint's tomb and stayed awake for this girl. His love was so strong that he succeeded in completing this vigil.

At daybreak on the fortieth day, the archangel Gabriel appeared before Hafiz and told him to ask for whatever he wished. Hafiz had never seen such a glorious, radiant being as Gabriel. He found himself thinking, "If God's messenger is so beautiful, how much more beautiful must God be!" Gazing on the unimaginable splendor of God's angel, Hafiz forgot all about the girl, his wish, everything. He said: "I want God!"

On this Easter weekend, I am also reflecting on the process of kenosis our self-emptying of all concepts, ideas, desires, mental superimpositions — to be followed by the fulfillment of a resurrection into a fuller, richer life.

The incidents described are for illustrative purposes only, and should not be construed as descriptions of any incident or person, living or dead (apart, of course, for Hafiz).

Update 15 November 2022: Probably the symbolism is buried too deep.

Lucy and Harry are nicknames for Lucifer and Ahriman.

Posted on 2020-11-15 by Cologero

5.3 The Scent of a Woman

This is why it is important to read older books, since it is easy to forget how quickly customs change, at least for those inhabiting the far West. In Gustav Meyer's *The Green Face*, we find this description of the seductive salesgirl in the magic shop:

As she did so demonstrate a magic trick for him she brought the whole range of a practised feminine charm into play, from the breasts deliberately displayed to the male, to the discreet, almost telepathic scent given off by her skin *which she intensified by occasionally lifting her arm to send a supplementary blast from the armpit.*

It certainly worked on the patron, since he bought the trick even though he neither wanted it nor needed it. Men today, who expect women to smell like a Dove beauty bar³, probably won't understand how her armpit scent is an attraction. Or perhaps they forget the natural connection between body odor and subconscious human sexual attraction⁴. Or perhaps she was a sorceress practicing her charm ...

Posted on 2012-08-23 by Cologero

* * *

³<https://www.dove.com/us/en/washing-and-bathing/beauty-bar/white-beauty-bar.html>

⁴https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Body_odor_and_subconscious_human_sexual_attraction

Aghorable on 2012-08-24 at 01:47 said:

Of course. This is why some women who might not be considered sexy if judged by popular standards still get a man's juices flowing when he is in their presence.

Oh, and Charlotte obviously could not resist returning after you flashed that deadly handlebar 'stache and white suit.

Cologero on 2012-08-24 at 16:55 said:

I am only into chapter 3, but I see Meyrink as a colorful writer, with the ability to describe various human types in great detail. He punctuates the story with ruminations on destiny and the intricacies of the thinking process. I can understand why Evola would have been attracted to this work. Meyrink describes the hypocrisy of Christian bourgeois life in Amsterdam in the ruins of post-WWI. For example, he describes one woman, a "humanitarian", who runs charitable events for people in the abstract, but does nothing for real individual persons. She has all the politically correct thoughts, although they do not go very deep. I was surprised, too, to learn that the Nigerian email scam had its own version at that time (without the Nigerian). I don't know yet why Guenon thought it was such a evil book, perhaps that will come out later on.

Logres on 2012-08-24 at 20:59 said:

I think it's good you are "testing the spirits" by reading the book yourself – I have one book by M that I could read, and am interested in Guenon's perspective, given he was so critical of so many of the figures Evola was interested in.

Logres on 2012-08-24 at 20:59 said:

Not that you have to "test everything", of course.

Cologero on 2012-08-24 at 21:13 said:

Actually, Logres, I'm reading it for pleasure. Even Eliade enjoyed Meyrink. Guenon, in his letters, claims that presenting Traditional information as a "parody" is an indication of a counter-initiation. We'll see ... or not.

BTW, oddly enough Guenon does recommend reading that type of material or, as you put it, "test everything".

Cologero on 2012-08-26 at 18:53 said:

I am still far from the conclusion that Guenon objects to. There are a series of macabre events and eccentric characters that form the story. However, there are some serious monologues about the nature of thought and destiny that, I believe, few men could write, and probably not too many more could even understand.

Cologero on 2012-08-28 at 11:41 said:
From The Green Face

Until now men have torn each other apart for the sake of certain dubious invisible beings that are careful not to call themselves spirits, but 'ideals'. I think the hour has finally come for the war against these invisible enemies, and I would like to play a part in it. For years I have been aware that I was being trained in spiritual warfare, but until now I have never had this clear feeling that a great battle against these damned ghosts is at hand. I tell you, once you start clearing out all those false ideals, there's no end to it. *You've no idea what piles of humbug brazenly posing as truth you have inherited.*

Numen on 2017-08-24 at 20:51 said:

I've recently come across a book titled "Scenting Salvation: Ancient Christianity and the Olfactory Imagination," which is about the aspects of scent and smell in early Christianity and Western mysticism. I have yet to fully read it in its entirety, but some interesting selections just from skimming through:

"exuding sweet fragrance to disguise the bad odor of jealousy" – Palladius

"Dearer to God are the trials for righteousness' sake than all vows and sacrifices. And dearer too, is the odor of the sweat of fatigue they cause, than all the drugs of sweet scent and exquisite perfumes" – Isaac of Nineveh

"virgins ought to refrain from using too much perfume"

5.4 Who do you love?

The New York Times had an article this week about the latest dating trend, which is to ask about your date's credit score before you get too involved. That is something pretty girls don't really have to worry about because we know that if this one gets away, there will be another to take his place. I never really had to ask that question myself, since there are more subtle ways to glean this information. I always order a glass of cognac for a cocktail and watch their face for a tell. If they flinch, even a little, that puts my guard up. My worst experience with that was when one date

didn't care about the \$20 glass of cognac, but objected vehemently when I ordered it on the rocks. He said it was a sad way to treat cognac and made me appear unsophisticated and prolish.

We dated for a while nevertheless, but he did treat me rather shabbily after that incident, and I believe because of it. I've tried it without ice, but can't seem to get it down. Well, back to the point, there are certainly more subtle ways to gauge this. If he pays with a gold Amex card, I know that they have run their own credit check on him. I'm a bit more suspicious when a date pays for everything with \$100 bills although I do find it somewhat exciting.

The experts say that you should verify a man's driver's license if you are meeting him for the first time. That is hardly sufficient, in my opinion. After all, virtually anyone can get one. No, what I ask for is his **Concealed Weapon Permit**. Then you know he has no criminal record and has passed a background check!

But, yes, I do have a serious point. After our first date, when it seems that there is something more that we mutually want to pursue, I ask for a background check. No, not one of those crappy Internet thingies, but a more personal one. You may think this is impudent, but trust me, it is worth the trouble. And boys are more cooperative than you might expect.

From my work with female clients, I understand the frustration women feel when their men do not open up with them. Boys don't like to talk about that girl stuff. However, if you ask him for evidence, you may be surprised what you find. My dates have shown me grades, SAT scores, and even IQ test results. You would be surprised, too, how many keep scrap books. They may keep clippings of their sports exploits, promotions, charitable activities, and so on. Having something concrete in front of them seems to get boys to open up more, so they become more talkative. You can find a lot about a person in this way. Photographs, too, are a great tool. Girls, you will do this at some point anyway, so why not learn all

you can at the beginning? If he has no documentable past, is that really something you want to take a chance on?

But hold on, that is not all. I also ask for three references, obviously not related to him. Again, boys, if they want you, are more accommodating than you might imagine. And if he can't find three people who admire him, do you really want to belong to a club of one? Usually, I get to talk to close friends, sometimes even the man's minister. If you get his AA buddy, you'll have to decide how best to handle it.

The fellow with the hangup about the ice cubes gave me the names of his childhood friend and two female friends. I wasn't sure if they were ex-girlfriends, or women he kept on the bench in case he needed a sub. To my mind, it showed a lot of *élan*, as well as a subtle warning that I was replaceable. Neither said a bad word about him, even after an hour, although I got the impression they would be happy if our relationship faltered. It did shake my confidence, since he seemed ready to dump me over ice in a glass of cognac. I've never been dumped, so it just made me want him more.

I'll end with a warning: like a good lawyer, never ask for information you don't want to hear. One date took me to an Italian film festival and then to a nice Italian restaurant afterwards. I always felt a couple should be open about their past experiences and how it affects them. So I spoke to him about my recent divorce, how it had torn me up, even to the point of not even telling my family for several months. I then asked him to tell me about his past relationships and what he had learned.

To my shock, he went on for the better part of an hour. He related a history of the past 15 years of his several girlfriends, how he met them, why they broke up, their personal histories (and some of them were bizarre), even their sexual practices. He seemed to take great pleasure in comparing the sizes, shapes, and tints of their body parts. He told me he skipped some because he couldn't remember their names. What made it so disconcerting, is the complete lack of ordinary emotion as he went on, nor

any empathy for the feelings of those women. He may as well have been describing a deer hunt with his hunting buddies.

I was getting quite uncomfortable, fidgeting in my seat, yet not daring to interrupt. At a suitable stopping point, I told him how I felt. He gave me a quizzical look, responding, “That’s what I thought you asked about.” He then returned to his meal with great gusto, and I pondered whether I would be the end of the road for him or the topic for a future conversation.

Posted on 2012-06-01 by Teresa Chicalinda

5.5 I’m Just a Girl

A few years ago I was watching an Argentinian movie about the Tango with Cologero. The main character, the aging movie director, was seducing a young dancer. He told her, “Sometimes I feel like a lion wandering aimlessly in the savanna.” Of course, that turned into a teaching moment. The lion does not wander aimlessly. He established the boundaries of his territory by pissing on the bushes; the scent of his urine is a signal to other lions to stay away.

Within those boundaries the lion is a presence, a “being there”. He creates the feeling of security for his harem so they can search for game and raise the cubs. I objected that the lion is lazy, since the lionesses are responsible for hunting. Cologero insisted that the lion is like the unmoved mover and the action of the lionesses are really the female force. It is only our age that regards women as knickknacks; there is no reason for them to be useless or incompetent.

I’ll consider that but I’m not quite convinced. On the other hand, unlike the prairie dogs⁵, there are no interlopers that dare approach his

⁵<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4898>

harem. Even Clint Eastwood would not risk his life for a few nights with a lioness of average looks and intelligence.

I sort of get that “presence” thing. This past spring, I saw Pitbull at an outdoor concert. Like a lot of women, I find Pitbull incredibly attractive and compelling. I was hardly alone, as there were thousands of screaming women, yelling at him to take his clothes off. Cologero said that if ever saw him in street clothes at Target, I wouldn’t look at him twice. I suppose that is true. Yet on stage, he is totally compelling. There is something about a man at the center of attention that excites a woman’s passion.

I can hear the complaints now, just as I have so often in therapy sessions: “Women want the bad boy, and the good guys are left wanting.” That is not quite true, as there are women who want the good guys; it’s just that the good guys don’t want them. Even if it isn’t Pitbull, different women will be attracted to different qualities, but they will always prefer the one that stands out from the crowd. Everyone else just seems interchangeable. If you need a toothpick, does it really matter which one you pick out of the box?

I know everyone thinks they need to be “nice”, say by buying flowers and chocolate. That is nice, but it would be much nicer from the equivalent of Pitbull. I expect an email from Cologero because I am using this wrong: Flowers are the path of the ancestors, but Pitbull is the path of the Gods.

That is simply the reality of sexual attraction, so intelligent men need to deal with it. I’m sure you can make the case that the wrong qualities are at the center of attention in our time. Intellectually I may agree, but primally I feel otherwise. If it is true, as I have been reading here, that intelligence is at the heart of reality, why is the world as it is arranged so unintelligently? Why don’t the intelligent men take control and redo society in their own image? I think it is because they lack the qualities of the Lion. It seems to me, instead, they are expecting the lionesses to change. That won’t happen. So how can that be done, you ask? Well,

don't ask me, I'm just a girl.

Posted on 2012-09-29 by Teresa Chicalinda

* * *

Audrey on 2012-09-29 at 22:50 said:

Ye, see that is the basis of war.. those other guys pants are pooppy, and they breed like rabbits! Mussolini was awesome about it.. perfume your underwear with roses y'all. Then the Germans came along, mis-read Evola, and lacking any sense of humor about coffee and the underwear washing thing, turned that into crotches of roses and bread baking.. and tgen there was Auschwitz. I hear Lithuanian ho's make the best Svara rabbits.

Audrey on 2012-09-29 at 22:54 said:

Born on a cock, died po Svarog. Germanz are ppl two. I have indeed released a record calked Iron, and dedicated it t the US Army Special Forces, who were founded by ex-Russians trying to get out from behind the Iron Curtain.

Audrey on 2012-09-29 at 23:11 said:

Pitbull is the path of the Gods? I am laughing here ..Apropos of the lioness commentary, that is simply the male enslaving the female skeletal structure to his reproductive impulses. There is no normal female who would concent, hence Nature invented boobies, and pearls..ie, drugs. The first principle of authentic Tantric sex is for the female to give up orgasm, and second is the oath not to use her body as a vehicle of another's desires. That means no kids. Society is so geared towards the family and pressuring the female it is not funny. The extremes are sacred prostitutes and military rape, which they call 'mead'.

Audrey on 2012-09-29 at 23:26 said:

Moreso, until a real Guru ties your hands with an authentic, real mala, and you are taught mudras, you will always only and only be a playbunny.

Andrew on 2012-09-30 at 02:47 said:

This site has been hijacked by a troll in Cologero's absence. I hope.

Audrey on 2012-09-30 at 18:29 said:

I am perfectly fine keeping my thoughts to myself, Ansrew, because most humans do not care to face the fallen aka predatorial nature of human sexuality. Nor the fact that things need to be faced squarely befoee they can be refined, which us the only way to change.

Look at our society... Clinton lies to his wife, and others condone rape as a form of conception.

Maybe you need a dose of grow up, and face the music because due to prim behavior we have \$5 his beaten and raped by middle class white millionaire wannabes and taco hell.

Just sayin' Andrew, but I also live outside of the world of library, university and home.

SW on 2012-10-01 at 15:31 said:

So it's actually the lionesses that go out and hunt and the lion king that stays home. Interesting.

Graham on 2012-10-02 at 23:07 said:

"Why don't the intelligent men take control and redo society in their own image?"

An intellectual could be defined as a man who attempts to do just that. Obviously nothing could be less traditional and more revolutionary: the intellectual, in this sense, is a Paine, a Marx, a Rousseau. Sites like this one exist because intelligent men have succeeded in redoing society in their own image. We attempt something quite different.

"I think it is because they lack the qualities of the Lion. It seems to me, instead, they are expecting the lionesses to change. That won't happen."

And I think that that's a platitude followed by a blame-shift typical of 'conservative' women with ensconced feminist tendencies. I wonder if you actually believe what you're implying, namely that women are devoid of agency and responsibility for themselves. Strangely that seems to be a point on which machos and feminists effectively agree. Myself, I suspect they are in symbiosis.

Perhaps women will have to learn the hard way what happens when from pride they refuse obedience to men: with voluntary submission the yoke is easy, and the burden light; with involuntary submission, not so much! [D83D?][DE09?]

Audrey on 2012-10-03 at 04:17 said:

From pride? What does pride have to do with experiencing sex as an energy of liberation and knowledge, and not as a yoke, easy or hard? Mind you the reason why women get yoked is so that they get entrapped by the male structure anyway. What I mean by this is the fact that during reproduction, esoterically speaking, the male skeleton, brain and skull reproduce, whereas the female body is only sacrificed as blood and flesh. After that, the child feeds on the mother's body until it is time to separate.. think about it.. it is a lateral extension of the structure into a temporal 'future'. Not only does it tie up the hands of the female, but it dictates to her rhythm, life direction, and she has no future. Hence, the perceived triumph of females over males, when the child is female, and the whole notion chiefly propagated by what I call matt patatt of child bearing as golden lamb and if women do not reproduce they will disappear bullshit. The whole German-Russian thing, which is bullshit, yet rocks and undermines society like a motherfucker.

It is not only that the female body is regarded as receptacle, but there is no actual registration of the female body at all. In other words, females have no awareness of themselves as bodies at all, physically and intellectually. It is classic black Tantra.

Briefly, and with not much precision, there are considered to exist three levels of knowledge, oral tradition based on breath energy, the book, and that knowledge which is deposited and transmitted by the skeletal structure .. note how females are excluded from gun wearing, sword practices, being generals, ranger school, all of that 'male' physical exercise.. and we are to be sluts in the bedroom, goddesses in the kitchen, and oh yeah, fetch home the bread like a good bitch too. All concepts of 'femininity' are servile to the male, and intellectually I am to salute little dicks who only see as high as my left breast..mmkay no.

I do have extensive formal university education as a cognitive scientist, mathematician, linguist, philosopher and art historian, and formally have the intellectual respect of the general manager of microsoft, harvard graduates in non business areas, and so forth. I find these to be mental gymnastics of the kid variety at best. At worst, reference Hadot, par exemple.

Gurdjieff is accurate about the klenex part, and again during birth the last dot on the picture is the nose.. it is a symmetrical funny shape, and is much responsible for why males try to 'hermeticize' female hands, male fantasies about mixing semen with excreta (sorry if yall not comfortable with graphicness), but also the popularity of say the shovel in military context, the playbunny phenomenon, the attractiveness of pitbull, olfactory smell sexual fantasies, such as bread, the smell of babies, perfumes, as well as a good portion of the non-mithraic aspects of wine, and the popular fantasy of omen as apples.. not to mention why females like to lie on chaises and discuss their sex lives.. Dick Couch anyone?

Females are externally yin and internally yang, with the male opposite. During sexual discharge, aka orgasm, the female brain is flooded with pleasure, just as when she is breastfeeding, so she does not actually self-actualize the sexual energy, but gives it away. Purely to feed the external, yang shell of the male. If she provides food for the male, she is also feeding her yin energy to his internal yin. Very schematically speaking.

That is why I carry my m16 left arm, and keep my berretta on my right thigh and a knife around my belt.

And if you think I will salute to your head senior coconut, instead of you mine (Evola also commented on the active and passive male/female in those terms), we are going to tango.

And you are right Cologero, I do not really care about the (sand) box. I think a bit of distraction in the way of examining the meaning of Grammar in Sanskrit would give you a small hint into something else.

Graham on 2012-10-03 at 12:04 said:

Audrey you're crazier than Charlotte ! I for one never realized that the shape of the nose was responsible for so much, up to and including the popularity of the shovel in a military context.

Anyway, yes, Audrey. From pride.

Pride that leads some women to see fathers, brothers, and husbands as tyrants and children as parasites ... leads them to call loss of chastity 'liberation and knowledge' ... leads them to brag about their degrees when nobody asked. Rather than admiring the Lion we could all do with more study of the Lamb. Submission: it's not just for women !

Out of curiosity, what are the (written) sources of this 'esoteric feminism' ?

To return to Terisa's post. The proffered symbolism of the lion and his harem, applied to Pitbull and his hysterical fans, is an example of the current organic symbiosis between machos and feminists, who both seek to 'liberate' women's libidos. Game bloggers call this hypergamy and fittingly explain it in animal terms – rather like a lion and his harem, in fact.

Gabe Ruth on 2012-10-03 at 15:37 said:

Though he cannot (yet?) be categorized as a traditionalist, this writer does have a clue about what ails the world: kinglessness.

Saladin on 2012-10-04 at 20:48 said:

Well said!

Just a Guy on 2012-10-18 at 18:45 said:

So much of people's lives is wasted in this. It is time to arrange marriages again. Get it over and done with early and move on with life, not decades of emotional drama and societal masturbation.

Andrew on 2012-10-18 at 20:27 said:

Thumbs up.

Lucas on 2015-08-30 at 08:25 said:

I understand your intentions, hahaha.

5.6 Men are Binary

Women seem terribly complex to men, although it is not really true. On the other hand, women believe that men are quite simple, again not true. A few years ago, I had a new client, let's call her Laine, who was trying to cope with a very difficult separation. Although approaching

menopause, she was still a strikingly beautiful women, blonde and slender with Nordic features inherited from her Norwegian family. She had a personal trainer and rode her kayak almost daily through the waterways of Miami Beach. I'm certain her firm, yet shapely, body still turned heads, even among the younger men.

Raised in a small town in upstate New York, she had a troubled childhood. Abused by her father and brother, who was always in and out of jail, she left home the day of her 18th birthday. In Manhattan, she achieved a modicum of success in modeling and acting, although it never brought her fame or fortune. She remained close to the entertainment industry, working behind the scenes in a cooking show and various news broadcasts. She hoped someday to have her own cooking show.

She was never able to establish a satisfactory relationship with a man, so she remained single and childless for many years. Eventually she was pursued by a businessman who owned an electronic store on 42nd street. I saw his picture: he was fat and ugly. Laine told me that he was so pushy that eventually she gave in to him. She found something exciting about his type A personality and the improvement in her financial situation through marriage was too much to resist.

Unfortunately, the money was ill-gotten through securities fraud and he was eventually arrested by federal agents. He spent a few years in prison, leaving her alone with their young son. The government had seized their assets, leaving her financial situation precarious. By turning state's evidence against his partners, he was able to get his sentence mitigated. Once out of prison, he was able to restart his businesses; Laine never knew where the money had come from. To avoid further confiscations, he put a couple of million dollars in her name and sent her to Florida, which he would visit every weekend. He encouraged her to get a divorce, a "paper divorce," he called it, in order to protect her assets from the feds. Eventually, he said, they would be back together.

Again, she agreed to everything he said. Over time, the visits became

less frequent, from weekly, to monthly, and then to never. She suspected he was with someone else, but really did not know. Oddly enough, she retained her admiration for him, claiming he could “sell ice to an Eskimo.” I told her that he could only sell to a sucker, but she would not face up to that. To do so would have meant that she was a sucker for being seduced by him. A therapist can only point things out, but it is up to the patient to admit her role in her own predicament. That is the only way to heal.

I got through to her a little bit. She said she now wanted a relationship with a regular guy, someone normal, someone she could count on. So she tried Internet dating and met someone she thought matched that ideal. Clark (not his real name) was a successful consultant, although hardly at the financial level of her ex-husband. He was fit and good-looking, intelligent, and a good family man. Just what Laine thought she wanted. I didn’t hear from her for a few months, so I assumed things were going well.

That is, until one Monday morning, she called me and frantically requested an appointment. She told me about Clark, how great he was, how he got along with her son. They went to dinner, dances, polo games, all the things she thought normal couples would do. So what was the problem, I asked?

“I don’t know. He was everything I thought I wanted. I just couldn’t get excited about him.”

“So you prefer someone who was a thief, a liar, who deceived you and cheated on you?” I asked.

“Yes, yet, what is wrong with me?”

“What happened over the weekend?”

“Saturday night, we met with some friends and came back to my house. I sensed a little coolness in him, although he was probably just responding to me. I walked him out to his car. He looked at me, but instead of kissing me good night, he simply asked, ‘do you want me to call you anymore?’”

“I was flummoxed. I started stammering and went on and on. I told him that he was the perfect guy for me, but that I was too messed up to have a relationship with him. I told him I had talked to my friends and they were all giving me advice; one even convinced me to go to a Baha’i meeting. Finally, I told him I was going back to therapy and I would contact him later after I had worked things out. I had never felt so out of control and just kept yapping.”

“Well, what was his reaction?” I was curious.

“He just said, ‘I wasn’t looking for a long story, I just wanted a yes or no answer.’ Then he drove off.”

Posted on 2012-11-03 by Teresa Chicalinda

* * *

KnewItAllAlong on 2012-11-04 at 21:34 said:

This is why folks used to keep a tighter reign on females guys. This lady could clearly benefit from having had someone tell her what to do; now look at her. These are the perils of liberation and modernity. She would probably defend both of those to the very end (though they give her the rope to hang herself).

5.7 What Does Woman Want

Happy wife, happy life.

Old wives’ tale

The great question that has never been answered, and which I have not yet been able to answer, despite my thirty years of research into the feminine soul, is ‘What does a woman want?’

SIGMUND FREUD

On se lasse de penser, meme d'agir, jamais on ne se lasse d'aimer.
(We get tired of thinking, even of acting. But we never get tired
of loving.)

AUGUSTE COMTE

Women of Power and Virtue Since most biographies at the time were about men, **Giovanni Boccaccio** redressed that imbalance in *On Famous Women*. He wrote about 100 or so women, mostly from antiquity. However, he was not simply interested in telling tales or repeating gossip, but rather in drawing moral conclusions from their lives. Hence, there are stories about virtue, greed, duplicity, adultery, loyalty, and so on. He did not regard women as pets who needed to be shielded from the harsh realities of life. In the story of Sulpicia, he makes that perfectly clear:

Women should not always be resplendent with gold and jewels; they should not always indulge in ornaments; they should not always flee the sun in summer and rain in winter; they should not always dwell within their changers; they should not always spare themselves.

To the contrary, the women he admired were as strong as men in their own way. When her husband Cruscellio, whom she loved dearly, faced hardships, she shared them also. Boccaccio explains:

When the blows of Fortune demand it, women must endure toil, go into exile, bear poverty, and face danger bravely with their husbands. This is the admirable service of women; these are their battles and their victories. Their striking triumphs are to overcome ease and luxury, as well as domestic difficulties, by means of their virtue, steadfastness, and purity of mind. In this way they win perpetual fame and glory. Let, therefore, not only those women

be ashamed who follow the shadow of happiness with all their efforts, but even more let those be ashamed who shun seasickness, are worn out by light work, are frightened by foreign lands, and become pale on hearing the bellowing of an ox.

Women became rulers not because they crashed some imaginary glass ceiling, but rather because they displayed the qualities of leadership and fairness. Thus he write this about Dido, the Queen of Carthage:

She cast aside womanly weakness and hardened her spirit to manly strength, and for this she later deserved being called Dido, which in Phoenician means 'heroic'.

Women could also be warriors, followers of Diana, like Camilla, Queen of the Volscians. Of course, a warrior requires self-discipline. Boccaccio draws this lesson from Camilla:

I wish that the girls of our time would look at Camilla and, seeing that virgin already adult and free amusing herself by running through fields, forests, and the dens of animals with her quiver, curing the pleasures of lascivious desires with work, refusing pleasures and amusements, abstaining from elaborate food and drink, and with constant spirit rejecting not only the embrace, but even the company of young men of her age, would learn from her example.

Men were often at fault, forcing themselves on women through their lust. Circe, the daughter of the Sun, affected men through her remarkable beauty. Boccaccio describes her effect on men:

She made many men become haughty because of her matchless attraction, and so those who through this wicked woman's deeds appeared to have lost human reason, seemed to have been deservedly changed into beasts through their own crimes.

In this regard, she was hardly unique. Boccaccio continues:

If we consider human behaviour we can well understand from this example that there are many Circes everywhere and many other men are changed into beasts by their lustfulness and vices.

It is up to men themselves to overcome their lustfulness.

Ulysses, instructed by Mercury's advice, i.e., by Hermes, obviously signifies the wise man who cannot be bound by the trickery of deceit.

Although he praised the chastity of many of the women, Boccaccio was well aware of the sometimes overwhelming power of sexual concupiscence. Chastity, therefore, had to be the free choice of a mature woman, and he opposed forcing virginity on girls. Rhea Illa was forced by her brother to become a Vestal, pledged to eternal virginity. Therefore he rejects sending young women to the nunnery against their will. That leads to unhappiness:

To console their saddened hearts, they have recourse only to thinking how they can destroy their prison and flee, or at least bring their lovers inside, trying to take furtively the pleasure which has been denied them.

Hence, he concludes:

Girls must not be consecrated to God while ignorant, or young, or under coercion. On the contrary, they should be well brought up from childhood in the parental home, taught honesty and praiseworthy behaviour, and then, when they are grown and with their entire mind know what they are doing, let them submit to the yoke of perpetual virginity of their own free will and not under duress.

The Double Standard The term “double standard” is hardly used any more. Not so long ago, it indicated that men and women were held to different standards in regards to their sexual activity. Presumably, men were admired for their sexual conquests, whereas women were condemned as sluts for being promiscuous. But life is not so simple.

There simply is not the same degree of difficulty. Almost any woman can walk into a bar and find a casual sex partner for the night. For men it is not so easy, since a few men get all the luck, but most would go home alone. Women are most attractive when young, but men mature later. After leaving the world of boys, they have to learn to deal with rejection, and only hard-earned experience will teach them what women want.

At a pool party some time ago, I met a fellow who was married to a TV sports executive. Although he had a normal build, she looked like a wrestler, a male wrestler to be clear. Seeing my pretty girlfriend, he must have felt he owed me an explanation. He had gotten drunk at a party, took her home, and one thing led to another. She got pregnant so he married her. His explanation, however, did not suffice, since they had a second child, probably not the result of a drunken orgy. He did the manly thing, rejected abortion, and married her. He really should not have been concerned about what other men think.

The British rag, the *Sun*, recently quoted a “study” claiming that sex on the first date is best to get into a romantic relationship. That just means that most men are so hard up for sex that they’ll latch onto any women who offers them a steady supply.

I used to be shocked at the number of women who were willing to cheat on their boyfriends or husbands with me. Were the husbands aware that their wives were in love with another man? Nevertheless, they were steadfast, presumably because they knew the fling would not endure for long.

On the other hand, we have the example of Hosea and Gomer. God wanted Hosea to marry her, despite her adulterous nature. So we should

perhaps admire the cuckold for his faithfulness.

On the other hand, it is said that the angels rejoice when a man marries a prostitute and leads her to virtue. The ideal of the good-hearted prostitute persists into our own time, as the success of the movie, *Pretty Woman*, attests.

The Unhappiness of Women Despite the overcoming of the double standard, about 20 to 25% of American women take anti-anxiety or anti-depressant medications. Another group self-medicates with alcohol, marijuana, or illegal drugs. Women were supposed to have become deliriously happy since they could engage in sex at will, take birth control, and abort unwanted pregnancies. The sexual revolution has not been an obvious blessing.

Loss of Interest in Sex At a lunch meeting with some old friends, a woman mentioned a “study” that claimed that youths were engaging in less sex. She thought that was marvelous, assuming that young people were returning to some sort of virtuous life. She was shocked, however, when I explained that the lack of interest in sex was due to masturbation. These youths are jerking off to online pornography.

When I was a youth, birth control was illegal except for married couples in Puritanical Massachusetts. When I got my driver’s license, I drove to New Hampshire to buy a pack of condoms. I kept one in my wallet, “just in case” the right occasion arose. A few years later, the day — or rather night — arrived. When I opened the package, the entire condom fell apart. I did not take into account that body heat would eventually dissolve the latex.

Starship Troopers The film, *Starship Troopers*, has often been described as “fascist”. That term is falsely used to describe any sort authori-

tarian rule. The correct term is “tyranny”, since Fascism has quite a different agenda.

Actually, the story is based on ideas from **Plato’s** *Republic*, whether consciously or unconsciously, I cannot say. The hidden Guardians rule the state. The Producers are those in trade, commerce, etc. Although the Producers can achieve personal wealth, they have no part in the political life of the State. They are regarded as weak and their lives as dishonourable, lacking in meaning.

In between them, there is the group of auxiliary Guardians, or warriors. As in the *Republic*, one does not become an auxiliary through birth, but rather it must be earned. Another feature is that warrior births are regulated by the Guardians, so the warriors require a license to bear a child. In the *Republic*, the auxiliaries, both men and women, would do gymnastics together in the nude. That is shown in the famous co-ed shower scene in the film.

Some may despise that political arrangement, even though it was successful in repelling an invasion of alien intelligent bugs. Democracies most likely could not accomplish that today.

Mediocrity and the American Dream There is constant talk in the media about achieving the “American Dream”, which, as far as I can tell, is to be a prosperous consumer with no higher values. After observing the behaviour of American politicians, it seems that the American Dream is that those of mediocre talents and virtue can obtain wealth and prominence.

A Korean professor claims that space aliens are mating with earthlings in order to bring about a superior race that will “save the planet”. I heard that there is a dating app for who would like to hook up with those aliens. So even if you yourself are mediocre, perhaps you could have an indigo child⁶.

⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indigo_children

Posted on 2019-05-02 by Cologero

5.8 The Votary of the Blue Flower

For the creation waits with eager longing for the revealing of the sons of God; for the creation was subjected to futility, not of its own will but by the will of him who subjected it in hope; because the creation itself will be set free from its bondage to decay and obtain the glorious liberty of the children of God. We know that the whole creation has been groaning in travail together until now; and not only the creation, but we ourselves, who have the first fruits of the Spirit, groan inwardly as we wait for adoption as sons, the redemption of our bodies.

ROMANS 8:19-23

And every day there were what are called the Green Hills; that is, the low line of the Castlereugh Hills which we saw from the nursery windows. They were not very far off but they were, to children, quite unobtainable. They taught me longing — *Sehnsucht*: made me for good or ill, and before I was six years old, a **votary of the Blue Flower**.

C S LEWIS, *Surprised by Joy*

Sehnsucht

The fullness of existence, life's true richness, does not consist solely in health and happiness but in an ever expanding range of joy and sorrow; and the broader the range, the richer life becomes.

VALENTIN TOMBERG

Besides the Green Hills, Lewis describes similar experiences and reached a conclusion:

Joy comes from an unsatisfied desire which is itself more desirable than any other satisfaction. And anyone who has ever experienced Sehnsucht will want it again.... I doubt that anyone who has tasted it would ever exchange it for all the pleasures of the world. ... It is a desire for something longer ago or further away or still about to me.

The satisfaction of every desire, beyond physical needs, is not necessarily energizing. One common example is sexual desire, for which there is the time of energized anticipation which enhances all the senses. That all ends in the spasm, as Marcus Aurelius called it. That is why the French refer to the orgasm as *la petite mort*, the little death. Life force is spent, there is exhaustion with nothing to look forward to, apart from endless repetition of the same.

To the common mind, the unsatisfied desire should bring sorrow, not joy. That is because our emotional life is poorly developed, actually, according to Western esoteric teachings, the least developed soul faculty. As one develops the emotional center, a deeper feeling of joy and sorrow may emerge. **Ibn Arabi** composed a series of poems on longing, mixing joy and sorrow, such as this one:



Gentle now, doves
of the thorn berry and moringa
thicket, don't add
to my heart-ache your sighs.

Gentle now,
lest your sad cooing

reveal the love I hide,
the sorrow I hide away.

Kahlil Gibran wrote on this topic:

Some of you say, “Joy is greater than sorrow,” and others say, “Nay, sorrow is the greater.”

But I say unto you, they are inseparable.

Together they come, and when one sits alone with you at your board, remember that the other is asleep upon your bed.

The one who is incapable of, or afraid to face, his sorrow, will never feel great Joy.

True Love and Friendship Aristotle famously distinguished three types of friendship:

- **The Friendship of Utility:** This type of friendship results when people are bonded through a commitment to a project. It may be random as in the case of people who meet, for example, through school, university, military service, or work environment. Or it may be deliberate as when people undertake a common project. In most cases, the friendship seldom endures beyond the common environment or project.
- **The Friendship of Pleasure:** In this case, the parties get pleasure from their relationship. They may be drinking buddies, poker, or other game, players, for example.
- **Spiritual Connection:** In rarer cases, the friends may share an intellectual or spiritual kinship.

These have their analog in the marriage relationship, which was described in Lucinde, one of our inaugural essays⁷. These are:

⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=7>

- **Utility:** The most fundamental utility is raising children, which is the primary goal of marriage. Then, a father might need to find a husband for his daughter. That happened to my prosperous great-grandfather, who had four daughters. When a financial reversal hit Sicily, he had to send to America to find husbands for all of them, whom he could no longer afford. Due to their age difference, I doubt that my grandfather knew my grandmother very well, but he returned to Sicily to marry her.

Among the bourgeoisie, a marriage may serve to cement a business relationship. The Rothschilds took advantage of this, for the obvious reason.

The nobility would arrange marriages to assure political alliances. Over time, the rulers were effectively of a different race from their subjects.

- **Pleasure.** Clearly, pleasure is an expected part of marriage.
Yet a man might keep pleasure and utility apart. In that case he might take on a mistress, just as a source of pleasure. The Shiites have an interesting solution to satisfy that longing: the temporary marriage.
- **Courtly Love.** This is analogous to Aristotle's spiritual connection. It was discovered in the esoteric schools that the same romantic feeling can arise without the physical element, thereby avoiding the little death. The Joy of experiencing a spiritual, intellectual, and emotional connection with someone else far exceeds physical pleasure. The former is rare, the latter, common. Nevertheless, the poignancy of separation brings pain, although without it, the Joy is incomplete.

Dance of the Seven Veils

And when the daughter of the same Herodias had come in, and had danced, and pleased Herod, and them that were at table with him, the king said to the damsel: Ask of me what thou wilt, and I will give it thee.

MARK 6:22

The dance of the seven veils is a modern reconstruction of Salome's dance. It was so seductive that Herod was willing to give up half his kingdom, but instead was asked for the head of John the Baptist. In an instant, the joy of the dance turned to sorrow, although Herod was compelled to honor his promise.

A modest version of the dance was performed by Rita Hayworth⁸ who did not remove the seventh veil. A more seductive and erotic version was performed by Maria Ewing⁹. With grace and allure she removed each veil in turn, leaving the audience always longing for more. Nevertheless, there is disappointment when she unveils completely and appears fully naked on stage. There is no more *Sehnsucht* and she appears ordinary.

By analogy, a woman's soul has seven veils. She desires to be known, but not so easily and not by anyone at random. One veil at a time, she reveals her soul. However, she should never remove the seventh veil; the mystery is more powerful than the revelation.

Knights of Christ

Magic, we could say, is the materialism of the future knights of Christ

PAPUS

⁸<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=I7I0Mhg8bks>

⁹<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=x3jF3g4KBbw>

And he gives expression to his hope that in the future there will be an intervention from beyond this closed circle by future magicians (“knights of Christ”) who will open the closed circle and transform it into a spiral.

VALENTIN TOMBERG

Magic means:

- We create our own reality
- Faith can achieve anything

Obviously, it is not a question of altering the material conditions of life, but of reaching higher states of being. A closed circle cannot do so because there is no opening to a higher state. But a spiral symbolizes that as we die to one state of being, we are reborn to a higher state. There is the stubborn awareness, experienced as a deep longing, that we are not in our true home, and that another twist of the spiral will bring us closer. Those who are satisfied with this life are described in the Quran:



As to those who believe not in the Hereafter, we have made their deeds pleasing in their eyes; and so they wander about in distraction.

THE ANTS

Believers, on the other hand, live in exile and there is a longing for the **Paradisial State**, which we know is our true home. The knight errant

wanders with a purpose, seeking the **Holy Grail** which Adam left behind when he was exiled from Eden. **Seth**, however, was allowed back to Eden in order to retrieve it. Hence, the Primordial Tradition can be traced back to Seth. **Boris Mouravieff**¹⁰ expresses that explicitly.

In the series “GNOSIS” the author has done his utmost to expose in a modern form the esoteric Doctrine which dates according to the Tradition from before the Deluge — back to Seth, the third son of Eve. Completed and revealed by Jesus after his resurrection to Peter, John, and James, this Gnosis was later conserved from generation to generation in esoteric form in the oriental Orthodoxy — to be brought out of its occultism in our time.

Saint Augustine recognizes that Tradition, albeit without specifying a precise source.

Now the Grail is back in Paradise which, according to **Dante**, rests atop the Mount of Purgatory. Hence, the Joy of Paradise can be realized only through a path of pain, suffering, purgation, and sorrow.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=I7I0Mhg8bks>

Posted on 2021-03-14 by Cologero

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Rusalka on 2021-03-15 at 09:20 said:

Beautiful essay but a heavily logos – perspective, therefore dualistic. It cannot help but split your mind!

Orgasm is exhausting for the masculine, not the feminine. Masculine energy goes outwards in it, feminine not, feminine takes it in. Woman becomes ruddy, red, wants to talk, ready for the next round, a man wants to sleep. Woman is the multi orgasmic, man is the one who needs to take breaks! “There is nothing to look forward to” exists only if you are fixated on the future and “things to look forward to”, but if you dwell in the moment, you can experience the sunyata and it can be blissful, as any experience arises from it!

Unity, Unity! Not splits, not separation!

¹⁰<https://www.borismouravieff-gnosis.com/articles/preface-to-the-arabic-edition>

5.9 The Sense of Beauty

In the *Metaphysics of Beauty Rituals*¹¹, **Naida**, at **Orphic Transcendence**¹², broaches the topic of Beauty in relation to the Feminine. This is often a neglected topic in metaphysical systems, since Beauty is considered arbitrary and subjective at best, and prone to artificial eroticism at worst. Yet Beauty is on a par with Truth and Goodness as one of the transcendentals; to neglect it is to fall short. This is clear from the Platonic Tradition:



The first and last lesson of metaphysics in the classical tradition is the erotic orientation of the soul toward being. This is expressed in Parmenides' image of the chariot — ride to heart's desire; in Plato's sexual and conjugal metaphors for knowledge; in Aristotle's dictum "All men by nature desire to know"; in Plotinus' account of being as beauty; and in Aquinas' treatment of the transcendentals good, true, and beautiful. *Ex visu amor*: this desire begins with the most rudimentary encounter with reality which is the nature of all awareness, and is consummated in the intellectual union which is at once perfect apprehension and perfect reality: thinking-being.

ERIC PERL, *Thinking Being*

Unlike Truth and the Good, which raise us up, Beauty seeks to manifest itself in the world, to restore Beauty to its rightful place in the world of manifestation. Naida shows us where to look for it:

In Western thought, Venus or Aphrodite is related to earthly matters. As an archetype, and not only as a deity, she is connected with

¹¹<https://www.orphicinscendence.com/post/the-metaphysics-of-beauty-rituals>

¹²<https://www.orphicinscendence.com/>

beauty, fertility, harmony, and love. ... Venus, therefore teaches or instructs in the philosophy and knowledge of the world — how to speak, how to dress, how to earn money, how to negotiate a good deal, how to be just in a worldly sense, not just a heavenly one.

Julius Evola, following the anthropologist Bachofen concurs:

The properly Aphroditic race; tellurism, i.e., the adherence to terrestriality, assumes the forms of an extreme refinement of material existence in it, and not infrequently then promotes an opulent development of everything that is pomp and luxury in the outer life, therefore also in the world of the Arts and aesthetic sentiment.

The pursuit of Beauty cannot be an abstraction:

To honour the Venus, or to create a positive Venus Karma, is to engage with the Venusian in balance. It is to have the best, highest quality clothes one can have, to eat the most quality food, but not without restriction, because indulgence creates a negative Venus Karma. To deny Venus, if there is a desire, is also to create, the negative Karma with it. ... From this, it is seen that Venus is not just beauty in a static sense, it is also the process of beautification. Connected with this archetype, we do not eat just to fill the belly — we eat food that is quality, we assemble and arrange it beautifully, we place it on a beautiful plate.

The Beauty Ritual

But, in the inner life, a passivity and a lunar inconsistency subsist, compensated by a particular prominence given to eroticism, thus also to everything which is related to woman, which then exercises control because of that and silently secures dominance for itself.

JULIUS EVOLA

That is only part of it, as the urge for dominance overcomes passivity. The Moon is cold and dry, while Venus is warm and moist. The Venusian spirit is hardly passive; the beauty ritual is energizing.

The beauty rituals also embody this sentiment of refinement and beautification. Indeed, body, face or anything else may be naturally beautiful, and perfectly enough. Yet, the Venusian spirit desires to enhance it, to dramatise it, to direct a light to a specific part, area or act. Venus, unlike the other symbol of the feminine, the Moon, is warm and active. Unlike the Moon which is cold and seeks to receive warmth from some external source, Venus is libidinous, warm, and seeks to release the energy into something.

The woman's Anima may even become Phallus hungry:

Aphrodite/Venus as a deity, and also the nymphs or sirens who are the same archetype, were often assertive and pursuing. Sometimes, even forcing themselves on the male object of their affection.

The Knight's Indifference In a world in which the ugly, the bizarre, the unusual are valorized, it is good to be reminded of the role of Beauty in life. For the Knight, therefore, the path of the Ascetic is not appropriate; rather the path of Indifference. The Knight may enjoy a sumptuous feast one night or he may have to forage for food on another; it is all the same to him.

A couple of years ago, a woman sent me a video clip from the Sound of Music with Maria dancing with the Captain. That was her fantasy: the elegant and charming Captain dressed in his finery. But perhaps the week before he was in a battle: sleeping on the ground, eating poorly,

body odor permeating the air, the agonous cries of the wounded, death all around him. It is all the same to him.

Indifference does not mean to be cold and without feelings; rather, it requires the wisdom to know when to express them and when not to. For the Knight, the world is the battleground in which he plays out his destiny. That is the horizontal dimension, but the cross requires the vertical axis. Hence, he is in the world but not of it. Naida attributes that axis to Jupiter:

Jupiter, also known as Guru, is the guru or teacher of the devas or gods, his principles are heavenly, not worldly. He is the Divine, universal law and not the particular law of worldly concerns.

Earthly concerns are ambiguous: Aphrodite's instruction may be the cunning of the Serpent or the Wisdom of Sophia. Cunning results from the ignorance of the vertical axis. It is the closed circle, so the cunning man is limited to "past experiences and future projections".

Wisdom, on the other hand, teaches us to look with the "eye of the heart". The world is Maya, illusion, but also a reflection of the Divine. Hence, Aphrodite can either entrap us or expose Reality to us.

In this essay, Naida uses Vedic mythology to explore and, ultimately, resolve this paradox. For an enjoyable and informative trip through the world of beauty, illusion, asuras, nonduality, and God, please visit *The Metaphysics of Beauty Rituals*¹³.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qUfWRBGQkz0>

Posted on 2021-03-25 by Cologero

* * *

Rusalka on 2021-03-25 at 09:28 said:

Ah! The original text just became even more beautiful after reading this reflection of yours.

¹³<https://www.orphicinscendence.com/post/the-metaphysics-of-beauty-rituals>